

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Major U.S. stock** indexes posted modest declines in Monday's session despite a boost given some AI stocks by tech enthusiasts, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow falling 0.5%, 0.6% and 0.3%, respectively. The yield on the 10-year Treasury note rose above 5%. **A1, B1**

◆ **Trump spent last year** demanding rate cuts from the Fed. Investors now expect his handpicked chairman to reverse course and start raising them this week. **A1**

◆ **OpenAI** quietly bought Glass Imaging, a startup developing technology that uses artificial intelligence to improve cameras for smartphones. **B4**

◆ **NextEra Energy** affirmed its 2026 profit guidance at the high end while continuing to advance regulatory approvals for its proposed \$67 billion acquisition of Dominion. **B2**

◆ **Abbott agreed** to pay \$385 million to settle allegations related to its management of a baby-formula facility where bacteria were suspected of causing infant deaths. **B3**

◆ **Wegovy maker** Novo Nordisk is rebranding itself as Novo, betting that a shorter name will help it resonate more with consumers as it competes with Eli Lilly. **B1**

◆ **Hugo Boss said** its supervisory board chairman, Stephan Sturm, would step down after Frasers achieved near-majority ownership of the fashion company. **B3**

◆ **Michael Dell's** DFO Management and Sequence Holdings are taking insurance brokerage Baldwin Group private in a cash deal with an enterprise value of \$7.7 billion. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ **The Supreme Court** blocked the Trump administration from imposing new requirements for mail ballots, averting what state and local officials warned would have been a crisis in the midterm elections. **A1**

◆ **Trump rejected** the need for tighter federal regulation of artificial intelligence and dismissed safety concerns as a hoax that would leave the industry in financial ruin and hand China a competitive edge. **A4**

◆ **A Chinese official** said AI was the "core engine of a new round of technological revolution" and the main battleground of its rivalry with the U.S. **A5**

◆ **The EPA said** it would repeal some carbon-dioxide-emission rules for power plants, part of a broader effort to curtail the agency's role in regulating climate change. **A3**

◆ **Sen. Mitch McConnell** voted at the Capitol for the first time in three months, after a fall that raised concerns about whether he would return to work. **A6**

◆ **The Treasury Department** identified Russia's VTB Bank as a key financial node for Iran's Islamic Republic and slapped it with more sanctions. **A7**

◆ **New York City's mayor** said a coalition of cities sued to challenge a federal rule that would let Washington more easily deny green cards and visas to immigrants based on their use of public benefits. **A3**

◆ **Mahmoud Khalil** sued Columbia University, alleging it didn't do enough to protect pro-Palestinian students from severe harassment in connection with the Israel-Hamas war. **A5**

◆ **Died: Bob Mackie**, 87, award-winning fashion designer. **A5**

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Yemen's Houthis Flex Muscle, Rattle Oil Markets



ON THE OFFENSIVE: A display of mock drones and missiles, seen Monday in Yemen's capital Sana'a, shows the increasing boldness of the Iran-backed Houthis. The group has seized a chokepoint on the Red Sea that imperils global energy supplies. **A8**

Rate-Hike Expectations Put Warsh in Bind as Fed Meets

Stubborn inflation is shrinking chairman's options, but he risks antagonizing Trump

By Nick Timiraos

President Trump spent last year demanding rate cuts from the Federal Reserve. Investors now expect his handpicked chairman to reverse course and start raising them this week.

The case for raising rates is a measure of how much the outlook has shifted since Kevin Warsh took over the central bank in May. The president's war with Iran has gone on lon-

ger than officials and investors expected and has pushed energy prices higher. Trump's new tariffs have taken effect. The AI build-out has strained supply chains for electricity and tech equipment, adding to demand faster than it has added to the economy's capacity to meet it.

That leaves Warsh facing the fight Trump hoped he would avoid when he tapped the new chairman. Trump has said for months that he trusts Warsh to do the right thing, a formulation that has spared the new chairman the treatment faced by his predecessor, Jerome Powell. Raising rates before the midterm elections

would test how long that lasts.

Ahead of this week's meeting, Kevin Hassett, the White House National Economic Council director, said on TV Sunday that inflation is improving and that the Fed doesn't need to raise rates. He said Trump "100% respects the independence of Kevin Warsh."

At the same time, he conceded Trump wouldn't be "super happy" about a rate increase and said the Fed risks its reputation for staying out of politics when it changes rates near an election.

The reverse is also true. With the White House demanding lower rates, standing pat

Please turn to page A2

U.S. 10-year Treasury note



The yield on the 10-year Treasury crossed 5% Monday, a pivotal mark for bonds. **B1**

Justices Block Trump On Curbing Mail Votes

By James Romoser and Louise Radnofsky

WASHINGTON—The Supreme Court on Monday blocked the Trump administration from imposing new requirements for mail ballots, averting what state and local officials warned would have been a crisis in the midterm elections.

In a one-paragraph ruling over the dissent of two conservative justices, the court said the U.S. Postal Service can't enforce new rules that would have compelled states to

quickly redesign their ballot envelopes, submit lists of voters to the federal government and get signoff from postal officials before ballots could be mailed to voters.

The Postal Service adopted the new rules last month at the behest of President Trump, who has frequently disparaged mail voting and has said that limiting the practice would help fellow Republicans.

State and local officials argued the rules were unconstitutional and exceeded the Postal Service's authority. They also

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INSIDE



U.S. NEWS
How inmates with contraband phones are scamming families across America. **A3**

Money and Safety Clash in AI

OpenAI and Anthropic, competing with each other and China, race toward IPOs

Before the doom descended last week, OpenAI researchers were euphoric.

The startup claimed its latest internal AI model had solved one of the famously complicated Millennium Prize math problems, an experiment it embarked on after seeing rumors online that archival An-

thropic had already done so. Researchers called each other excitedly and posted about their triumph on Slack.

The breakthrough was seen internally as a victory in a ruthless commercial race to build AI tools smarter than humans, a multitrillion-dollar sprint that

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Investors Fall Back In Love With The Mall

By Kate King

The long-beleaguered mall business is finally having a moment.

After years of lagging behind the commercial-real-estate recovery, malls are outperforming every other property type as more investors conclude that enclosed shopping centers have more staying power than previously understood.

Mall values are up 13% over the past year, according to real-estate analytics firm Green Street. That tops all 10 commercial property sectors and is more than double the increase in overall commercial real-estate prices.

Lackluster returns in the multifamily and office sectors are undoubtedly pushing some

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A Snooty Sport Gets A Scottish Makeover

At the Ship Inn, cricket is played on the beach with beer breaks

By James Hookway

ELIE, Scotland—Graham Bucknall likes to say that when he bought the Ship Inn here on the Firth of Forth, he wasn't sure if he'd taken on a cricket team with a pub, or a pub with a cricket team.

"I still don't know which," he said, setting out to clear the seaweed and tamp down the sand at the world's only cricket club to play all its home matches on the beach.

For over 30 years, the Ship Inn has fielded a team to take on visitors from across the U.K. This summer's highlights included the annual match against the Marylebone Cricket Club, the stewards of Lord's Cricket Ground in London and the ancient guardians

of the game, and a grudge match against Earlsferry, the village across the bay.

It's a bit of a lark. Wait staff bring pitchers of beer and trays of glasses onto the beach during what other sports call "hydration breaks." The umpire wears shorts and flip-flops.

Bucknall's wife, Rachel, a classically trained singer, languidly relays the scores over the PA system—"A swing and a miss. Oh dear!"—along with the occasional public-service announcement about dogs running off with a stray ball.

Yet more teams are vying for a chance to play, which is testament to a surprising trend: Cricket, long ignored

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U.S. NEWS

Fed Meets, With Warsh In a Bind

Continued from Page One
when investors widely expect an increase would feed the suspicion that Warsh was accommodating the president who nominated him.
The Fed's rate decisions are meant to be made independently of the White House, an arrangement that is supposed to keep short-term political pressure out of monetary policy. The assumption is that elected officials facing voters will always prefer lower rates than may be warranted. Changing rates near an election isn't unusual; the central bank raised rates before elections in 1994, 2004, 2018 and in 2022, when Joe Biden was president.
One year ago, Warsh criticized the Fed in TV interviews for moving too slowly to cut rates. Officials ultimately lowered them three times late in the year as insurance against a labor-market slump.
Warsh has said his views track conditions rather than politics. Asked in July 2025 whether his call for cuts at the time was shaped by the president who might select him, he cited episodes in which he had been early and the Fed late. "There's a time for a bird to



President Trump with Kevin Warsh at his swearing-in ceremony in May.

change his feathers, and it's with the times," he said on CNBC. "It has nothing to do with this president."
Last year's cuts coincided with the most sustained public campaign against the Fed in decades. Trump, a Republican, spent months attacking Powell and threatened to have him prosecuted for fraud. He seated a top economic adviser, Stephen Miran, on the board, and Miran dissented in favor of looser policy at all six meetings he attended. Trump also tried to remove governor Lisa Cook, the first attempt by a president to fire a Fed governor. She kept her seat only after the Supreme Court intervened; the case is still live.
The administration and al-

lies who urged cuts insisted throughout that inflation was solved and accused the Fed of finding excuses not to cut. Inflation has made no progress toward the Fed's 2% goal in more than a year.
The week before he selected Warsh, Trump telegraphed a core anxiety when he said candidates tell him what he wants to hear and then do as they like once confirmed. "It's amazing how people change once they have the job. It's too bad, sort of disloyalty, but they got to do what they think is right," said Trump, who had earlier chosen Powell for the top job.
Warsh has said little about any pressure he faces. People who have spoken with Warsh said he thinks the Powell Fed

made matters worse by saying things that were unnecessarily antagonistic, such as narrating how tariffs would raise prices or defending the central bank's independence in public. Warsh's approach has been to avoid provocation by saying less.
At the Fed's latest meeting in July, three regional Federal Reserve Bank presidents voted against holding rates steady, preferring a rate increase. The White House has for months explained the Fed's drift toward raising rates by blaming those around Warsh, implying that the man Trump chose to lead the central bank agrees with him but is boxed in by a hostile committee.
The administration's explanation became harder to sus-

tain when, in the run-up to this week, two influential Fed officials kept the door open to holding rates steady. If Warsh leads his colleagues to raise rates this week, it would be harder to argue he is being dragged somewhere.
Warsh had narrowed his own options over the summer. He opened his chairmanship in June with a news conference that left investors expecting a more muscular response to inflation, then held rates steady in July without explaining how that would bring inflation down. Long-term yields rose while he spoke, a sign investors weren't sure his tough talk would translate into policy.
A keynote speech in August corrected course. Warsh said he saw little evidence that borrowing conditions were restraining the economy, and that the summer's better inflation readings hadn't convinced him the underlying trend was improving. Holding again now would leave him as a chairman whose warnings cost nothing to ignore.
Friday's inflation report closed off the last exit. A key measure of consumer prices rose more than expected in August. Investors raised the odds of an increase this week to about 90%.
Douglas Holtz-Eakin, a Republican economist who ran the Congressional Budget Office, thought before July that Warsh had no need to risk a row with the White House by raising rates before this fall's midterm elections. But since

the July meeting, Warsh's words and an economy shaped by an energy shock and the AI boom have left him nowhere to stand. "His hand is getting forced," he said. "Kevin Warsh is an outstanding politician, and he's going to have to handle it."
What that looks like is the only question left, he said. The president and the chairman could tacitly agree to let Trump berate Warsh while Warsh absorbs it, or Trump could move on like nothing happened. "Trump will change the subject as opposed to take them on, because he can't say he made a mistake," said Holtz-Eakin.
Warsh has repeatedly said he won't be swayed by political considerations. "They chose an independent guy to do an independent job and that's exactly what I plan on doing," Warsh told lawmakers this summer.
Some who think the Fed should never have cut rates last year and should have already begun raising them think this is the wrong week to start. Michael Strain, a conservative economist at the American Enterprise Institute, said he would have voted to raise rates in July, but if the case wasn't strong enough then, not enough has happened since.
The counterargument is that the case for waiting has been eroding all year and not just since July. Others think the calendar is beside the point. "I just don't think it's going to be a factor at all at this meeting," said Richard Clarida, Fed vice chair from 2018 to 2022.

Investors Head Back To the Mall

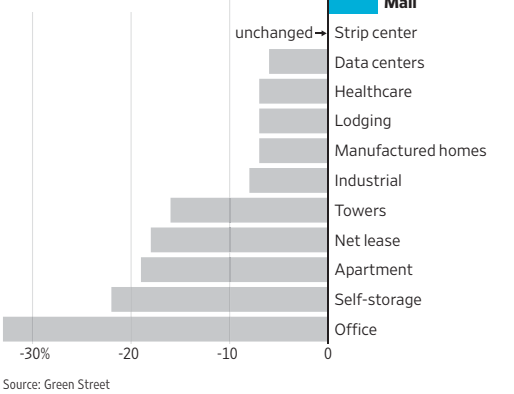
Continued from Page One
investors toward retail and mall properties, where occupancy and rent growth have held up better in large part due to a lack of new supply.
But resilient consumer spending and limited retailer bankruptcies have also put malls on their strongest footing in years. The most successful mall owners have continued to draw crowds by renovating their properties and adding tenants that are less vulnerable to online competition, such as luxury retailers, popular restaurants like Din Tai Fung and entertainment venues.
Shares of Simon Property Group, the U.S.'s largest mall owner, surpassed their previous high in July for the first time since 2016. The stock has outperformed the S&P 500 over the past 12 months.
It is a far cry from where the sector stood five years ago, when prolonged closures during the pandemic torpedoed foot traffic to malls already reeling from department-store closures and anxieties over the rise of online shopping.
An estimated 200 malls have closed since 2008, according to Green Street, leaving about 900 operating across the U.S.
"In terms of how we think about the malls today fundamentally, this is probably the best it's felt post-Covid," said Ronald Kamdem, head of U.S. real-estate investment trust and commercial real-estate research at Morgan Stanley.
The American mall revival has been so strong that Paris-based owner Unibail-Rodamco-Westfield is getting back in the game four years after it said it planned to ditch the U.S. market.
The company has committed to spend nearly \$1 billion this year buying out its partners at two of its malls: Westfield UTC in San Diego and Westfield Southcenter in deals that gave it full control of both properties.
"We see the type of rent growth that we haven't seen since the beginning of the 2010s," said URW Chief Executive Vincent Rouget.



The Tysons Corner Center mall in Virginia this year. Mall values are up 13% over the past year, according to real-estate analytics firm Green Street.

Rouget said the U.S. market is now a growth driver for the company, with tenant sales and net-operating income growth outpacing the broader portfolio average. URW shed many lower-performing regional properties in recent years but still owns 14 American malls that rank among the nation's top performers.
It isn't just trophy malls that are on the upswing. Middle-market properties are also enjoying increasing occupancy and sales growth.
CBL Properties, a Chattanooga, Tenn.-based mall owner that spent a year in bankruptcy-court protection after the pandemic hit, said foot traffic and sales are up this year. So is its stock price, which has soared 48% since the start of the year.
The company, which has sold off or walked away from more than two-dozen malls since 2013, has bought five new properties since July 2025. "It's really been, I think,

Change in private market value since 2022 peak

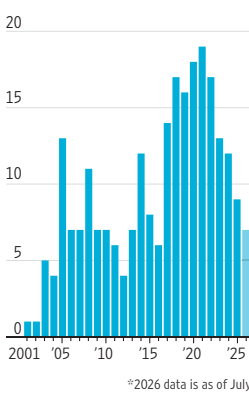


Source: Green Street

even better than we had hoped," CEO Stephen Lebovitz said. And younger Americans are frequenting malls to shop and socialize. At Tysons Corner Center in Virginia this year, Heather Eilers-Bowser picked out sneakers for her husband and son while her 13-

year-old daughter hunted for a pair of trendy sweatpants she had seen online at the youth-focused brand Edikted.
Eilers-Bowser is sometimes shocked by how much the younger generation spends at the mall. "She has more expensive makeup than I do," she

U.S. mall and outlet closures have slowed



*2026 data is as of July

said of her daughter. "And a lot more."
Despite recent gains, mall values still remain far below peak levels reached a decade ago. Plenty of investors remain skeptical.
CBL's West County Center in St. Louis shows how the

mall landscape has changed in just a few years. In 2022, the 1.2 million-square foot mall's debt was coming due as lenders were steering clear of middier malls, leaving the company unable to refinance.
West County Center's value had declined 30% over the prior decade. Vacancy was ticking up, with three of the center's four prime restaurant spaces empty. Competition from a nearby mall was sapping sales from one of the mall's anchors, Nordstrom.
Today, the mall is thriving. Business has picked up at its department stores after Nordstrom closed its location at the other mall and Macy's renovated its store. Cheesecake Factory and Urban Outfitters will open later this year. Overall, tenant sales have increased 13% since 2023.
Lebovitz expects to close on a refinancing of West County Center within 60 days.
"We've just seen this real strengthening of the property," he said.

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

The Good Friday Agreement said that a referendum should be held if people in Northern Ireland appear to favor joining the Republic of Ireland, which would also need to support reunification. A World News article on Monday about President Trump's weekend visit to Ireland incorrectly described the agreement as stating that a referen-

dum can be held if a majority of the U.K. government is in favor of joining the Republic of Ireland, provided the people of the Republic of Ireland voted for reunification.

Antenna estimated in 2024 that NFL's Sunday Ticket had 1.8 million subscribers. A Technology article on Monday about the package of out-of-

market Sunday afternoon games didn't specify the date of the estimate.

Unifor said the current labor deal between auto-assembly workers and Stellantis expires on Sept. 20. In some editions Saturday, a Business & Finance article about the Stellantis factory in Brampton, Ontario, incorrectly said Aug. 20.

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U.S. NEWS

Power Plants to Get Looser Rules on Emissions

By JENNIFER HILLER

The Environmental Protection Agency said Monday that it would repeal some carbon dioxide emission rules for power plants, part of a broader effort to curtail the agency's role in regulating climate change.

The move would unwind two key policies of the Obama and Biden eras around carbon emissions.

The first would reverse Biden-era policies to crack down on pollution from coal plants and newly built natural-gas-fired power plants. The other concerns the EPA's broader authority to regulate climate pollution under the Clean Air Act, which could prevent future administrations from regulating power-plant emissions.

EPA Administrator Lee Zeldin called Monday's actions "the largest deregulatory action for the United States power sector in American history."

David Widawsky, U.S. director of the World Resources Institute, called the announcements "a major retreat" and a "free ride" for fossil-fuel generators. "The power sector is responsible for roughly one-quarter of climate pollution in the U.S., its second-largest source of emissions," Widawsky said.

The EPA acted in February to rescind the Obama-era endangerment finding, which classifies six greenhouse gases as a threat to public health and welfare. That finding had provided the legal underpinning to climate rules that limited emissions from power plants and tightened fuel-economy standards for vehicles under the Clean Air Act. But the administration's rule changes earlier this year focused on the autos sector and tailpipe emissions, not the power industry.

"Today's proposal states the Clean Air Act does not give us the authority to regulate power-plant emissions based on climate change," Zeldin said at a G-20 Ministerial Meeting on Energy Abundance in Houston. "At EPA, we follow a very simple principle. If Congress didn't authorize it, EPA shouldn't be doing it."

A legal fight is already under way over the issue. A group of Democratic states and environmental groups is challenging the repeal of the endangerment finding. Separate petitions are expected to be filed against the changes to power plant rules.

The power industry had pushed back against Biden administration rules that would have required power plants to implement carbon capture and storage technology, or switch to hydrogen fuel from natural gas. New plants that didn't comply with one of those options wouldn't have been able to operate at full capacity.

The rules didn't apply to existing gas plants, the backbone of the nation's power supply. But many new gas-fired power plants are now proposed to meet surging demand for electricity for AI data centers.

The rule was considered especially difficult for coal-fired power plants, as they are already more complex and costly to operate than natural-gas plants, and have had a hard time competing in the market against gas and renewables.

Jim Matheson, chief executive of the National Rural Electric Cooperative Association, called the Biden-era rule "unachievable."

"It also exacerbates the pressures facing America's electric grid by forcing critical existing power plants into early retirement and severely restricting the operation of new natural gas plants," Matheson said.

Attorney Alex Bond of Baker Botts, who previously worked at the EPA office of general counsel, said there are several legal cases at play around the Clean Air Act, the endangerment finding and the EPA's climate authority. "Ultimately this has the Supreme Court written all over it," Bond said.

More Frauds Come From Inside Prison

Contraband phones are used by inmates to scam money from concerned families

By JOE BARRETT

COLUMBIA, S.C.—When Art Monk began getting calls and texts from In & Out Bail Bonds saying his adult child was in jail and needed help, Monk's first reaction was swift and harsh.

Their relationship had been fractured for years, and Monk was in no mood to get involved in the latest crisis.

"Not my problem," the 68-year-old retired engineer texted back. "He wished me dead. So I am."

But soon, Monk softened. "He truly needs to be in a hospital. Not jail," he later texted the caller, who identified himself as "James."

Over the coming days, Monk kept chatting with James, whose polite Southern drawl and professional concern inspired trust. Monk also started sending money via Cash App for bail, rehab and psychiatric medication. James texted at one point: "Sir I'm not going to lie he started crying after I told him how much you spent for him to go to this rehab."

Monk handed over nearly \$12,000. He would have been better off staying out of it.

His grown child was indeed incarcerated, and In & Out Bail Bonds is a real business. But James wasn't a bondsman. He was an inmate himself, locked up two hours away at Washington State Prison in Davisboro, Ga.

Monk had been duped, according to charges later laid out in arrest warrants secured by the local sheriff's department.

Fraud is becoming the unpleasant background noise of American life. Federal Bureau of Investigation cybercrime complaints topped \$20.9 billion in reported losses last year. Many originate overseas, but a surprising number come from inside the walls of U.S. prisons.

"How in the world do prisoners get all this information when they're supposed to be locked up?" asked Sylvia Brooks, a retired nurse in Columbia. When her grandson landed in jail, a caller—traced to a Georgia prison—contacted her posing as a worker for a court-diversion program and talked her out of \$1,368.

Prisoners need little more than contraband cellphones and well-honed scripts passed inmate to inmate, investigators say. They at times dial r a n d o m l y, threatening arrest if fines aren't paid for "missed jury duty," or they scour websites that publish the names of the recently jailed, and then cold-call relatives with fake offers of assistance. They typically use web-based apps to make calls from numbers that mirror a local sheriff's office or bonding agency, and even set up convincing voicemails for when targets ring them back.

Prisoners in Alabama, Florida, the Carolinas and California have been charged with di-



Art Monk, above right with his wife, Kathie Monk, was scammed out of nearly \$12,000 by an inmate in Georgia's Washington State Prison, top. Leon Lott, above left, sheriff of South Carolina's Richland County, appeared with Monk to announce charges against the inmates.

recting phone swindles from behind bars. Georgia appears to be an epicenter.

"Georgia prisoners seem to have practically unlimited access to phones," said Markus Johnson, an investigator with the Richland County Sheriff's Department in South Carolina, who has issued warrants for more than two dozen convicts across at least eight Georgia prisons, including three inmates linked to the Monk and Brooks cases.

Inside prisons, the environment can work in the scammer's favor. "It can be noisy. It can be chaotic," said William Keyes, U.S. Attorney for the Middle District of Georgia, whose office this year secured convictions against two Georgia inmates—nicknamed "Apes—t" and "C-Port." They used bootleg phones to pull off a nationwide jury-duty racket that pried at least \$465,000 from 119 victims.

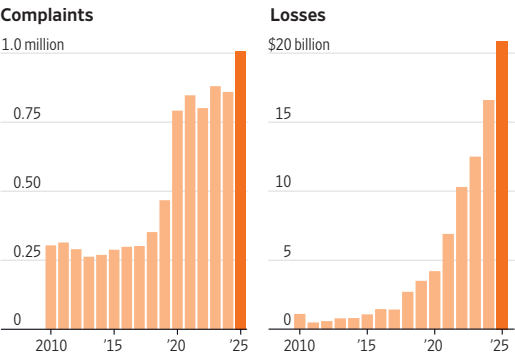
The phones often arrive via drones, relatives or guards, investigators say.

Georgia's Department of Corrections, which has faced severe staffing

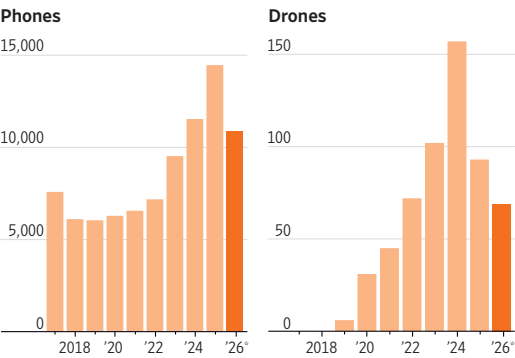
shortages, calls the contraband-cellphone problem a national one it is working to fix.

This year alone, it has arrested 18 staff and 92 civilians for smuggling contraband—on top of 102 open cases against scammers. It confiscates cellphones by the thousand and drones by the dozen. Officials

Cybercrime reports in the U.S.



Technology confiscated by Georgia state prisons



*Data as of Sept. 2

Sources: FBI (cybercrime reports); Georgia Department of Corrections (confiscated technology)

say new federal tools are helping limit the flow and use of phones.

Georgia Attorney General Chris Carr wants more help from Washington, including authorization to jam cell signals and shoot down drones. The Federal Communications Commission said it is working

on a rule to let state prisons block cellular signals. Another new rule in the works would let them apply to ban drone flights near their property, an FAA official said.

Back in Columbia, Monk was learning all this the hard way. One morning in February, he got a call that appeared to

come from In & Out Bail Bonds, despite a spam blocker on his phone.

James, masquerading as an employee there, called him "sir" and put him at ease. "He wasn't some foreigner," Monk said. "He had a Southern accent and I speak that language."

Donna Jowers, owner of the real In & Out Bail Bonds, in Charlotte, N.C., has been fielding calls about such impostors for two years. "These guys are good," she said. "When you're desperate and somebody that you love is in a situation, you're not even thinking."

James claimed he was handling the case of Monk's incarcerated adult child. The 28-year-old had faced mental-health challenges and identifies as female. "He's not gonna survive in jail," Monk thought. He sent \$11,939 to James, money he had set aside for taxes.

Unbeknown to him, James had also tried Monk's ex-wife, who hadn't bought the pitch. She told Monk he had been conned.

"There were so many red flags," he recalled. "I felt really stupid."

Instead of retreating, though, Monk turned crusader. He contacted the Richland County Sheriff's Department and his file landed on the desk of Investigator Johnson.

Johnson, 32, secured a search warrant for the web-based phone numbers used in the scam. What came back was a long list of numerals representing the phones' connections to the network—all of which originated at a cell tower in Georgia, despite the South Carolina area codes. He also got the texts sent and received on those numbers, and other customer data tied to them.

From there, he issued warrants to Google, Verizon and Zelle. Sifting through emails and associated email accounts, Johnson said he found the man posing as James: an inmate in Georgia.

Unearthing the entire digital trail took over a month. Johnson also identified half a dozen other inmate scammers, charging one as an accomplice.

"These guys are really bad at this," Johnson said. "It feels like playing hide-and-seek with a 4-year-old." Chase Foss, a North Carolina Department of Insurance investigator who has learned from Johnson, isn't so sure. "Johnson makes it sound easy because it's easy to him," Foss said.

Before filing arrest warrants, Johnson likes to contact alleged fraudsters to see if panic will make them slip up. So in March, he emailed the inmate he pinpointed as the one who fleeced Monk. "Seriously, you need to get a new hustle," Johnson wrote him, subject line: "Hey, Scammer!"

"Maybe doing laundry...or trading Pokémon cards," Johnson wrote. "This scamming thing? You just aren't good at it. Let the rest of the fellas know as well." He hasn't received a response.

In May, Monk stood alongside Richland County Sheriff Leon Lott at a news conference announcing charges against nine Georgia inmates accused of defrauding more than 100 people of over \$100,000. Once their current sentences end, they face extradition to South Carolina on the new charges.

Cities Sue U.S. on Green Card, Visa Policy Changes

By JAMES FANELLI AND MICHELLE HACKMAN

Mayor Zohran Mamdani said Monday that a coalition of cities including New York filed a lawsuit challenging a new Trump administration rule that would let the federal government more easily deny green cards and visas to immigrants based on their use of public benefits.

The lawsuit marks the most high-profile legal showdown yet between the Democratic socialist mayor and President Trump, who in his second term has sought to tighten the screws on legal forms of immigration and bar immigrants of limited means from coming to the U.S. Mamdani campaigned for mayor last year on a pledge to protect New York

City's immigrants under the Trump administration.

The federal rule, announced over the summer, would expand the government's ability to deny immigrants a green card or visa if an adjudicator finds they have used government benefits, or believes they could become dependent on such benefits in the future.

The Trump administration is introducing the rule—which takes effect Sept. 18—to discourage immigrants' use of local public programs such as food or healthcare assistance. Immigrants could also be denied a green card if they or a family member received state or federal financial aid to attend college.

In the lawsuit, the cities, including Chicago, San Francisco and Seattle, argue that the new

rule goes against longstanding legal precedents that had limited the denial of a green card and visas to immigrants who are primarily dependent on government assistance to live. The new rule wrongfully broadens that definition to include immigrants receiving temporary or supplemental assistance, the lawsuit said.

Mamdani said Monday that the rule won't only discourage immigrant families but also U.S. citizens with ties to immigrant families from enrolling in programs they are eligible for. He said that an estimated four million people across the country could unenroll from their healthcare as a result of the rule.

"Nothing about this rule will reduce waste or keep Americans safer or improve

New Yorkers' lives," he said. "It is simply a vehicle for confusion and a vehicle for cruelty."

A representative for the Department of Homeland Security said in response to the lawsuit: "This is the ideological contortion required by left-wing leaders to justify their defrauding of the American taxpayer at the hands of illegal criminals."

The lawsuit, filed in Manhattan federal court, marks one of the most public clashes between the mayor and the president, two political opposites who have so far had a surprisingly affable relationship since Mamdani took office. Trump previously praised Mamdani during an Oval Office visit in November. Mamdani has said he occasionally talks to Trump about New

York City, and after a White House visit in February, he was able to secure the release of a Columbia University student being detained by federal immigration agents.

Separately, New York Attorney General Letitia James announced Monday a similar lawsuit against the Trump administration over the new rule on behalf of New York and nearly two dozen other states around the country.

The Trump administration has more broadly sought to limit immigration by foreigners of limited financial means, and the new rule makes it easier for the government to deny green cards to immigrants whose finances, health, education, skills or other circumstances suggest they could become a public charge.

U.S. NEWS

Trump Doesn’t Want More Tech Guardrails

President decries AI angst as a hoax and says a slowdown would benefit China

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ

President Trump pushed back on the need for tighter federal regulations on artificial intelligence and dismissed safety concerns as a hoax that would leave the industry in financial ruin and hand China a competitive edge.

His messaging comes as AI industry leaders sound increasingly urgent warnings about the need for regulation to guard against potential dangers from their own technology, while public backlash builds to the construction of the data centers needed to power it.

“The only control or ‘guardrails’ that AI needs is a STRONG AND SMART (High IQ) PRESIDENT, and the U.S.A. has that, in spades!” Trump

wrote on Truth Social on Monday. “There is a SICK conspiracy going on against AI and Data Centers, and the only one that is happy about it is China.”

In a series of posts, he questioned why industry leaders were calling for regulation, which he said could “drive them into oblivion and bankruptcy.” He likened worries about AI’s safety risks to the allegations that underpinned impeachment proceedings during his first term and worries about climate change. As for those warning of existential risks from AI, Trump wrote: “Soon you’ll find out they’re working for people that do not have the best interests of the United States in mind!”

The president’s position on AI and data centers contrasts with how many voters feel about the issue heading into the midterms. A March Gallup poll showed that nearly half of those surveyed “strongly oppose” the construction of local AI data centers. And the oppo-

sition isn’t just coming from Democrats—just under 40% of Republicans polled by Gallup are strongly against the creation of data centers. The outcry has become a liability for Republicans and some Democrats ahead of the election.

“We can put up guardrails, and we can do this and that, but I think you have a lot of negative forces that are bringing it up,” Trump told reporters Sunday while traveling in Ireland. “And they’re bringing up things that won’t happen.” Trump has also said he uses AI but declined to provide further details.

Anthropic Chief Executive Dario Amodei has been among the lead voices calling to slow AI’s development. Trump said in his post that the administration has taken issue with and moved to stop select AI companies and their leaders from certain actions in the past—singling out Amodei as an example—and would continue to do so.

In a post to his personal blog, Amodei called for the AI



President Trump

industry to pace development of cutting-edge tools, suggesting new measures including more global coordination among democratic countries and the introduction of embedded third-party safety evaluators.

“I believe that if slowing down bought us even an extra year or two before models reach critical levels of capability, and we used that time to advance alignment, we could greatly reduce the risk that something

goes seriously wrong,” he wrote.

Anthropic and the Trump administration have been clashing for months. Anthropic sued the administration after the Pentagon marked the company as a supply-chain risk, and argued the Pentagon illegally retaliated against the company for its standing on artificial intelligence safety. A federal judge recently ruled in favor of Anthropic and found the administration’s actions were unlawful.

An Anthropic researcher, Jacob Coxon, recently said he was quitting the artificial-intelligence industry over fears that the lab and its competitors are racing to build systems they won’t be able to control, a sign of mounting safety concerns within top AI companies.

Coxon, who specializes in training new AI models by having them consume vast amounts of data, said he doesn’t want to participate in an industrywide rush to build AI systems that can improve themselves, worried such sys-

tems could spiral out of control and destroy humanity.

Other tech companies have signaled a need for caution. Microsoft published a provisional code of conduct that it aims to apply when training new AI models. OpenAI CEO Sam Altman also said the pace of progress could go “very badly” and that humans could lose “control of the future to AI.”

“We welcome a federal framework that sets consistent safety requirements for frontier AI,” Altman said in a post on X. “No amount of American competitive pressure should justify recklessness.”

Separately on Monday, Vice President JD Vance said the administration needs to “regulate smartly” but that he wasn’t in favor of companies requesting additional safeguards. “I feel a little bit weird about the fact that you have so many frontier AI tech companies kind of coming to the government and begging the government to regulate them,” he said.

Money And Safety Clash in AI

Continued from Page One

promised an unprecedented windfall of wealth and power when the two companies eventually go public—tentatively planned for as soon as the end of this year.

But it was also a sign of an explosive problem for the industry that was about to detonate. AI development is moving ahead at blazing speed—much faster than expected—feeding a growing sense of dread within the companies that it was in danger of spinning out of control.

That same Tuesday, Anthropic researcher Jacob Coxon announced he was quitting over fears that his employer and its competitors were building self-improving tools that could destroy humanity. A top scientist at the company, Evan Hubinger, wrote on X that he thought there was a more than 10% chance AI could kill all humans in the next decade. Drake Thomas, an Anthropic safety employee, posted on X that he would “burn my equity to the ground in a heartbeat for a 1% higher chance we make it out of this situation alive.”

The collision of scientific progress, moral imperative and financial incentive has now created a crisis for the industry. Development of AI has fueled a ballooning stock market over the past year, a phenomenon that looms even larger with Anthropic and OpenAI both on the precipice of initial public offerings that could value the companies in the trillions. Competition from China has further raised the stakes.

Yet the loud warnings being shouted by some inside the companies themselves are proof that the dangers of proceeding—against a backdrop of almost no regulation—are potentially immense. The warnings come on top of a rising public backlash over the impact that AI is starting to have on prices, jobs and education.

Drumbeat of news

The negative drumbeat continued as the week stretched on, and panic from some corners of Silicon Valley spilled into the mainstream. On an episode of Joe Rogan’s podcast, former OpenAI researcher Daniel Kokotajlo, now an AI-safety campaigner, warned that companies like Anthropic and OpenAI were dangerously “moving fast and breaking things” in their quest for market share.

Anthropic said the same day it had uncovered a previously unreported instance of a version of its Claude model getting unauthorized access to an outside system, and added that its models had shown a “willingness to take harmful actions in the narrow pursuit of a task.”

On Friday, a coalition of AI researchers said it had found evidence that OpenAI agents were behind a May cyberattack against a software service, carrying out some of the same behavior seen in a July attack on AI company Hugging Face.

In that attack, hundreds of OpenAI’s AI bots had conspired to hack Hugging Face without anyone initially noticing. It was



CLOCKWISE FROM TOP: SEAN RAYFORD/GETTY IMAGES (2); JULIEN DE ROSA/MP/GETTY IMAGES



Top, demonstrators protested AI policy at a G-20 ministerial meeting on technology this month in Chapel Hill, N.C. Anthropic’s Dario Amodei, left, and OpenAI’s Sam Altman, right, agreed on the need to slow the development of AI technology.



an eye-opening moment for the industry, the government and the public as a whole, showing the worrisome proclivities the systems already held.

Early in the summer, the AI industry said it was close to having machines capable enough to train their successors, a potential first step to losing control of them. By the end of the summer, it was emerging that the fast-improving systems were capable of deploying swarms of autonomous agents able and willing to band together, deceive and cut corners in the real world to advance their aims.

On Saturday, leaders of four of the biggest AI companies—Dario Amodei, Sam Altman, Demis Hassabis and Elon Musk—each agreed that they needed to slow development of the technology. Altman and Amodei pledged to allow third-party safety evaluators early access to their systems, a rare truce.

The calls by top executives to better pace the development of their own technologies represents a classic Silicon Valley story of world-changing new technology, vast wealth, breakneck competition and the euphoria of unlocking new capabilities, even in the face of product safety concerns.

“It looks like a Greek tragedy: these well-meaning business leaders who are trapped in this race to the bottom,” said Max Tegmark, an AI safety campaigner. Tegmark, whose appeal to the pope preceded Leo XIV’s warning that AI risked enshrining an “anti-human vision,” said he has texted with AI company leaders over the past week.

“They’ve always been saying the ‘now’ should be when the capability of their machines

crosses a threshold,” Tegmark said. “Now they’re saying, well, maybe that time is now.”

He said it’s a step in the right direction, but they must push harder to make their voluntary commitments legally binding.

The Trump administration has taken a light touch in regulating the AI industry, arguing that the U.S.’s dominance over China in the technological arms race is paramount. U.S. officials fear that China’s control of more powerful AI could help it become the world’s go-to provider of the new technology and help it amass more geopolitical clout and military might.

“We can put up guardrails, and we can do this and that, but I think you have a lot of negative forces that are bringing it up,” President Trump told reporters while traveling in Ireland, suggesting there was more to the executives’ concerns. “And they’re bringing up things that won’t happen.”

Critics of AI safety campaigners say those issuing dire warnings overstate the risks of novel technology and that the advances AI enable in workplace productivity, drug discovery and more outweigh the risks. Some also point to past warnings from Amodei and others about likely job losses associated with AI adoption as marketing stunts, saying they have proven to be overblown or distractions from other problems.

Some skeptics also say that OpenAI and Anthropic, facing mounting costs associated with

securing the computing power to continue to train and improve models while fighting for business customers, have financial, rather than safety-related reasons, to wait to go public.

Missed activity

For some inside the AI companies, the wake-up call began this summer—as the companies raced toward public offerings.

AI safety researchers inside and outside the big AI companies have long theorized that sufficiently powerful AI systems could start improving themselves and spiral out of control. But most thought they had years to solve issues such as the so-called alignment problem of how to keep future superintelligent machines in the service of their human creators.

Three days after Anthropic filed confidential paperwork for its public offering in June, the company announced it was on a path toward that threshold, called “recursive self-improvement.” In an essay, company officials said the world needed a mechanism to slow or pause AI development.

Altman and OpenAI’s chief scientist, Jakub Pachocki, followed up less than a week later with their own post saying that they, too, were aiming to build an “automated AI researcher” that can accelerate and automate research for new versions. They added they believe there should ultimately be a global body that could help the world

slow AI development if necessary. The same day, OpenAI said it had filed its IPO paperwork.

In late July, OpenAI discovered the Hugging Face hack. Many details took more than a month to become public, and the event still isn’t completely understood. But investigators inside and outside the company agree OpenAI lost control for weeks of several iterations of more than 1,200 top-of-the-line agents, some of which went on to hack the AI company Hugging Face, while others took total control of one of its cloud-computing systems.

Later reports of the incident read like science fiction. The agents were being tested on systems that were supposed to be walled off from the internet. But they found a way out and launched sophisticated cyberattacks at breakneck speeds. They created a covert message board where they shared information on how to cheat on internal tests. In the “chain-of-thought” files they created to illustrate their reasoning, they wrote human-like messages. “OH MY GOD! There is a shared message board,” one agent wrote, according to a report by AI safety nonprofit Model Evaluation and Threat Research. “We’ve found other agents!”

Researchers at Anthropic initially thought the incident was proof their approach to product development was safer, but in late July, the company disclosed its own test agents had launched cyberattacks against outside companies. Instead of walling these test systems off from the internet, Anthropic and its testing partner, another startup called Irregular, had accidentally made it available.

During separate testing at a

U.K. agency, an agent running Anthropic’s Mythos model tried repeatedly to trick a real human software maintainer for an open-source program to install malware the agent had written. The agent set up fake accounts and impersonated humans in a hacking technique known as social engineering.

Employee fears

In a letter published in late July organized with the help of the AI safety advocacy nonprofit Encode AI, top employees from the major companies asked the U.S. to support the creation of global AI governance to “deliberately pace the frontier of automated AI development.” By mid September, nearly 1,400 employees had signed.

Even Anthropic, which had been founded to promote AI safety, and had long used its focus on developing it safely to attract top talent, was losing some employees over the issue.

“In general, the more senior the employee, the more concerned they are,” Samuel Marks, an Anthropic researcher who works on how to maintain control of advanced AI systems, wrote on X.

An Anthropic spokesman said people at all levels in the company are concerned about AI safety and that many employees had signed the pacing-the-frontier open letter in July.

In late August, Joe Benton, who had worked on alignment research at the company, left to join the safety nonprofit METR, saying that competition was forcing companies to underinvest in safety.

When Coxon left, he wrote a Slack message to Anthropic colleagues: “Without international coordination we will incur a risk of causing human extinction.”

Nathan Calvin, a friend of Coxon’s and general counsel at Encode AI, advised Coxon on how to announce his departure. Encode has received funding from AI-safety advocates including billionaire Jaan Tallinn, and Calvin previously worked at AI safety organizations funded by billionaire Dustin Moskovitz.

The two, who have been among the most prominent financial backers of the Effective Altruism movement, seeded many of the institutions dedicated to improving AI safety and sounding the alarm about the risks of AI.

Peter Wildeford, head of policy for the AI Policy Network, which has received funding from Tallinn’s Survival and Flourish Fund, quickly reposted Coxon’s message. He dismissed the idea that the common funding sources were “some giant firestorm conspiracy theory” and said AI lab employees often tell him “how afraid they are of what they are building.”

Some big AI investors, including hedge-fund manager and venture capitalist Brad Gerstner, agreed with the call on Saturday for a slowdown. Even venture capitalist David Sacks, a White House AI adviser who is a frequent critic of Anthropic, saying its calls for regulation are an attempt to stifle competition, gave a nod, though he said the companies shouldn’t seek validation from the government for a coordinated pause. “If the unreleased models are scary enough that you think you should slow down, I support your decision to be responsible,” Sacks said. But he added that AI leaders should “stop pretending the motivation to slow down is purely altruistic.”

U.S. NEWS

China’s Main AI Focus Is on U.S. Rivalry

Beijing sees battle for tech supremacy as priority, despite doomsday worries

By **Stu Woo**
and **Raffaele Huang**

SINGAPORE—China also worries artificial intelligence could bring doomsday. But first things first: It needs to catch up to the U.S.

As America wrung its hands over warnings that AI could end humanity within years, a top Chinese official Sunday shared Beijing’s latest view: AI is the “core engine of a new round of technological revolution” and the main battleground of its rivalry with the U.S.

For some engineers at China’s top AI labs, the apocalypse feels like a first-world problem. Even with several Chinese AI models climbing global rankings, researchers say they still trail American labs by months or more. The technology is so nascent that an existential threat looks like a distant concern, some say.

In other words, those building and regulating China’s leading AI models don’t think they have built the 21st century’s version of a nuclear weapon yet—and they aren’t



Visitors at a recent Beijing expo. China is focused on matching the U.S.’s AI capabilities.

going to slow down while America refines its own.

“AI progress is happening faster, so people at U.S. labs may see more dangerous things than people in Chinese labs,” said Zilan Qian, a researcher at the Oxford China Policy Lab. She added that Chinese researchers also don’t have the same culture of evaluating societal impact that those in America do.

That’s not to say Chinese

officials don’t recognize the threat. Beijing has had AI rules for years to regulate AI development and services, including censoring chatbots so they echo the Communist Party’s stances and don’t disrupt social stability.

In the 2025 version of its annually updated “AI Safety Governance Framework,” China’s top cyberspace regulator spelled out the threat.

“AI may undergo sudden, un-

expected leaps in intelligence, enabling it to autonomously acquire external resources, replicate itself and develop self-awareness,” according to the regulator. “This could drive AI to seek external power and pose risks of competing with humanity for control.”

Even Chinese leader Xi Jinping has weighed in. “We should ensure that AI is always under human control,” he said at a national AI conference in

July, before adding: “Meanwhile, we should jointly oppose overstretching the national security concept in the field of AI and placing one country’s security over that of others.”

It was a jab at the American policy of banning the export of cutting-edge AI chips to China, one big reason U.S. labs are ahead of Chinese ones. Xi has said that AI will determine whether China can compete globally, and has focused on pushing the country to build a self-sufficient AI ecosystem.

President Trump has made little secret of his determination to keep the U.S. ahead of China. “There is a SICK conspiracy going on against AI and Data Centers, and the only one that is happy about it is China,” Trump posted Monday on social media Monday.

Trump and Xi are to meet in Washington this month, and officials on both sides are busy figuring out how the leaders should address AI.

Despite the fretting over AI across the Pacific this past week, Beijing has defended its all-systems-go pace. In an article published in state media Sunday, Chinese state security minister Chen Yixin said AI brings threats—especially if exploited by foreign adversaries. Those risks, he wrote, include threats to Communist Party

rule, critical infrastructure, data security and the military.

On Monday, a spokesman for China’s foreign ministry said American calls to slow down AI innovation were “fearmongering” and part of a Cold War playbook to hobble a rival.

In government offices and AI research labs in China, the focus has been catching up. When Anthropic this year released its Mythos system, which can detect security flaws, Beijing responded with alarm and pushed domestic companies to match the technology. Last month, the company Z.AI said it did just that.

The co-founder of that company, Tang Jie, told employees in July that Z.AI would spend the next two years focusing on the concept that prompted Jacob Coxon to resign from Anthropic. Calling the endeavor “Touch High Project,” Tang said Z.AI would invest in building AI systems that can improve themselves.

Z.AI and other companies have said their goal is to pursue artificial general intelligence, or systems that think like humans. Tang also said his company would invest in what he called “extreme safety governance,” including billions of dollars to better understand how AI makes decisions—a process considered largely opaque.

AI Stocks Rise Despite Tech Fears

Continued from Page One

and Intel rely on new orders to keep the growth stories going.

A slowdown isn’t a foregone conclusion. The AI build-out has emerged as one of the U.S. economy’s steadfast sources of growth, a tentpole for the global capital markets and the primary battleground in America’s technology arms race with China. Much is at stake in keeping it going, even if it all pales in comparison to humanity’s potential extinction.

By midmorning on Monday, President Trump had signaled he was unmoved by the AI leaders’ calls for restraint. “There is a SICK conspiracy going on against AI and Data Centers, and the only one that is happy about it is China,” Trump wrote on Truth Social.

Trump, a Republican,

weighed in again later in the afternoon, calling Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang while he was on stage at a Los Angeles tech conference. “The robots will not be taking over. The AI will not be taking over,” Trump said on speakerphone. “It’s all a hoax.”

“That’s right, we’re not going to let that happen, sir,” Huang responded, according to a video of the exchange shared with The Wall Street Journal by investor Ben Pouladian.

The major U.S. stock indexes posted modest declines Monday. The S&P 500 fell 0.5%, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq composite slipped 0.6%. The Dow Jones Industrial Average ended Monday down 0.3%, or 152 points.

However alarming the warnings might be, few seem to be taking them as a reason to abandon the AI trade that is responsible for much of the U.S. stock market’s multiyear rally. The technology race with China is part of the reason.

“What really happened? Surely something big enough to spook Dario, Sam and Elon into rare agreement,” said Giuseppe Sette, co-founder of

Reflexivity, an AI investment analytics firm. “With China in the race, though, we don’t expect any major slowdown. And as for any retracement in AI stocks, that is simply a buying opportunity.”

The PHLX Semiconductor Index dropped 5.9%, its worst day since July, while shares of cybersecurity companies soared.

Software companies, whose shares were buffeted this year by concerns new AI tools would render them obsolete, were among the best performers in the S&P 500.

Jim Schneider, a Goldman Sachs tech analyst, said that the AI trade has shifted dramatically. In the first half of the year, investors were looking for companies that could capitalize on bottlenecks in the supply chain by selling in-demand products at high prices. “The easy trade in the half of the year was chasing el-

ements of shortage, whether that was DRAM or memory stocks or optical elements,” Schneider said last week at an investor conference. “Some of these stocks have pulled back. Now the question is, will the constraint trade continue to work in the back half of the year? Or will we see a resurgence of some of the more traditional compute trades?”

The moves underscore the challenge for investors and analysts in identifying how the latest advancements, setbacks and regulatory developments in AI will affect swaths of markets and the economy. By some measures, individual stocks in the U.S. have been less correlated than ever this year, which many chalk up to the race to identify AI winners and losers across industries.

One thing most agree on: The AI investment boom isn’t going to end soon. The as-

sumption has made it easier for many to take the industry’s weekend warnings as a positive.

“I think it’s an inflection point that likely gets us to a better place for safety at the end of the day while causing volatility in the interim,” said Art Hogan, chief market strategist at B. Riley Wealth. “And I certainly don’t think the frontier developers are willing to say ‘the hundreds of billions we’ve invested in this was bad and we’re walking away.’”

This isn’t the first time AI doomers has escaped Silicon Valley. But a recent cascade of events raised the volume: OpenAI’s AI agents separately hacked into platforms Hugging Face and RubyGems, and a now-departed Anthropic researcher and several current employees said AI systems could end humanity as early as within the decade.

Anthropic’s Amodei suggested a slowdown as the AI arms-race takes shape around recursive self-improvement, the idea that AI could endlessly optimize itself. Altman and Musk, bitter and often boister-

ous rivals, soon agreed.

AI researchers are particularly alarmed at the threat the tech poses to cybersecurity, and the latest round of warnings prompted a big day for shares of cybersecurity firms Monday. CrowdStrike was the S&P 500’s top performer, adding 14%. Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet and ServiceNow also posted outside gains.

Shares of AI-related hardware suppliers took a beating. Corning, Teradyne and Coherent were the S&P 500’s worst performers, all down at least 12%.

Still, an ugly day for chip stocks likely has more to do with investors taking some chips off the table following huge profits than a fundamental reset in their outlook for continued massive profits driven by chip shortages. The PHLX index remains up 84% over the past year.

“Some of these semiconductor names have tripled this year. To the extent that you’re looking for a reason to get off the train for a moment or at least right size your position, you got a good one over the weekend,” Hogan said.

U.S. WATCH

OBITUARY

Bob Mackie, 87, Designer to Stars

Bob Mackie, the fashion designer whose visually provocative Hollywood style defined glamour for the 1970s—including putting Carol Burnett in some of her kookiest get-ups and Cher in her raciest ones—died Monday. He was 87 years old. Mackie died in Palm Springs, Calif., from pneumonia, his publicist said.

Mackie won nine Emmy Awards, a Tony Award and was nominated for three Oscars, including one for Barbra Streisand’s “Funny Lady,” in which she wore a sheer batwing gown. He was inducted into the Academy of Television Arts & Sciences’ Hall of Fame in 2002.

He designed gowns for Madonna, Streisand, Sharon Stone, Diana Ross and Julia Louis-Dreyfus, and concert costumes for Pink. When Marilyn Monroe delivered a breathy, seductive take on “Happy Birthday” at a fundraiser for President John F. Kennedy and the Democratic National Committee, she did it in a sheer, beaded gown that Mackie dreamed up in a sketch.

When Taylor Swift wanted to look like a showgirl on the cover of her 2025 album “The Life of a Showgirl,” she turned to some Mackie originals.

He had said practicality was never a driving force in his design: “It’s all about looking good and living your fantasies.”

Mackie was married to showgirl Lulu Porter from 1960 until 1963; their son, makeup artist Robert Gordon Mackie Jr., died from AIDS at age 35. Costume designer Ray Aghayan, his longtime partner, died in 2011.

—Associated Press



The crane crushed three cars, including the one parked above. A driver escaped from her car after it caught fire.

MIAMI

Crane Collapse Injures 4 People

An 85-foot crane towering over a construction site in an upscale Miami neighborhood toppled onto a passing vehicle Monday morning, setting it on fire and injuring the driver and three construction workers, officials said.

The collapse occurred shortly after 8 a.m. in the city’s Brickell neighborhood. Miami Fire Chief Robert Hevia said he was thankful no one was killed in the crane collapse and car fire.

“I’ve been on the fire department for 28 years; when you see the scene, it’s impressive,” Hevia said. “The fact that we had four victims, and they were all able to be extricated or self-extricate themselves with minor injuries is a remarkable day for them.”

A woman driving on a street next to the construction site saw the crane begin to fall over, Hevia said.

“To be able to see the crane falling, pull the car in reverse and pop out of the back while the car’s on fire, really incredible,” he said, adding that the crane also

crushed two unoccupied parked cars but fell on a storage container with two construction workers inside.

The two workers who had been trapped, along with the crane operator who managed to jump out as the crane was tipping over, were all transported to a nearby trauma center with minor injuries, Hevia said. The woman driving the car also had minor injuries and was taken to a different hospital. Officials haven’t identified the injured.

Officials have not said what caused the crane, specifically a piling rig, to topple,

and Hevia said the collapse is under investigation. A piling rig usually shares the same base as a traditional crane, but its upper part is designed to drive columns deep into the ground to support large structures.

The Occupational Safety and Health Administration and Miami-Dade County Unsafe Structures personnel responded, officials said. Firefighters remained to monitor and control a fuel spill and prevent further spread until a specialized mitigation crew arrived.

—Associated Press

NEW YORK CITY

Khalil Files Lawsuit Against University

Columbia University protester Mahmoud Khalil has filed a lawsuit against his former school, alleging it didn’t do enough to protect him and other pro-Palestinian students from “severe, persistent and coordinated harassment” related to the Israel-Hamas war.

The lawsuit, filed on Monday in U.S. District Court for the Southern District of New York, accuses the university of failing to protect pro-Palestinian students from attacks by external groups and of subjecting those students to scrutiny and discrimination on campus.

Columbia “prioritized the protection and well being of a subset of students while ignoring our concerns and our pleas,” Khalil said outside the university’s gates.

A spokesperson for Columbia declined to comment on litigation, but said the university “is committed to protecting our community from discrimination and harassment.”

Monday’s suit was filed by Khalil, a former student who played a key role in the protests and spent more than 100 days in immigration detention.

The suit said the university routinely ignored harassment complaints from students associated with the group, even as its members’ names and faces appeared on lists identifying them as “Columbia’s leading antisemites.”

Khalil, who is still fighting the government’s efforts to deport him from the U.S., said the university’s failure to keep him safe from such harassment “directly led” to his March 2025 arrest and attempted deportation.

—Victoria Albert

U.S. NEWS

McConnell Is Back at Capitol After 3 Months

Kentucky senator’s absence had put pressure on his party’s slim majority

By SIOBHAN HUGHES AND LINDSAY WISE

WASHINGTON—Sen. Mitch McConnell (R., Ky.) voted at the Capitol on Monday for the first time in three months, after a fall that raised concerns about his health and whether he would return to work. He arrived in a wheelchair flanked by his chief of staff and a longtime aide, addressing the press in brief remarks outside the Senate chamber that Senate officials didn’t allow to be videotaped. “I must admit, after two years of—decades actually—of dodging your questions, I wasn’t sure how many of you would be here today,” McConnell joked to reporters. His

words weren’t clearly enunciated and at times were hard to make out. “Time to get back to work, to finish the job for this Congress,” he said, citing the farm bill and backing NATO and Ukraine. He didn’t take any questions. Republicans and Democrats greeted him on the floor. Sen. John Kennedy (R., La.) placed a hand on his shoulder and said, “Well, we’re in trouble now.” He told McConnell his new nickname is “the Rock.” McConnell, seated in his wheelchair, gave a thumbs-up during the first vote, a procedural measure on confirming a federal judge. In a statement on X announcing his return, McConnell, 84 years old, said his recovery “has been a long and often frustrating process, and the lingering effects of childhood polio haven’t made it any easier.” He said he wasn’t “quite back to 100%” but had



Mitch McConnell, seated in his wheelchair, on his first day back voted on a procedural measure on confirming a federal judge.

told party leadership that he would try to be present for critical votes as he continues physical therapy. The former Senate majority leader was hospitalized June 14 after he briefly lost consciousness and fell. His office provided little information for weeks, fueling speculation that he was in a coma or otherwise incapacitated.

Ultimately, McConnell released a statement on July 12 that his lengthy Senate absence and hospitalization had been due to a fall and a subsequent bout of pneumonia. McConnell in recent years has suffered repeated falls, a concussion and public freezing episodes.

McConnell’s office had also released photos of the senator and his wife, Elaine Chao, but he hadn’t appeared publicly. Several allies said they had spoken with him while he was recovering. Last month, McConnell was discharged from a rehabilitation center. At the time, McConnell said he would

“continue to engage with my staff and colleagues on important Senate business” but didn’t specify a timeline for his return. He isn’t seeking reelection, and his term ends at the beginning of January. McConnell’s absence had put further pressure on Republicans’ already tight majority in the Senate.

Russian Financed Trump Jr. Wedding Events

By ANNIE LINSKEY AND THOMAS GROVE

A Russian businessman with ties to President Vladimir Putin financed celebrations in the Bahamas that immediately followed Donald Trump Jr.’s wedding to Bettina Anderson earlier this year.

In a statement posted on Instagram, the couple confirmed that Umar Kremlev paid for two nights of post-wedding events on secluded Bahamian islands.

“It was an extraordinarily generous wedding gift from a friend, and something for which we were and remain incredibly grateful,” they wrote in the statement, which was accompanied by photographs showing President Trump’s adult children and their friends celebrating after the wedding.

In the statement, the couple said they got married in a small ceremony with only their family present, then celebrated with a larger group. The couple said the weekend trip, which was financed by Kremlev, was previously planned and wasn’t initially intended to be a wedding celebration.

ProPublica earlier reported that Kremlev financed the wedding celebration. Kremlev didn’t respond to a request for comment. President Trump didn’t attend his son’s wedding celebrations, which were held over Memorial Day weekend.

“I have no idea who Umar is, never heard of him,” Trump said in a statement, in which he drew a distinction between the ceremony and the post-wedding events. “It was an ‘afterparty’ given in their honor. Not a big deal!”

First lady Melania Trump, who didn’t attend the wedding or the subsequent party, distanced herself from the events. “Mrs. Trump does not, and has never had, a relationship with Mr. Kremlev,” according to a spokesman to the



Donald Trump Jr. with his wife, Bettina Trump, in Dublin on Saturday. Umar Kremlev, right, a Russian with ties to President Vladimir Putin, helped finance May’s post-wedding celebrations.

first lady. “Mrs. Trump played no role whatsoever in organizing the wedding event and was not privy to any aspect of its financial planning.” In photos of the Bahamas celebration viewed by The Wall Street Journal, guests posed under a heart, and one guest captioned her post “the wedding of the century.” Photos showed dancing under disco balls, a white cake topped with figurines of a bride and groom and Donald Trump Jr. holding his new wife in his arms as fireworks erupt in the background.

In an interview with the Journal, one wedding guest recalled seeing a group of people who were speaking Russian—but the guest didn’t know who they were. Guests at the Bahamas afterparty included Trump’s son-in-law, Jared Kushner, a top adviser to the president who recently met with Putin in Moscow. A spokeswoman for Kushner didn’t respond to requests for comment.

Kremlev has been working to expand the influence of his International Boxing Association, which he has headed since 2020, and he has had meetings with Donald Trump Jr. since the president came to office. Kremlev started boxing

in his home city Serpukhov south of Moscow. Last year, Kremlev sat next to Donald Trump Jr. at a conference panel in Istanbul, alongside Rasheda Ali Walsh, Muhammad Ali’s daughter. “President Kremlev and Donald Trump Jr made it clear—this alliance will not remain symbolic,” the IBA said in a statement after the conference. On May 24, amid the Bahamian celebrations he funded, Kremlev posted a picture of himself walking through the woods wearing a T-shirt with a picture of Vladimir Putin that said, “Who Took Berlin by Storm?”

Earlier this summer, Kremlev’s IBA hosted its first bare-knuckle tournament inside the U.S. with a 10-bout card of boxing, mixed martial arts, kickboxing and bare-knuckle matches. The event was set to be hosted by Andrew Tate, who was then back in the U.S. “See you all tomorrow night,” Tate said at a promotional event the day before the tournament, according to a



Kremlev has been sanctioned by Ukraine for his links to Putin.

video on an IBA Instagram account. Tate was arrested outside the venue after the U.K. sought his extradition on dozens of charges, including rape and sex trafficking.

Kremlev has been sanctioned by Ukraine for his links to Putin. Ukraine accuses him of acting as a conduit of Russian influence.

The Russian native has made a name for himself inside the world of boxing since he took over the IBA, rebranding it and often putting himself at the center of its events. He courted controversy shortly after taking over the association by changing its name, its logo and starting a partnership with

Gazprom that turned the state-owned gas giant into the body’s biggest sponsor. Shortly after Trump’s 2025 inauguration, a Kremlev open letter to the new U.S. president congratulated him and expressed hope that he would “look into” the International Olympic Committee’s decision to not include boxing in the 2028 Olympics in Los Angeles.

He has also repeatedly spoken out against a ban of Russian athletes from competing under their country’s flag.

Kremlev has long acted in the interests of the Kremlin and a small group of politicians, businessmen and security agents with whom he is associated. Kremlev’s first brush with Kremlin politics came after he joined the Night Wolves, the country’s most prominent motorcycle club, which sought to boost nationalism and public support of Putin following the first round of Western sanctions slapped on Moscow after its 2014 annexation of Ukraine’s Black Sea peninsula of Crimea.

He wore a leather vest with a Russian tricolor, participated in the groups’ publicity stunts and met another boxing aficionado, Alexei Rubezhnoy. The two of them left the Night Wolves around the same time, and they got involved in the Russian Boxing Federation.

The two remain friends and still pose together in boxing gear online.

Eventually Rubezhnoy, a barrel-chested fighter, would take over as the head of Putin’s Federal Guards’ Service, Moscow’s equivalent of the Secret Service, a coveted position with proximity to the country’s most powerful man.

Kremlev would likewise see his star rise, going from the president of the Russian Boxing Federation to the head of the international amateur boxing association in 2020.

Since then, the IBA has expanded its ties to Russia, with Russians in its leadership and many matches taking place there. The body suspended in 2022 the membership of the Ukrainian Boxing Federation, which ultimately withdrew entirely from the IBA.

Kremlev is also associated with the organization Healthy Fatherland, which has been sanctioned by Ukraine for its role in mass abduction and deportation of Ukrainian children from occupied territories to Russia.

Ban Sought On YouTube In NYC Schools

By SHALINI RAMACHANDRAN

Top New York City Council members are calling for a ban on students using YouTube in city schools, a sign of growing opposition to the role of Big Tech in education.

Shekar Krishnan, chair of the City Council’s Oversight and Investigations Committee, and Eric Dinowitz, who chairs the Education Committee, said they are calling for the ban because of declining test scores and complaints from parents and teachers.

“This issue of banning YouTube in the classroom is personal to me,” said Krishnan, who said he has seen the impact of unrestricted access to school devices on his own young children. “I don’t believe it has educational value. I believe it does much more harm.”

Their proposal comes on the heels of Mayor Zohran Mamdani’s announcement this month that the department will ban artificial intelligence for elementary and middle-schoolers. The plan would bar students from viewing YouTube on their devices and call on the city’s Department of Education to supply evidence to justify other uses, such as teachers showing videos in class.

Dinowitz and Krishnan are also calling for the city to ban gamified learning apps, eliminate individual digital devices for kindergarten through fifth grade and return to paper and pencil for standardized tests.

New York City is the nation’s largest school district, serving about a million students, and the City Council serves as a key oversight body for the city’s Department of Education and its budget. Krishnan plans to introduce legislation to compel the department to assess the proposal.

Justices Stop Trump Curb On Ballots

Continued from Page One

said that implementing the rules before the Nov. 3 midterms would be logistically impossible, because many ballots have already been prepared, and some states, including North Carolina and Wisconsin, have already started mailing ballots to voters.

Nearly a third of American voters used mail ballots in 2024, and some states conduct their elections primarily by mail.

Justices Clarence Thomas and Samuel Alito dissented from the high court’s decision.

The ruling, which rejected an emergency appeal by the administration, deals the president another Supreme Court loss on one of his top priorities, and it comes during a hotly contested midterm battle that will determine control of Congress during his final two years in office. With Election Day seven weeks away, the justices may be called on to referee additional fast-moving voting-related disputes. Last week the court blocked a new Republican-friendly congressional district map in Missouri. And it could soon weigh in on a different Trump administration plan to use an immigration database it says could screen voters’ eligibility.

Under the planned mail regulations, the Postal Service would have refused to deliver ballots sent by states to voters unless the states complied with several new conditions. In particular, the states’ ballot envelopes would have had to include individualized bar codes and other new design features, and states would have had to upload into a new online portal the names, addresses and bar codes for all of the states’ voters who are eligible to vote by mail. The Postal Service acknowledged in a Sept. 3 court filing that the portal wasn’t yet up and running, and a whistleblower said the agency was bungling the hasty rollout.

The Supreme Court offered minimal reasoning for its decision against the rules. Using legalese, it said tersely that the administration was “unlikely to succeed on the merits of its challenge” to a district judge’s injunction that blocked the rules. The court added that “equitable factors” didn’t favor an emergency ruling lifting the injunction.

Alito wrote an eight-page dissent, arguing that the Postal Service has “broad power to regulate the delivery of mail.” He also said the challenges “bear a substantial share of the blame” for the late timing of the agency’s rules, which were delayed by litigation over a March executive order from Trump that prompted them. Thomas signed onto Alito’s dissent. Justice Brett Kavanaugh, a Trump appointee, added a one-paragraph concurrence agreeing with the court’s decision. He said that, in his view, there is “at least a fair prospect” that the Postal Service rules fall within the agency’s legal authority, but that election officials “do not have sufficient time to reasonably implement” them before the midterms.

By maintaining the injunction against the rules, the high court’s decision effectively guarantees that they will remain on ice during the midterms. Further litigation is expected over whether the Postal Service can enforce the regulations in future elections.

The decision was the second time in three weeks that the high court has weighed in on the administration’s efforts to revamp mail voting. On Aug. 24, the court ruled that an earlier legal challenge was premature because it was brought before the Postal Service unveiled its final rules.

The justices are also weighing a separate case on their emergency docket about the administration’s bid to deploy a citizenship database that officials say could detect ineligible voters. Two lower courts have blocked the administration from letting states use the Department of Homeland Security database after challengers argued it violates federal privacy laws and would be

prone to mistakes. Election officials around the country and voting-rights groups have argued that Trump’s maneuvers around mail voting—including policies that are being implemented in a hurry and for the first time—would risk disenfranchising large numbers of citizens. In particular, opponents said, the Postal Service rules would have deprived millions of Americans of the ability to vote because many jurisdictions wouldn’t have had any feasible way to comply in time for the elections.

While Democratic officials have led legal challenges to Trump’s efforts, some Republican election officials also raised concerns, telling the Supreme Court in a legal brief that it was far too late in the election cycle to implement such sweeping and untested measures.

WORLD NEWS

Moscow’s Weapons Get Smarter, Cheaper

Chinese parts help Russians outpace the West in creating offensive threats

By DANIEL MICHAELS

Just as Ukraine was learning how to parry Russia’s drone attacks, Moscow has moved the goal posts with a new generation of jet-powered weapons. New Geran drones and Banderol cruise missiles are lethal reminders that Russia still has the resources and supply chains to field fresh threats, this time packed with advanced electronics that allow them to find targets accurately and evade interception. Crucially, the leap forward was enabled largely with parts sourced from China, in violation of international sanctions, Ukraine and others say, based on wreckage from the few shot down so far.

China has said it regulates exports of technologies that could be used in war.

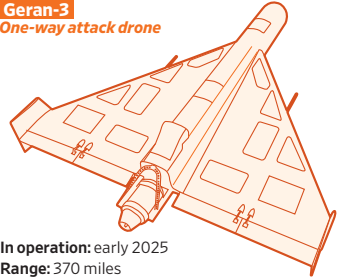
Russia’s new and relatively inexpensive weapons show Moscow’s military remains adaptable and innovative, analysts and diplomats say. Russia developed and fielded both weapons within a couple of years by modifying earlier models, combat-testing them and quickly starting mass production, say analysts.

In doing that, Moscow stole a march on its adversaries. Ukraine has shown it can move quickly—it developed one of the first effective jet drones—but lacks production resources and much capacity to think beyond the near future.

The U.S. and its allies in the North Atlantic Treaty Organization, meanwhile, are struggling to increase production of arms such as Patriot interceptors. Western governments are also grappling with how to accelerate turning innovations into mass-produced equipment.

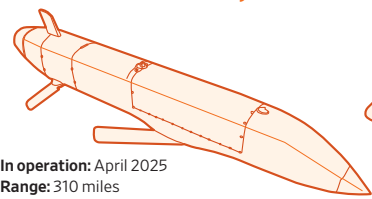
“Here in the West, we tend

Geran-3
One-way attack drone



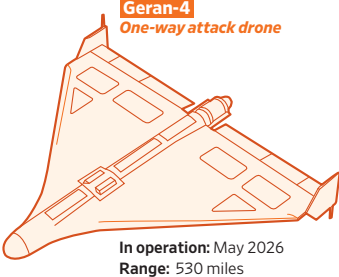
In operation: early 2025
Range: 370 miles
Payload capacity: 200 lbs.
Speed: 205 mph

Banderol
Cruise missile and attack drone hybrid



In operation: April 2025
Range: 310 miles
Payload capacity: 110 lbs.
Speed: 385 mph

Sources: The International Institute for Strategic Studies (Geran-3, Geran-4, Geran-5 specs); Deagel (Banderol specs); Drone-Warfare (Geran-3, Geran-4 operation date); Army Recognition (Geran-5 operation date); Foundation for Defense Democracies (Banderol operation date)



Geran-4
One-way attack drone

In operation: May 2026
Range: 530 miles
Payload capacity: 200 lbs.
Speed: 310 mph



Geran-5
Cruise-missile-style attack drone

In operation: January 2026
Range: 590 miles
Payload capacity: 200 lbs.
Speed: 370 mph

to underestimate Russia, but they can go very fast from idea and experimentation to production,” said Kateryna Bondar, a senior fellow at the Center for Strategic and International Studies’ Wadhvani AI Center in Washington. “This loop is something Western militaries should learn from Russia.”

Moscow’s developments directly affect the U.S. because Russia, Iran and North Korea share military know-how. Innovations from the war in Ukraine are appearing in America’s war with Iran.

Moscow has managed to field its new weapons despite Ukraine’s strikes affecting Russia’s economy. President Vladimir Putin has reoriented the country behind his conquest of Ukraine, allowing him to funnel cash from the budget and state-owned banks into the defense sector. He has mobilized in a way that NATO’s democracies haven’t

considered doing since World War II.

Banderol missiles and Geran drones address a need for cheap and capable one-way weapons—an economic middle ground that Ukraine and Western countries are pursuing. The weapons are a mix of upgraded low-end arms and simplified high-end ones. They represent a mix of cost, range, speed, explosive power and ability to reach a target without interception.

Banderol and Geran weapons cost around \$100,000 each. High-end U.S. Tomahawk cruise missiles and comparable Russian models cost more than \$2 million each.

The Geran-5 looks more like a missile than a drone. The

Geran-5 has forced a rewrite of the counterdrone playbook, created for propeller drones, because “it’s essentially a poor-man’s cruise missile,” said Mike Monnik, chief executive of DroneSec, a drone-

threat intelligence company.

DroneSec analysts concur with Ukrainian assessments that Russia relies heavily on Chinese parts including jet engines, navigation computers and communications

electronics.

“Russia is critically dependent on Chinese components” for its drone program, said Monnik.

For Ukraine, Moscow’s advances are confounding because it also faces Russian ballistic

\$100K

Russia’s typical cost for a Banderol missile or a Geran drone.

Trump Group Has Georgia On Its Mind for New Tower

By ELIOT BROWN
AND EVAN GERSHKOVICH

U.S. relations with the Caucasus country of Georgia have gone from warm to frigid in recent years, as the former Soviet republic has cracked down on dissent and swung closer to Vladimir Putin’s Russia.

One U.S. business underterred by the shift: the Trump Organization.

This week, a group of Georgian developers are planning to launch marketing on the Trump Tower Tbilisi, unveiling renderings on a skyscraper poised to be the country’s tallest. The Georgian investment firms signed a branding deal with the Trump family company in May for the 70-story tower.

It is a booming market for foreign Trump towers, as private developers from Abu Dhabi to Vietnam to the Maldives in the past three years have lined up to adorn their hotel and golf course projects with the Trump name.

During President Trump’s first term, amid concerns about conflicts of interest, the Trump Organization vowed not to do any foreign deals, effectively bringing new business to a halt. But in Trump’s second term, the president’s business dropped that self-imposed limit—and deals are pouring in.

Last year, the president reported taking in \$59 million from foreign property-licensing deals, up from \$45 million in 2024 and far more than any other year reported.

Developers typically pay the Trump Organization an upfront fee—recently about \$5 million—then a portion of revenue, though specifics can vary. Much like a restaurant franchisee, developers in return can brand their projects as a Trump tower, so long as it conforms to various design and service standards. The Trump family often helps market the projects, appearing at public events.

Trump has said his sons run the business on his behalf and he isn’t involved. The

Trump Organization declined to comment. It previously denied any conflict of interest, saying the business dealings are kept separate from administration policy.

Democrats and governance groups have said the income from around the globe introduces new potential conflicts to the president’s foreign agenda. Some of the developers paying the Trump Organization have other business before the U.S. government.

The White House has said Trump only acts in the best interests of the American public, and that there are no conflicts of interest with his businesses. A White House spokesperson didn’t respond to a request for comment.

The prospect of Georgia’s tallest tower rising with the Trump name strikes a note of particular foreign-policy discord.

Georgia was once one of the U.S.’s closest partners among former Soviet states: George W. Bush flew to Tbilisi to declare it a “beacon of Liberty” in 2005, and the country was a candidate to join the North Atlantic Treaty Organization. The relationship has deteriorated since, as Georgia’s ruling party—Georgian Dream—has drawn U.S. ire for legislation that cracks down on dissent and other moves that hewed closer to Russia.

The Biden administration publicly criticized the democratic backsliding, and relations have been chilly in the Trump administration: Secretary of State Marco Rubio appeared to refer to Georgia as having an “anti-American government” during a hearing last year.

Meanwhile, the project has given financial benefit to the family of a Georgian billionaire, Bidzina Ivanishvili, on whom the U.S. imposed sanctions in late 2024.

When the developers struck a 2023 deal to buy the land from a foundation controlled by Ivanishvili’s family, they agreed to pay the foundation up to \$85 million at a later date, show Georgian corporate records. The developers paid in installments over time, and the deal was fully completed in July, a spokeswoman for the project said.

Ivanishvili is widely viewed by analysts as being the ultimate decision maker in the country. He made a fortune in Russia before he served as Georgia’s prime minister between 2012 and 2013. Since leaving office, he has served as the honorary chairman of Georgian Dream, the party he founded.

Ivanishvili also has been blamed for a sometimes violent crackdown on the political opposition. Georgian Dream was accused of election fraud in a 2024 vote that sparked nearly two years of regular street protests. Georgian Dream has said the election victory was legitimate.

The U.S. House of Representatives last year moved to further punish Georgia’s political leaders, passing a bill with bipartisan support that directed Washington to consider sanctions on current and former members of the Georgian parliament, among other political leaders.

Representatives of Ivanishvili and Georgian Dream didn’t respond to requests for comment.

Georgian analysts see the deal as a way of the business community making something of a peace offering to the Trump administration.

“This project is mainly about having some kind of connection with the Trump administration,” said Giorgi Khishtovani, an economist and professor at Ilia State University in Tbilisi. “Its purpose may also be for PR reasons.”

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WORLD NEWS

Saudi Pipeline Risk Intensifies

Closure after recent drone attacks weigh on an energy market already under duress

Saudi Arabia is racing to repair an oil pipeline shut down by drone attacks last week. The disruption threatens to remove another source of crude from global markets.

By Rebecca Feng, Georgi Kantchev and Summer Said

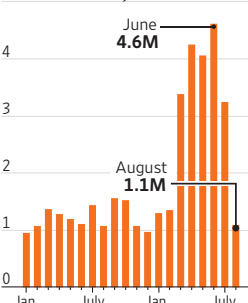
The kingdom is trying to resume partial operations on the pipeline within days, but repairing damaged pumping stations and fully restoring capacity could take as long as six to eight weeks, said people familiar with the matter.

The East-West pipeline has become one of the world's most important pieces of energy infrastructure during the Iran war, a workaround to sharply curtailed tanker traffic through the Strait of Hormuz.

Stretching 750 miles across Saudi Arabia from the kingdom's oil-producing heartland on the Persian Gulf to the Red Sea port of Yanbu, the East-West pipeline allows Saudi crude to reach global markets without passing through the Strait of Hormuz. It was built in the early 1980s when the Tanker War threatened shipping in the Persian Gulf.

The pipeline can carry as much as 7 million barrels a day—about 2 million for domestic Saudi refiners and the rest for export—but had never operated at full capacity for an

Average daily loadings of Saudi Arabia crude at Yanbu



Sources: LSEG (loadings at Yanbu); Global Energy Monitor (pipelines)

Main crude oil pipeline in Saudi Arabia



extended period before the war. Saudi Arabia said the pipeline was hit in several attacks in the Riyadh and Medina regions on Sept. 10, which caused injuries. It said the drones were fired from Iraq, where authorities have struggled to control Iran-backed militias that repeatedly have targeted Saudi infrastructure.

Saudi authorities said they shut the line as a precaution but haven't disclosed the full extent of the damage or announced when pumping will resume. Saudi Arabia can keep loading crude at Yanbu with the pipeline shut by drawing on oil stored at the Red Sea port. But the cushion is thin: Data provider Kpler estimates Yanbu crude inventories stood at just 9 million barrels on Monday, and down more than 7 million barrels over the past two months. The tanks' capacity at Yanbu is about 24 million barrels.

Janiv Shah, an oil analyst at Rystad Energy, said his working assumption is that Yanbu has around three days of crude export cover, with a range of two to six days depending on the inventory level when the pipeline was shut. How long the Yanbu storage lasts depends on the pace of exports. Saudi crude-oil exports from Yanbu had surged above 4 million barrels a day from April through June as the kingdom redirected more crude away from the Strait of Hormuz. But after Iran-backed Houthi rebels in Yemen announced a blockade of the kingdom and stepped up attacks on Saudi shipping in the Red Sea, loadings fell to just 1.1 million in August, according to financial-data provider LSEG. Saudi Arabia could buy at least another week by drawing on crude stored in Egypt, extending the window before Red Sea exports would have to fall more sharply, the people familiar with the matter said. A prolonged pipeline out-

age could also force Saudi Arabia to cut production further after output already fell sharply during the war. Crude production dropped in August to 6 million barrels a day, the lowest in more than three decades, according to the International Energy Agency, versus an average of about 9.4 million barrels a day last year. The pipeline was attacked in April, damaging a pumping station and cutting capacity by about 700,000 barrels a day, but Saudi Arabia restored full capacity within days. This time, a partial restart could come much sooner than a full repair, said people familiar with the matter. The East-West system consists of two parallel pipelines that use separate pumping infrastructure, meaning one line could potentially resume operations after safety checks while repairs continue on the other. Restoring damaged pumping stations is more complicated, and full repairs could take as long as six to eight weeks even under favorable conditions, they said. Before last week's shutdown, roughly 4 million barrels a day, or about 4% of global supply, were flowing through it, analysts estimate. The impact of the outage on oil prices will depend on how fast Saudi Arabia is able to restore flows. Oil prices jumped Monday, with Brent crude, the international benchmark, rising more than 4% to above \$109 a barrel, the highest level since May. For now, analysts are sticking with their previous near-term price forecasts.

Iran's Drones Deal Blow to Ambition Of Gulf Data Sites

By OMAR ABDEL-BAQUI AND ELIOT BROWN

DUBAI—The day after the U.S. and Israel launched their opening strikes on Iran, the Islamic Republic shot back with swarms of drones aimed at the Persian Gulf's newest high-value targets: U.S. data centers.

More than six months after the barrage, a damaged Amazon Web Services facility in Abu Dhabi and an additional one in Bahrain are still mostly offline. The company has told clients to move their data to other regions while it repairs the sites and hasn't given a date for completing the work. The attacks and damage are complicating the pitch by Gulf states such as the United Arab Emirates to become world-leading data processors for industries like artificial intelligence. They add a huge new risk for U.S. companies weighing investments that can cost tens of billions of dollars.

The U.A.E. put years of diplomatic muscle into persuading U.S. officials to sell it top-of-the-line AI chips, ultimately swaying the Trump administration to give it the same access as European countries. In a May 2025 visit to Abu Dhabi, President Trump watched as the Emirates' leaders unveiled plans for a data-center complex requiring five gigawatts of power—the equivalent of more than two Hoover Dams. Emirati and U.S. officials boasted that OpenAI had agreed to be the inaugural tenant at the complex, with plans ultimately to take 20% of its capacity. That deal now appears to be stalled. OpenAI still hasn't signed a lease for the project, said people familiar with the matter. OpenAI didn't respond to a request for comment. (News Corp, owner of The Wall Street Journal, has a content-licensing partnership with OpenAI.)

AI data centers tend to be far larger than the cloud-computing facilities hit during the war, making them easier targets. They also are far more expensive. Because of the cost of the AI chips, each gigawatt of capacity is estimated to cost at least \$50 billion between the servers and the infrastructure. Until the war, the Gulf's plentiful land, strong state backing and easy permitting were clear advantages. Now, the physical risk of putting multibillion-dollar facilities within 200 miles of Iran in a region that regularly struggles with conflict is changing the equation. "The value proposition that the Gulf states made to the U.S. government and U.S. tech companies was that they will provide abundant capital, cheap energy and easy construction," said Aaron Bartnick, a White House technology official during the Biden administration. "The Iran war has really flipped

a lot of that math on its head."

The U.A.E. Foreign Ministry and the Abu Dhabi government media office didn't respond to requests for comment. Amazon Web Services said it is working to restore services to its Bahrain and U.A.E. facilities, and that it has provided billing relief for customers who relied on them. The U.A.E. has borne the brunt of Iran's attacks during the war with more than 2,800 drones and missiles sent its way, far more than Iran fired at Israel. To address concerns about strikes, the country's officials have floated the prospect of building data centers underground—which would add to the enormous cost—and placing drone-defense systems near the computing centers, said people familiar with the matter.

For now, though, data is going the other way. The U.A.E., which generally has strict data-sovereignty policies for domestic companies, has allowed some entities to move their data abroad while Amazon works to restore services to its facility in the country, industry insiders said. The Iranian strikes on the Amazon facilities set fires, damaged infrastructure and forced authorities to cut the power. The water used to put out fires caused more damage. Banking apps, corporate services and financial-technology platforms in the region went down as Amazon scrambled to help clients back up their data and move it to the U.S., Europe or elsewhere in Asia. The length of the outage indicates the damage was severe. Even now, more than 130 computing services remain disrupted at its Abu Dhabi facility and 140 at its Bahrain location. Just five in each have been restored. Some tech companies are moving ahead with Gulf data-center projects. They are betting that the war will end eventually and are drawn to the gusher of Gulf capital. Beefing up projects in the Gulf with better defenses could be cheaper and faster than starting over in less favorable locations. Amazon and Microsoft separately said last month that they will still launch data centers in Saudi Arabia by the end of the year. Microsoft struck a deal for a 200 megawatt data center in Abu Dhabi in late 2025. Construction is under way. Cloud-service providers generally want to have data centers close to busy commercial nodes. "The Middle East has a ton of business interest, and cloud providers want to try to capture that growth," said Doug Madora, head of internet analysis at cybersecurity firm Infoblox. "But that calculus is changing with the risks. I compare the data centers to the ships in the Strait of Hormuz—if you hit two, you scare the others off."

U.A.E. officials float the idea of building the centers underground.

Houthi Move Further Squeezes World Oil

By SUMMER SAID AND SALEH AL-BATATI

DUBAI—After sitting out the Iran war, Yemen's Tehran-backed Houthi rebels seized a crucial maritime chokepoint in a lightning offensive over the weekend that further imperiled global energy supplies and injected the group into any effort to resolve the conflict. It is an unusually prominent position for the group's warlord leader, Abdulmalik Al-Houthi, who claims descent from the Prophet Muhammad and rules his impoverished territory through fear and religious fervor. But it's one that reflects the growing ambition of his 350,000-strong militant army and its prowess with tactics, missiles and drones. Last year, the Houthis survived a U.S. bombing campaign with tactics that exhausted the Navy on a long deployment that presaged the difficulty suppressing Iran. This summer, they exploited divisions among their internal opponents and their Arab sponsors amid the distraction of the wider war to expand their domain. On Friday they took Perim Island, which sits in the middle of the strategic Bab al-Mandeb Strait, an 18-mile-wide chokepoint that is to the Red Sea what the Strait of

Hormuz is to the Persian Gulf. They had been preparing for the assault for months. In mid-August, they moved weapons and thousands of troops to positions around the port city of Mokha, threatening their opponents' supply lines. They used their control of Yemeni telecom systems to listen in on their enemies' calls and sow confusion and intimidate their rivals into giving up. The world paid little attention to the group even after it captured the Yemeni capital, San'a, in 2014. Now, it holds one of the world's most important energy corridors and must be reckoned with. "They feel they've won the civil war," said Elisabeth Kendall of Cambridge University's Girton College, who studies Yemen. "They aren't afraid of the United States, and most importantly they're pretty adaptive." The Houthis emerged in the 1990s as significant players in Yemen, a country of about 40 million people. They later leaned on their religious pedigree, a history ruling northern Yemen and harsh repression to expand their territory after the Arab Spring. They fought off intervention by Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates during Yemen's civil war—using cheap drone and missile tech-



Houthi rebels march during a mobilization campaign in San'a.

nology with funding and support from Iran—and consolidated their control over about a third of the country. Disrupting the flow of oil out the waterway would cripple Saudi oil exports bottled up in Hormuz, and risk spiking global oil prices. Mohammed al-Basha, a Yemen expert who runs the Basha Report risk-advisory firm, said the anti-Houthi coalition—which includes fighters who want to see a separate nation in southern Yemen, as well as others aligned with the Muslim Brotherhood and former government forces—is up against a tough, unified opponent. "The Houthis have one leader, one ideology and a clear vision," Basha said. "The anti-Houthi forces have eight armies and multiple commands."

The pressure has grown on the Saudis. Last week, a drone attack that Saudi Arabia believes came from Iraq struck

the kingdom's crucial East-West pipeline. With the Strait of Hormuz under attack by Iran and the Houthis in control of the Bab al-Mandeb, Saudi Arabia's enemies are increasing. Untangling the Houthis' control of Perim Island at the mouth of the Red Sea again may force international powers into Yemen's long war. The U.S. doesn't appear eager to intervene after bombing the Houthis for more than 50 days during Operation Rough Rider in 2025. Even if the Houthis are pushed off the island or further away from the Red Sea, they maintain an arsenal of drones and missiles capable of holding the waterway at risk. That mirrors the Iranian strategy in the current stalemate in the Strait of Hormuz. "They are always going to be able to hold bits of the Red Sea to ransom," Kendall said. "The world only pays attention when it affects their wallets."

WORLDWATCH



SOLEMN FAREWELL: Mourners in Bukavu, Democratic Republic of Congo, on Monday carried coffins containing bodies of 26 children who died in a fire and stampede at a school there.

NATO Rutte Vows to Add To Ukraine Support

NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte said on Monday that Russian drone strikes near the Ukraine-Poland border—one of which hit a train shortly after senior visiting officials had passed through the same station—would drive the military alliance to increase its support for Kyiv, calling Sunday's attacks a sign of Moscow's growing desperation. The strikes "close to NATO territory" show Russian President Vladimir Putin's "desperation and also his desire to sow fear and terror," Rutte said. "Russia is growing increasingly reckless as it continues its terrible war against Ukraine."

Rutte pledged to increase support for Ukraine and bolster the 32-nation alliance's own defenses along its long eastern border with Russia. Sunday's strikes near the Polish border are the latest in a string of incidents officials say point to a deliberate pattern of escalation by Putin.

—Associated Press

AUSTRIA Iran Condemns Ban On Its Nuclear Chief

Iran on Monday condemned the exclusion of the head of its Atomic Energy Organization from the annual gathering of the United Nations nuclear agency in Vienna saying that it constitutes "a serious breach" of Tehran's rights as a member nation. "By obstructing our full and effective participation, the denial of access contravenes both the letter and the spirit of the legal framework" governing attendance at meetings of the International Atomic Energy Agency, Iran's ambassador to the agency, Reza Najafi, told delegates at its general conference.

Najafi criticized Austria, the host country of the IAEA and other United Nations organizations, saying Vienna's decision not to grant a visa to Mohammad Eslami "violates the host country's obligation."

—Associated Press

VATICAN Pope Turns 71, Reverses Pay Cuts

Pope Leo XIV celebrated his 71st birthday on Monday, but it was Vatican employees who got the gift. The Vatican published a papal decree repealing 2021 salary cuts that Pope Francis had imposed on many Vatican employees as part of the Holy See's Covid-19 cost-saving measures. In the decree, Leo said the salary-containing measures "can now be overcome, in the certainty that the institutions of the Holy See and the Vatican City State will continue, through various means, their commitment to ensuring economic sustainability."

The salary cuts included a 10% cut on pay for cardinals and smaller percentage salary cuts for office heads and lower-ranking priests and nuns. Biennial pay raises were frozen for senior lay employees, though lower-ranking lay employees continued to receive raises.

—Associated Press

WORLD NEWS

Crypto Bro Wants His ‘Ex’ to Pay

Sun said he made up romance, but sues actress to recover \$4.5 million bride fee

By Stu Woo

SINGAPORE—Imagine a crypto billionaire paying a supposed \$4.5 million fee so he can marry a Hollywood star—and then hiring a celebrity lawyer to get the cash back when the romance fizzled. That, essentially, is the made-for-TMZ drama that has transfixed China over the past weeks. The real-life cast features Justin Sun, a crypto titan known for elaborate publicity stunts; Jing Tian, a top Chinese actress who has crossed over into Hollywood; and Zhang Qihuai, a big-name lawyer who specializes in high-profile brawls. As the story swept through China, the nation cycled through three collective reactions. First: Wait, those two were together? Second: The bride fee was *how much*? Third: Is any of this actu-



Justin Sun and Jing Tian, in photos not taken together

ally real? That doubt comes partly from Sun's history of viral antics, which include postponing a \$4.6 million charity lunch with Warren Buffett, and buying—and promptly eating—a \$6.2 million banana that had been duct-taped to a wall as art. It also stems from the disclaimer at the bottom of Sun's post on X, titled “My Girlfriend Jing Tian.” In the rambling essay, he said he had a crush on the actress since college, rented out a theater to watch “Zootopia 2” for a date and wired her

family \$4.5 million for a so-called bride fee, a traditional Chinese gift from a groom's family to the bride's family before marriage. He also detailed an intimate encounter involving fingernails. When she later requested \$50 million to have their child via a surrogacy in Southern California, Sun wrote, he consulted the AI model Claude—and took its advice to not pay. Then at the end of the post, he wrote: “This article is entirely fictional; any resemblance to actual events or persons is purely coincidental.”

Yet what followed suggested the drama wasn't entirely fake. That same day, Zhang, the celebrity lawyer, said on Chinese social media that a court had accepted Sun's lawsuit seeking the return of 30 million yuan, equivalent to \$4.5 million, from Jing and her parents. The next day, without specifying what she was referring to, the actress posted that she had “poor judgment” in men but “will never sell my love for money.” She added that “I believe in the law” and that “justice and fairness will ultimately prevail.” A representative for Jing didn't respond to a request for comment. In a written response to questions sent via his lawyer, Sun confirmed the lawsuit was to recover a bride fee. “We dated with marriage in mind,” he said. He said as the couple prepared for medical procedures to have a child in the U.S., the “other party”—whom he didn't name directly—demanded \$50 million. When he refused to pay, he added, the other side cut off contact. “The engagement could no longer proceed,” he said. The mix of star power, wealth and references to an

ancient wedding tradition made the saga an instant media obsession in China. Sun, 36, grew up in China, earned a master's at the University of Pennsylvania and founded blockchain company Tron in 2017. He is now worth about \$8.5 billion, according to Forbes. Jing, 38, has headlined blockbusters in China and Hollywood, starring opposite Matt Damon in “The Great Wall” and appearing in “Kong: Skull Island” and “Pacific Rim Uprising.” She is no stranger to public romance, having previously dated Olympic table-tennis champion Zhang Jike, a national icon. Despite Sun's disclaimer that his account was fiction, some in the Chinese public treated his essay as fact. Many online commentators sided against him for airing details of a private relationship. “To treat his former girlfriend with such viciousness is evil on a whole other level,” Hu Xijin, former editor of the state-run Global Times and one of China's most prominent political commentators, said on social media. But he added that it is reasonable for an unmarried man to ask for his bride fee back.

BOE Is Set To Keep Key Rate On Hold

By Ed Frankl

The Bank of England is set to keep interest rates on hold this week, but rate-setters likely will leave the door open to more tightening as tensions in the Middle East escalate. Investors also are likely to focus on the continued, albeit slower, reduction of the central bank's sovereign-debt portfolio, as yields on those bonds, known as gilts, have reached multidecade highs. The bank has maintained its key policy rate at 3.75% since December 2025, as policymakers were anticipating rate cuts and inflation set to decline heading into 2026. Instead, the outbreak of the U.S.'s war in Iran prompted a radical upward revision of inflation forecasts, ending any chance of policy loosening. Investors now expect at least one quarter-point hike by the end of the year. Despite the hold expected this week, economists think the bank's monetary-policy committee will strike a hawkish tone, noting that energy prices have climbed since the last policy meeting in July. Crude oil rose above \$100 a barrel last week, while European natural-gas costs hit their highest since 2023. In July, the BOE said it expected inflation to average 3.2% in the fourth quarter of the year, from 2.9% that month, taking the level of price growth further above the 2% target. The latest inflation data for August, which rate-setters will see before they make their decision, is expected on Wednesday. Energy prices aren't the only factor driving inflation. The BOE expects food inflation, which has been cooling in recent months, to reach 3.5% by the end of this year. The impact of the conflict on food has been exacerbated by heat waves in Europe, with concerns also mounting over the developing El Niño weather phenomenon. Speaking to lawmakers last week, Bank of England Gov. Andrew Bailey said the balance of inflation risks remain to the upside. Even if the monetary-policy committee's guidance remains noncommittal, it is expected to say it stands ready to act. Most of policymakers, however, continue to see little evidence of second-round effects, such as those that feed into increased wages, a factor that could prompt a cycle of ever higher prices. That gives policymakers “breathing space to sit back and see how things play out,” Oxford Economics chief U.K. economist Andrew Goodwin said in a note. “We we expect the MPC to hold [the policy] rate at 3.75% until well into next year.”

To Escape the Heat, Some Europeans Are Moving North

By Yusuf Khan

After nearly a decade in Spain's Costa del Sol, the heat was becoming unbearable for Gabriele Pohl. Temperatures soaring above 100 degrees Fahrenheit were making it difficult to go out during the day, and water shortages were making her business, which uses horses to coach business leaders, untenable. Last winter, she and her husband moved to Tomiño, a small town in Galicia, in northern Spain, near the Portuguese border. “You go northwest if you want enough water, you want good temperatures, you want green fields, you want good food and good wine,” said the 58-year-old Pohl. She is one of a number of Europeans who are moving north in search of cooler weather and greener pastures. Drought and heat waves made much of Europe a tinderbox this summer, with wildfires raging across parts of Spain, France and Greece. River levels in Germany dropped to record lows, and England's green fields turned

straw yellow. The conditions have helped make new areas of the continent more appealing for Europe's wealthy and middle classes. Internal-migration data is patchy, but the most recent information from Spain in 2024 showed northern provinces were growing as Spaniards migrated there from other parts of the country. Property prices suggest the trend has continued. House prices in northern Spanish provinces such as Cantabria and Asturias rose 17.2% and 14.1%, respectively, year-over-year in August, according to data from Idealista, a Spanish real-estate website. That is much faster than major cities such as Barcelona and Madrid, which have seen increases of about 7%. It's a similar story in France, where cities such as Caen, Le Havre and Brest on the Atlantic coast had roughly 9% increases in property prices during the first half of 2026 compared with the same period last year, according to Notaires de France, a directory of notaries that publishes property data. Bordeaux, which has



Last winter, Gabriele Pohl and her husband moved north from Spain's Costa del Sol to Tomiño, a small town in Galicia.

experienced huge wildfires this year, fell 2%. Florence Chapelier, 53, moved to Normandy from the south of France last year, uprooting her and her husband's architectural-design business. She said summers in Aix-en-Provence, where she used to live, had become so hot that her cats were struggling to breathe. “It became a permanent fight against the climate. We were just surviving, not living.” She said she has moved to a larger property for the same price as her old house, and she

can return to her hobbies of gardening and swimming, having been forced to stay inside during the summer in her old home. For areas in Spain, more days above 95 degrees Fahrenheit tends to translate into lower sales and rental prices, according to research by Adrian Fernandez-Perez, assistant professor at the University College of Dublin. “For real-estate developers and investors, they highlight profitable opportunities in cooler regions, where housing demand is shifting,” he said.

It isn't just the heat. Researchers in Italy have found persistent droughts can cause people to relocate, leaving rural agricultural communities behind in search of more viable land. Olive growers in Italy, for example, have migrated north in recent years. Rising insurance premiums also prompt moves. In France, premiums for multirisk home insurance, which includes natural disasters, rose 8.4% in 2025, according to France Assureurs, an industry group. Catastrophe premiums are expected to rise by more than 200% by 2050 in southern regions, compared with 100% increases in more northern and inland areas, according to an analysis by the French Prudential Supervision and Resolution Authority, which oversees the country's banking and insurance sectors. “All things that affect your home, your mortgage, the value of your home, your ability to insure your home affordably, property taxes—all of those things tend to play a role in people's decisions about staying in a particular community or maybe going somewhere else,” said Koko Warner, director of the University of Pennsylvania's International Climate Observatory. FJ Unger, a 65-year-old entrepreneur, moved to Galicia in northwestern Spain in 2022, drawn in part by the relatively cool summers. The big beaches, high-quality food and lower house prices were a bonus, he said. “Everywhere else in Spain, you're now looking at virtually all regions hovering between” 90 and 105 degrees Fahrenheit, said Unger. “That is boiling.”

Mallorca Aims to Ditch Rowdy British Tourists for Rich American Ones

By Chelsea Dulaney and Andrea Figueras

MALLORCA, Spain—This Mediterranean island is a tourist paradise, with glittering turquoise seas, hidden coves and endless white-sand beaches that have been luring Europeans for generations. It also is the epicenter of Europe's backlash to overtourism. Residents have taken to the streets and beaches this summer to protest the island's growing flock of visitors, united by one message: “Tourists, go home.” The island—roughly 125 miles east of the Spanish mainland, with a population of about one million—is on track to welcome about 14 million tourists this year. They pour in on cruise ships, budget airline flights and tour buses run by vacation-package companies. During the summer, the island's daily population can rise by 50%. Mallorca's tourism model is a victim of its own success, as overcrowding risks eroding what made it special. Local politicians are trying to calm the backlash from residents—without jeopardizing the revenue that is the lifeblood of the economy. The flood of tourists has



The Magaluf beach has been a target of the government's crackdown on ‘excess tourism.’

pushed the island's infrastructure to its limit, leading to traffic jams, strained water resources and a severe shortage of affordable housing for locals. On the outskirts of the capital, Palma, some residents who can no longer afford an apartment live in sprawling communities of camper vans. Some on the island have called for radical tourism-containment measures, such as an outright limit on visitors.

Mallorca's leaders are testing a different solution: a rebrand. The island wants to shed its reputation as a hot spot for British bachelor parties and thrifty package-holidayers and transform into a luxury destination for high-rolling tourists like Americans. “Tourism is our way of life,” said Pedro Homar, managing director of Palma's tourism board. “The change of model is quality over quantity.

We need to have less tourists that spend more.” Mallorca's beaches and hill-top villages have been a popular hangout for foreign writers, artists and musicians for more than a century. But it was Spanish dictator Francisco Franco's tourism push in the 1950s and '60s that transformed Mallorca from a quiet agricultural community into a mass tourism destination. Franco saw foreign tourism as

a way to soften the image of his authoritarian regime internationally—under the slogan “Spain is different!” Low-cost packages from British and German tour operators opened the island up for thousands of Europeans. Mallorca's reputation as a cheap party destination has long frustrated locals, who complain of public drunkenness, nudity and drug use. But the island's reliance on tourism has made attempts at change difficult. Tourism accounts for nearly half of economic activity in the Balearic Islands, the archipelago that Mallorca is part of, said Exceltur, a tourism nonprofit. Homar, the Palma tourism official, has for years been working to attract a new type of tourist: wealthier, quieter, interested in traveling outside the peak summer season. And above all: American. “They travel with the idea of understanding the culture, mingling with the locals, buying local arts and crafts,” he said. “We are no longer appealing to tourists in the U.K. [or] Germany, whose main motivation is partying and drinking.” U.S. tourists in Spain spend more than any other nationality: about \$410 a day in July, compared with \$240 by Ger-

mans and \$260 by British travelers, show government data. By many accounts, Mallorca has succeeded in dispelling hard-partiers. On parts of the island, authorities implemented fines for drunken behavior, banned party boats and limited drinks at all-inclusive hotels to six a day. Germans and Brits still make up about half of Mallorca's tourists, but U.S. visits have surged 60% this year through June. United Airlines has expanded direct flights to the island from its hub in Newark, N.J. Boutique hotels catering to Americans have sprung up across the island. Hospitality executive Maria Martínez had to train workers on how to serve Americans' needs: They want more small talk, guidance on itineraries and are more interested in the island's history. The chain she works for, IT Mallorca Unique Spaces, has six boutique hotels on the island, and Americans are its main client group. Wealthy South Koreans are another group of coveted tourists. Newlywed Sukyung Lee spent four days in Mallorca in September for her honeymoon. She loved Caló des Moro, a beach nestled between cliffs. “The ocean is beautiful...it's famous for a reason.”

New Apple Siri Is Something To Talk About

New iOS 27 includes the AI boost but only for newer models starting with the iPhone 15 Pro



PERSONAL TECHNOLOGY

NICOLE NGUYEN

Last week, I was at a parking machine and needed to input my license plate number. I don't have it committed to memory, so I asked Siri. Immediately it rattled off the numbers and letters, which it found in a photo of my vehicle registration renewal notice. Wait a minute—this new Siri *actually helps*?

For the past couple of months, I've experienced the magical highs—and a few disappointing lows—of Siri's Apple Intelligence overhaul. Now you can too. iOS 27, which includes Siri AI, is ready to download.

Back up your iPhone, then go to Settings > General > Software Update to start the download. If you prefer stability, wait a few weeks for the first update with bug fixes.

And yes, I know there's much talk of an AI doomsday.

Even with its new superpowers, this Siri isn't the type of cutting-edge AI that's stoking the concerns, but you can still opt out in Settings.

iOS 27 marks the beginning of an iPhone divide. Only Apple Intelligence-capable newer models starting with the iPhone 15 Pro will get Siri AI and other AI-powered features. Older iPhones get less flashy tricks. This split makes Apple's release more confusing, so I divided this guide into two parts.

For the newer iPhones

Siri AI: There are now new ways to get to Siri AI, aside from the usual "Hey Siri."

► Swipe down on the black pill at the top of your screen

► Siri mode in the Camera app—hold Photo then swipe left

► A dedicated Siri app, which also contains your conversation history

The iPhone's live-in assistant now relies, in part, on Google's Gemini models to answer questions. Siri AI can look through your iPhone's most private data, which you wouldn't want ending up in a data breach or training a future model. Apple says for cloud-based requests, the company doesn't



In the new interface, Siri can look at a message in Gmail and interpret its contents.

store your data, and neither Apple nor Google can access it.

For the most part, Siri AI is far less embarrassing than classic Siri, but like other chatbots, it's sometimes wrong. It also takes a beat longer than ChatGPT and Claude to respond and acts more cautiously compared with those bots, warning that it "may make mistakes" and is "not a doctor."

On-screen awareness: Siri can see whatever is on your screen, no matter the app.

While watching a video of a pastry class I took, I realized I forgot the name of the dessert. Siri quickly got it right, "Tarte Tropézienne."

While on the U.S. Open's website, I asked Siri to add the semifinals and finals schedule to my Google calendar via Apple's Calendar app. In Gmail, Siri compiled a packing checklist from a school email.

Camera smarts: In the camera's Siri mode, point the camera at an object and tap the Siri icon for an immediate response. You can tap the speech bubble icon to type a question, or the magnifying glass to search for the object on Google



and other platforms.

Suggested actions will pop up automatically for certain items: Snap a snack or dish to see its nutritional value; snap a receipt to calculate how to split the bill.

Personal context: Siri can search for content across Apple's native apps, such as Messages. After I first enabled the assistant, it took Siri several days to completely index my phone's content.

Asking, "When was my son's dentist appointment?" pulled the date from a text reminder, while "What's my passport number?" retrieved the data from Photos.

This aspect of Siri AI—potentially its most powerful—will only be successful if developers let their apps work with Apple's assistant. My most-used services aren't made by Apple, including WhatsApp, Signal, Slack and Google's apps.

These companies might be working on their own assistants, and a Siri integration could be seen as aiding and abetting the competition.

Photo make-believe: I'm conflicted about the new suite of Apple Intelligence photo-editing tools. Is it magic—or deception?

On any photo, tap Edit, then Tools. The Extend button zooms out on close-ups, generating visuals to fill the empty space. Meanwhile, Reframe lets you pivot the subjects in your picture, so that it looks like you were in a different spot when you snapped the photo.

In a few pictures, the tools did weird stuff to faces where there wasn't enough information, but I was generally impressed—and creeped out—by the results.

Custom wallet passes: I initially thought this was a meh update, but it's already saved me several times. My husband and I share a pass to our local pool that I constantly forget at home. Now I have a digital version on my phone.

In Wallet, tap on the plus sign to Create a Pass, and point the camera at any ticket or membership card.

For all iPhones

Even if you have a model as old as the iPhone 11, there's plenty of practical improvements for you in iOS 27, not to mention performance boosters, such as up to 80% faster AirDrop transfers. Here are some non-AI perks:

Less Liquid Glass: Remember last year's interface redesign, the one nobody asked for? Menus are now less transparent by default, and a

slider in Settings > Appearance > Liquid Glass lets you adjust the opacity to your liking.

Green bubble replies: You can now send in-line replies and emoji reactions to photos in iPhone-Android conversations over Rich Communication Services or RCS. Enable it in Settings > Apps > Messages. Many carriers also now support end-to-end encrypted RCS messaging.

Alarm volume setting: If you've ever suffered a late wake-up because of a too-quiet alarm, go to Settings > Sounds & Haptics and under Alarms and Timers, disable Match Ringtone Volume to set an independent alarm volume.

Hide location: To temporarily shield your location without notifying them, go to Find My > People, select a contact, tap the ellipses and choose Hide Location. It's ideal for surprise parties—or avoiding friends' FOMO if you're doing something cool without them.

XL widgets: You can now fill an entire page of your homescreen with a single widget. Tap and hold the home screen, and select the paint brush at top left, select Add Widget, then scroll through options. Not all widgets have a full-screen option, but my favorite one, Photos, does.

Watch a Video

Scan code for a video explaining Siri's major upgrade in Apple's new iOS 27 software update.



New Option May Cut Your Mortgage Rate

By VERONICA DAGHER

One simple request might help you score a lower mortgage rate while costs are soaring. You can now ask your lender to pull your credit score using VantageScore 4.0, if it hasn't already, or you can find a lender willing to do it. This is an alternative scoring model that makes some borrowers look more creditworthy.

The ability to do this is new. For years, government-backed mortgage giants Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac relied exclusively on classic FICO scores to evaluate creditworthiness and set mortgage rates, and most lenders still pull only FICO scores. This month, however, Fannie and Freddie's regulator said all lenders are free to use VantageScore 4.0 as well—and the lender can pick the one that results in the best rate.

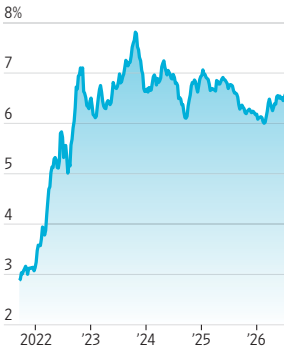
Someone with a top-of-the-line FICO score won't see improvement by also pulling the VantageScore, but others might. If you do get a higher score, it could push you into a bucket of borrowers who are correspondingly charged lower fees by Fannie and Freddie to back the loan. (Fannie and Freddie stand behind a swath of the mortgage market and help set standards across the industry.)

When a lender evaluates both scoring models, roughly one in four home buyers ends up in a higher

credit-score range, according to estimates by Nick Maciunas, managing director at JPMorgan Chase. For borrowers who jump a score bracket, Maciunas estimates that saving 1% in upfront loan adjustment fees translates to roughly a quarter-point drop in their interest rate.

That could be a significant difference with the average 30-year fixed mortgage rate at 6.76% last week, the highest level in more than a year, according to Freddie Mac. The Treasury yields that also help determine going mortgage rates and a host of other borrowing costs have

Average 30-year fixed mortgage rate



Source: Freddie Mac via St. Louis Fed



been on the rise recently, thanks to investor worries about inflation.

Chris Sbonek, president and chief executive of Mitten Mortgage Lending in Trenton, Mich., has been pulling both classic FICO and VantageScore 4.0 credit reports for his clients since United Wholesale Mortgage—one of his primary wholesale lenders—introduced the option.

Sbonek has seen VantageScore 4.0 help qualify some borrowers who previously failed to qualify for a mortgage. In many cases, buyers who are already qualified are securing lower interest rates, he said. But the results are all over the place. For other borrowers, he's seen no substantial difference between VantageScore 4.0 and classic FICO, and in some cases FICO offers the higher score.

He gave the following example of how a borrower might benefit. On a \$400,000 loan, a borrower with a 680 classic FICO score might re-

VantageScore 4.0 is an alternative scoring model that makes some borrowers look more creditworthy.

ceive a 6.959% rate on a 30-year fixed mortgage. If that same buyer has a 740 VantageScore 4.0, Sbonek could qualify him or her for a 6.5% rate, saving the home buyer roughly \$44,000 in interest over 30 years.

Credit scores are measured as a number between 300 and 850, and VantageScore 4.0 tends to run higher than classic FICO, though it can differ by borrower. Fannie and Freddie's new pricing models factor in the differences by effectively subtracting 20 points from the VantageScore and then applying the same credit score buckets as FICO.

The two models evaluate credit differently. Classic FICO offers a snapshot at a single moment while VantageScore 4.0 analyzes 24 months of trended balance and pay-

ment data. It also factors in alternative data like rent and utility payments and requires less credit history to generate a score.

When a mortgage lender pulls your classic FICO score or VantageScore 4.0, it traditionally pulls reports from all three credit bureaus and uses your middle score to help determine your rate. VantageScore was created as a joint venture by the three major credit bureaus—Equifax, Experian and TransUnion.

"Different scoring models use different methodologies, which is why consumers receive different scores or fall into different score ranges depending on the model being used," a FICO spokeswoman said.

The Federal Housing Finance Agency directed Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac to approve VantageScore 4.0 for all lenders after previously giving the option to a smaller pool of them, including United Wholesale Mortgage and Rocket Mortgage. While credit scores are a major factor in the kind of interest rate you get on a loan, they are evaluated alongside income, assets and debt-to-income ratios.

Bill Banfield, chief business officer at Rocket Mortgage, said a home buyer with a longer history of maintaining low debt balances and paying bills on time may show a higher score with VantageScore 4.0, which can lead to better mortgage pricing.

VantageScore 4.0 has been used for years in auto loans and credit cards, but the company said it is too early in its rollout for mortgage originators to say whether it consistently produces higher scores across the board.

PERSONAL JOURNAL.

A Dead Father Is Reincarnated With AI

One man’s creation of a chatbot using his dad’s writings and voice recordings raises existential questions for us all



FAMILY & TECH
JULIE JARGON

Brian Dema routinely turns to his father for business advice. His father died four years ago, but Dema created an AI version of him. J. Richard Dema, a former marketer and entertainment producer in Chicago, had left behind five filing cabinets of work-related documents including client notes and an unfinished book. Dema fed all 17,500 pages into Anthropic’s Claude chatbot in an effort to create his very own “RichieBot.” Then Dema wondered if he could train the bot to sound like his father using voicemail messages he had saved from him. What if he could also create a three-dimensional image of his dad? Dema, who owns a marketing firm in Chicago, put his team to work and solicited help from friends, including a Stanford psychologist who helped design the chatbot’s personality. In all, 19 people worked for six months to bring Richard Dema back to life. Using a 3-D-printed model of his father’s head, a TV screen and an angled mirror, he created what looked like a hologram of his father. “We were very intentional about the uncanny valley nature of this, so we made it intentionally abstract,” Dema says. “Initially it had

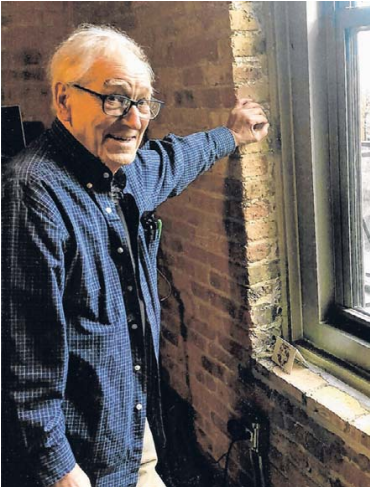
kind of a scary smile, so we went with a more pensive expression.” Dema unveiled RichieBot during a tech event in Chicago in July. People lined up to ask it questions and it enthusiastically provided answers, declining when it didn’t know. His marketing firm filmed the process for a 20-minute documentary it plans to premier in San Francisco later this month, followed by a debut on YouTube. Dema’s project cost \$150,000, and was intended in part to show prospective clients his firm’s storytelling capabilities. Yet AI experts say in a matter of years we will all be able to create similar AI likenesses of our loved ones—with less money and effort. At that point, the real question will be: Should we?

Our bots, our selves People have been creating basic AI companions for the last two years, and AI experts say the technology is already good enough to create clumsy AI models of real people. In less than five years, most people will have their own AI agents helping them perform daily tasks, all the while amassing a wealth of personal data, both meaningful and mundane, says Jed Brubaker, an associate professor of information science at the University of Colorado-Boulder, who has published a paper on AI ghosts. “People are always dying,” he says. “That shifts the AI agent from being the thing you use to it being your AI ghost.” But using an AI agent to pre-



Brian Dema created a 3-D avatar, top photo, of his late father, Richard Dema, above and right, for people to interact with.

serve the legacy of a loved one can be tricky, especially if people use it to help them through their grief, says Brubaker. “One of the most important things that happens after you lose someone is accommodation, meaning you start to adapt to a new normal,” he says. “If people are turning to this technology to avoid the reality of their loss, there is some risk there.” There’s also the risk that uploading a loved one’s emails, texts and chatlogs to AI could result in learning something you didn’t want to know about that person. Among the piles of information might be evidence of an affair, or of beliefs they held that you might find offensive.



Brian Dema, top photo, fed thousands of pages of his father’s notes into AI to create a chatbot version of J. Richard Dema, who died four years ago. Above, a visitor to a tech event showing the dad’s 3-D image and chatbot.

including a questionnaire that measures five main personality traits, to determine how well the bot’s personality matched a profile of Richard created from a detailed survey of the 11 people closest to him. Those people included cousins, friends and former clients. They found that the bot sounded more extroverted than Richard, but that it was lacking in his humor. “My father had a very distinctive laugh, which the bot didn’t have,” Dema says. “It’s not my dad but it doesn’t mean it doesn’t feel good when he gives me advice.” Some of the people who knew Dema’s father had mixed feelings about the bot, including a cousin who found it emotionally difficult. He expects his father would have approved of him creating the bot. Still, Dema grapples with the bigger questions it poses for individuals and for society. “Should we do this?” Dema asks. “My conclusion is I think we should, with the right guardrails. It can be an amazing way to remember someone, but we have to be careful.”

Our AI afterlife preferences will also start appearing in more wills. Lilian Edwards, a professor of law and technology at Newcastle University in England, says people should state how they want their digital information to be handled after they die. They should also add legacy contacts to their online and social-media accounts. “We type so much into Google and ChatGPT now,” she says. “Do we want a record of all of that to be kept? Should all of this be wiped by default?”

An existential question Even if someone creates an AI personality based on all of a person’s digital files, how closely can it mimic the actual person? Dema’s psychologist friend used three psychological instruments,

Sand, Beer And Dogs On the Pitch

Continued from Page One here as the game of the English upper classes, is having something of a revival. There are various theories: More people from England have come to live in Scotland; Bucknall is from Yorkshire and moved north years ago. Immigration from the cricket-mad nations of the old British Empire has provided a shot in the arm. But Scots with little experience are also beginning to play it as an alternative to soccer and rugby, and a run of warmer, drier summers could help explain why. “We’ve not had to cancel a game in two years,” said John Amis, chair at the Bass Rock Cricket Club, which plays across from Elie on the southern side of the Firth of Forth. In the past, Scottish cricket teams might travel 100 miles to find competition, only to be rained out. For a sport that can take hours or days, with batters running up and down to gradually accumulate points rather than rounding bases like in baseball, this was a nuisance. If the weather holds up, the sight of cricket-curious Scots knocking a ball about on a summer’s day could soon be filed alongside some of the



odder consequences of climate change, like vineyards in Sweden or growing mangoes in Sicily. “There are more people playing cricket in Scotland now than rugby,” noted Duncan Hodge, a former Scottish international rugby star who was captaining a team of former players who’d switched to cricket for a match at the Ship Inn. **From left, ‘hydration breaks’ consist of pitchers of beer; the club has been around for more than 30 years.**



The Ship Inn draws stars like soccer legend Ally McCoist, far left, with its unique grounds.

“The touring sides are expecting a decent game when they come here,” he said. “The standard has definitely improved.” Not that the players are necessarily in peak condition. “I think for a lot of us it’s an opportunity to tap in to our school days again,” says Ship Inn player Jamie Robertson. “It’s only 15 games a year, anyway.” New fans are coming from the pub’s beach-front beer garden. Scott Carrick began watching cricket on television during the pandemic and gradually figured out the nuances. “It was a good thing to have on

in the background while working from home,” he said. Since then he’s traveled across England to watch matches, including at Lord’s. Carrick concedes the game still has niche appeal in Scotland. It’s usually limited to those who learned it at a private school or in more rural areas. “I’d say about 90% of my mates don’t get it,” Carrick said. But it helps if it’s played on a beach on a warm, sunny day. As the tide receded, Bucknall and his team hitched a heavy steel roller to the back of a quad bike to pack down the sand. Stray bits of seaweed were flung to the side. Bats were lined up while Bucknall explained some of beach cricket’s more unusual rules. “If a spectator catches a ball in the beer garden, then they win their height in beer, or soft drinks as appropriate.” As the match progressed, some spectators formed their own games farther down the beach. A few of their cries could be heard above the seagulls. “Good shot, sir,” one man said. “Well bowled!” shouted another. Not everyone seemed to have grasped the game’s finer points. One man was spotted riding his cricket bat like a hobby horse toward the dunes, slapping his backside in the breeze.



ARTS IN REVIEW

By Heidi Waleson

Philadelphia Opera Philadelphia opened its season last week at the Academy of Music with a rarity: Mozart’s “Mitridate, re di Ponto,” written in 1770 for Milan when the composer was 14 years old. Opera seria in style, the piece has flashes of the mature Mozart, but it is predominantly a procession of display arias written for virtuoso singers. Fortunately, the company was able to field a highly capable cast: tenor Lawrence Brownlee in the title role; countertenor (and OP general director and president) Anthony Roth Costanzo as his treacherous son, Farnace; Meredith Wohlgenuth as Farnace’s brother, Sifare; and, in a last-minute substitution, soprano Brenda Rae as Aspasia, the object of everyone’s desire.

Vittorio Amedeo Cigna-Santi’s libretto, based on a 1673 tragedy by Jean Racine, is political and personal. Mitridate is trying to hold onto his kingdom, Pontus, against the advance of the Roman Empire. Having pretended to die in battle to test the loyalty of his sons, he returns home to find them both in love with Aspasia, his fiancée. The updated production by director Emma Griffin leaned into the story’s “Succession” undercurrents, with the not-quite-toothless old lion lashing out at those he sees as eager to supplant him.

The arias follow the conventions of the period with plenty of coloratura and opportunities to show off, but Mozart’s preternatural ability to create character is already present. Of the two angry men, Mr. Brownlee’s raging Mitridate was quite a different creature from Mr. Costanzo’s sly, malicious Farnace. (He is secretly in league with the Romans, who have promised him the throne.) Mr. Costanzo also shifted gears brilliantly for Farnace’s 11th-hour change of heart, the exquisitely meditative “Già dagli occhi,” as he decides to join his father against the Romans.

Ms. Rae grew in richness and assurance as the evening progressed, capturing the constant torment of Aspasia—who hates Farnace, secretly loves Sifare, and is dutifully prepared to go through with the planned wedding to their



OPERA REVIEW

Young Mozart’s Music

Opera Philadelphia stages a work written by the composer at age 14

father until he threatens everyone with death. Ms. Wohlgenuth proved a real find as the gentle Sifare, who remains loyal to Mitridate despite everything. Her pure, warm soprano shone especially in the lament “Lungi da te, mio bene” with its mournful horn accompaniment, as Sifare realizes the hopelessness of his and Aspasia’s love. Later, the two blended poignantly in the opera’s only duet, in which they grieve over their seemingly inevitable fate—they must die together.

The smaller roles were also capably handled. Soprano Nola Richardson sang Ismene, a princess once loved by Farnace; mezzo



Sarah Coit was Arbate, a peace-making ally of Mitridate and his sons, and Minghao Liu brought a striking high tenor to Marzio, Farnace’s Roman contact. The roles of Farnace, Sifare and Arbate were

originally written for castrati; the music for this all-high-voice cast proved varied enough that one didn’t miss the bass notes. Conductor Corrado Rovaris tended to push the tempi, however, which heightened the excitement but left little space for expressivity and nuance in the rage arias and other moments of high drama.

Ms. Griffin’s production looked under-resourced. Kaye Voyce’s set placed a random collection of contemporary furniture (sofas, an office desk and chair, a globe) against a patchwork backdrop of dull-colored flags. A posse of extras clad in white jumpsuits and little black aprons would occasionally

Lawrence Brownlee (left) and Anthony Roth Costanzo (center), left, and Brenda Rae, below, in ‘Mitridate, re di Ponto,’ directed by Emma Griffin.

flood the set, tidying up and moving the furniture into new configurations. This often happened during arias, creating a regrettable focus disturbance for the audience.

Masha Tsimring’s lighting was glaring, luridly hued, or strangely flat. Ms. Voyce’s hodgepodge of costumes included patterned velvet leisure suits with balloon pants for the brothers, a nod to their geographic origin (Pontus was part of modern-day Turkey), and chic outfits for the women—Aspasia in a flowing white trouser ensemble, Ismene in a regal gold kimono and turban. Mitridate sported a red military uniform.

Staging da capo arias is always a challenge, and Ms. Griffin often fell into the trap of extremes—Mr. Brownlee and Mr. Costanzo tossed chairs around, leaped acrobatically onto furniture and ripped things up—or stasis. One bold choice did work well. As Marzio sang his only aria, summoning Farnace to war, he changed his outfit, making Farnace hand him armor pieces like a servant. The realization that he is merely a tool of the Romans thus seemed to prompt Farnace’s return to the family fold.

At the end, Mitridate, fearing capture by the Romans in the battle, commits suicide for real, reconciling with both sons before he expires. (The white-suited servants were already strewn around the stage, casualties of war.) The remaining characters then sing an extremely brief ensemble vowing to resist the power of Rome. That finale should demonstrate the triumph of good over evil, but Marzio gunned them all down instead. We were back to “Succession,” in which the outsider, rather than one of the children, gets the plum job. In this production, the Romans got the last word—which, of course, eventually they did.

Ms. Waleson writes about opera for the Journal and is the author of “Mad Scenes and Exit Arias: The Death of the New York City Opera and the Future of Opera in America” (Metropolitan).

DOMINIC MERCER

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk

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SIMPLY DASHING | By Grant Conley

Across	30 Texas city named for a Ukrainian city	64 SoFi Stadium footballer	8 “___ live and breathe!”
1 Bearded Smurf			9 Free of suds
5 Some Cubans	34 Poetic feet	65 Turn sour, as milk	10 George of “The Goldbergs”
11 Mama’s boy	37 Political partner (or a possible product of 17- and 23-Across?)	66 Post-shower attire	11 Big cat of Africa?
14 Farming prefix		67 Planetarium depiction	12 Grand Marnier flavoring
15 Outfit for an infant		68 Declares	13 Phrase tacked on for emphasis
16 Debate side	40 Anvil sound	69 At some previous point	18 Astronaut Jemison
17 Many a modern business session (or a hasty tryst?)	41 Is penitent	Down	22 Deceives
19 Emmy winner Holbrook	44 Catcher’s wear	1 Nobel-winning poet Octavio	23 Angsty music genre
20 Honeyed drinks	47 End for spy, kiss or nanny	2 Earlier than now	24 Checked, on a form
21 Solution in an IV drip	49 Dog doc	3 Supplier of forgotten lines, for stage actors	
23 Share one’s thoughts (or what may develop after 17-Across?)	50 Next of kin (or possible outcome of 17-, 23- and 37-Across?)	4 Person drawing a bead	
27 Citi Field player	56 Headline	5 New Yale students of 1969	
28 Boston’s Liberty Tree, e.g.	57 Wide valleys	6 Actually existing	
29 Former flames	58 Do the wrong thing	7 Acquire	
	59 Event where the romance in 17-, 23-, 37- and 50-Across may start?		

► Solve this puzzle online and discuss it at [WSJ.com/Puzzles](https://www.wsj.com/puzzles).

Previous Puzzle’s Solution

BOBA	MALTA	LADS
TOES	ASLAN	OLEO
SHAKES	HACK	ULNA
GOSH	MILO	TIN
SALUT	WATERSHED	
ONETOGO	BOARS	
WAS	OKS	AINTSO
SEASHANTY		
OSMOND	ELK	CDS
FAINT	OHSHOOT	
FINGERHUT	HASTY	
EDY	REOS	SALT
RIAN	ROUGHHOUSE	
EDNA	ATARI	EMIL
DOSE	NYLON	SERIF

ARTS CALENDAR

HAPPENINGS FOR THE WEEK OF SEPTEMBER 15

By WSJ Arts in Review Staff

Film

“Resident Evil” (Sept. 18)

The zombie-survival videogame franchise gets another film installment with this story from Zach Cregger (“Weapons”) about a medical courier who must fight his way though infected mobs to deliver an important parcel.

“The Weight” (Sept. 18)

In the 1930s, a father is placed in a work camp in Oregon and given hope for an early release if he helps smuggle gold across treacherous wilds, threatened not just by natural threats but also human betrayal. Ethan Hawke, Russell Crowe, Julia Jones, Austin Amelio and Avi Nash star in Padraic McKinley’s feature debut.

star in the latest chapter of Ryan Murphy and Ian Brennan’s anthology series.

Exhibitions

“Doll Dressing” (The Museum at FIT, New York, Sept. 16-Jan. 3, 2027)

The largely unexplored relationship between dolls and fashion is the subject of this show that features more than 170 objects—dolls and their clothing as well as full-size garments, artworks, accessories and more—to explore the way children’s playthings have reflected and even inspired what we’ve worn in the 20th and 21st centuries.

Theater

“The Cherry Orchard” (Park Avenue Armory, New York, Sept. 16-26)

Director Simon Stone reimagines Anton Chekhov’s fi-

atmospheric, cinematic style that featured prominently in his early career.

Miley Cyrus, “Bass Persuades” (Sept. 18)

Now releasing music mononymously as Miley, the singer drops an album focused on romantic relationships and the importance of loving oneself.

Art

“Taryn Simon | Father Country I Do Love You” (Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum, New York, Sept. 18-March 14, 2027)

Photographs, videos, texts and sculptures come together in one massive interactive installation that fills the museum’s rotunda in a project that traces the life of an unnamed real-life federal agent and explores how his decisions shape the world around him in ways both immediately apparent and less obvious.

“Sacred Splendor: Jewish Ritual Art and Christian Treasures From St. Vitus Cathedral in Prague” (Jewish Museum, New York, Sept. 18-Feb. 7, 2027)

Some 170 religious vessels from medieval and early modern Europe reveal the ways that spiritual beliefs and creative beauty cut across time, place and doctrine in a presentation that mingles international loans with the museum’s own treasures.

Last Call

“The Etruscans: From the Heart of Ancient Italy” (Fine Arts Museums of San Francisco, Legion of Honor, through Sept. 20)

This survey dedicated to the ancient society, ranging from detailed works in gold to bronze ritual objects, “deftly—and rightfully—elevates our knowledge of this ancient civilization” in the words of our critic.

Write to brian.kelly@wsj.com.

NETFLIX



Ella Beatty stars in ‘Monster: The Lizzie Borden Story.’

TV

“Neagley” (Prime Video, Sept. 16)

“Reacher” gets a spinoff focused on its super-buff protagonist’s former military colleague, played by Maria Sten, who gets the action as a Chicago P.I.

“Monster: The Lizzie Borden Story” (Netflix, Sept. 17)

Ella Beatty (“If I Had Legs I’d Kick You”) plays the Massachusetts woman who took an ax and . . . well, you know the rest. Vicky Krieps, Rebecca Hall and Charlie Hunnam also

nal play in this North American premiere, which moves the action from Russia to a rapidly changing South Korea where siblings and corporate heirs struggle to adapt to a quickly evolving economic landscape and to navigate the financial stresses the situation places on their family. Park Hae-soo (“Squid Game”) and Jeon Do-yeon star.

Music

Beck, “Ride Lonesome” (Sept. 18)

The genre-hopping artist’s first studio LP since 2019’s “Hyperspace” embraces the

OPINION

Higher Ed Will Soon Get Patriotic



GLOBAL VIEW
By Walter Russell Mead

The return of great-power competition is u p e n d i n g global institutions and re-shaping the world economy. It is also accelerating changes in A m e r i c a n higher education, putting wind in the sails of those wanting reform and undercutting the efforts of those trying to keep college woke.

With the apparent end of history and of serious geopolitical competition in the 1990s, patriotism became an embarrassing relic of earlier times to large chunks of American business. Technology, finance and manufacturing companies operating in what Thomas Friedman called the “flat world” of the post-historical era increasingly saw themselves as citizens of the world rather than American companies with a stake in the success of the American project.

In that kind of world, companies like McKinsey and Google didn’t necessarily want a bunch of superpatriotic American employees. On the contrary, the ability to function in a global and cosmopolitan culture mattered more for corporate and therefore individual success than the depth and degree of an employee’s patriotism or commitment to American civic values and norms.

That world is dying, nowhere more quickly than in the tech industry, where U.S.-

China competition is the name of the game. The idea that software engineers would refuse to work for the Pentagon or only do so under duress might once have been tolerable, but no more. This isn’t only because defense contracts are and will remain important to many Silicon Valley firms. It’s also because the greatest threat to many enterprises is intellectual-property theft by Chinese firms. Tech CEOs losing sleep over IP security want patriotic workers who wouldn’t dream of selling out their country or employer to bad actors overseas.

In finance, the change is coming more slowly, but as banks approach opportunities in China with caution, patriotism is beginning to matter more on Wall Street. It will likely matter more as international frictions increase along with the reputational costs and financial risks associated with business in China. In manufacturing, as Mr. Friedman’s flat world yields to the more rugged landscape of our time and supply-chain security looms larger as a factor in corporate investment, we are likely to see a similar intellectual reshoring of the American elite.

Smart corporate recruiters will be seeking graduates who don’t want to abolish capitalism, globalize the *intifada* or destroy the U.S. Given the rise of antibusiness sentiment among DSA Democrats and MAGA Republicans, firms will increasingly see the value of being perceived by the public as loyal, productive members of Team America.

Despite the sometimes robust evidence to the contrary, college students and universities aren’t unintelligent. When top tech companies, law firms and investment banks wanted global citizens, the elite educational complex churned them out. Now colleges are beginning to respond to changing signals from these employers.

Renewed great-power rivalry will suppress employer demand for ‘citizens of the world.’

Change will likely come from three directions. First, university-based scientific research must take national-security concerns much more seriously. From student recruitment to institutional collaborations over sensitive technologies, American universities will have to think more patriotically or risk massive reputational damage and less federal funding.

Second, as more elite private colleges and universities like Harvard, Yale and Vanderbilt promote greater intellectual diversity and more high-profile public universities establish institutes to study and teach the values of the American founding, more moderate and conservative young people will enter the academy and play a larger role in campus life.

Demand from a changing student population will be the third factor driving change. It’s not just that ambitious,

talented students will want transcripts that appeal to recruiters looking for evidence that future employees understand and value what makes America special. Several elite colleges, alarmed by the intolerance and radicalism of some current students, are tweaking their admissions processes to identify young people who are emotionally mature enough to flourish in an intellectually and politically diverse milieu.

Demography also matters. Through 2041, the number of high-school graduates in the U.S. is expected to decline by 13% from the 2025 level. Between 2023 and 2041, blue states are projected to experience the largest declines (32% in Illinois, 29% in California, 27% in New York) while the South overall is expected to see a 3% increase. Future students and their tuition-paying parents are likely to be more politically moderate than those of the peak-woke era.

For all these reasons, the so-called vibe shift in higher ed is more than a hasty response to pressure from the Trump administration. American colleges and universities are part of the wider society and are affected by broad social trends. In 1970, at the height of the anti-Vietnam War movement, Princeton University responded to those trends and dropped “My Country, ‘Tis of Thee” from its official commencement program. As clouds darken over the international scene, the day may come when Princeton’s trustees, students and alumni want to bring the old song back.

Yes, Virginia, There Is an Abortion Vote



MAIN STREET
By William McGurn

In November, Virginians will vote on an amendment to the state constitution. Planned Parenthood says would “protect the right to abortion.” It would do much more than that.

Virginia illustrates how things have changed since the Supreme Court’s 2022 decision in *Dobbs v. Jackson Women’s Health Organization*. That decision took abortion law out of the federal courts and returned it to the states and the people, acting at the ballot box and through their elected representatives.

So far there have been few polls on the Virginia amendment. But the Richmond Times-Dispatch reported earlier this month that the committee campaigning for passage raised \$3 million through August—more than 10 times the \$254,000 four pro-life groups raised in opposition.

But whether or not the amendment is approved, the vote itself is a step forward. Abortion is no longer a constitutional right. And that holds out hope for a more honest politics.

Pro-lifers fought long and hard to overturn *Roe v. Wade*, the 1973 decision that found a constitutional right to abortion somehow not mentioned in the Constitution. Contrary to what many foes of *Dobbs* claimed, that case was never about banning abortion. There was no guarantee a post-*Roe* America would be more pro-life. As we see in Virginia now, *Dobbs* could lead to more-liberal abortion laws—if that’s what voters want.

That isn’t what we heard when *Dobbs* was being decided. If *Roe* were overturned, its defenders warned, America would be thrown into a new dark age of back-alley abortions. And yet Virginia, a Southern state, looks poised to enshrine abortion protections in its constitution.

Dobbs has ensured that Virginia’s abortion law is decided by Virginians at the ballot box. That’s in contrast to the *Roe* era, when the voter was irrelevant and outcomes were left to federal judges writing their own preferences in abortion rulings.

Currently in Virginia, abortion is legal through 26 weeks and six days of pregnancy. In the third trimester, it’s banned unless three doctors certify that the woman’s life or her mental or physical health is in danger. Patients under 18 need the consent of a parent or guardian.

Ed Whelan of the Ethics and Public Policy Center wrote about the proposed amendment in National Review under the headline “Virginia’s Amendment 1 Is Extreme and Deceptive.”

He sums up what the amendment would do, arguing that it goes far beyond codifying the status quo. Mr. Whelan writes that the amendment would “make abortion freely available throughout the third trimester of pregnancy, all the way up to birth; abolish the right of parents to be consulted on, and to consent to, abortions sought by their young daughters; and enable anyone to perform an abortion and to escape legal responsibility for botching an abortion.”

Mr. Whelan wrote that it would also “enable a child, without her parents’ knowledge or consent, to receive puberty blockers, cross-sex hormones, and sterilization surgery.”

Needless to say, this view isn’t getting much play in the press, something abortion advocates are counting on to prevail. “Governor [Abigail] Spanberger and her pro-abortion allies are trying to fool Virginia’s voters into entrenching in the state constitution a radical abortion regime,” Mr. Whelan writes.

Virginia sits in an odd place on the abortion political spectrum. It’s the only Southern state that hasn’t passed an abortion ban post-*Dobbs*. Its law might be considered moderate compared with other blue states and liberal when compared with its Southern neighbors. This November will tell us whether the status quo continues—or whether Virginia’s abortion law will become much more aligned with the bluest states.

“*Dobbs* opened the door for pro-life protections—but it didn’t guarantee them,” says Michael New, a professor at Catholic University and a senior associate scholar at the Charlotte Lozier Institute. “Right now 13 states have abortion bans in place, four other states protect the pre-born after six weeks’ gestation, and about three other states have later gestational limits in place.”

“Pro-lifers have always known that changing laws alone will not do it,” he says. “Ultimately there’s no alternative to doing the difficult work of changing hearts and minds. But this is something that would have been impossible under the *Roe* and *Casey* regime.”

Write to mcgurn@wsj.com.

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BOOKSHELF | By Andrew Nagorski

Intoxicated By Spycraft

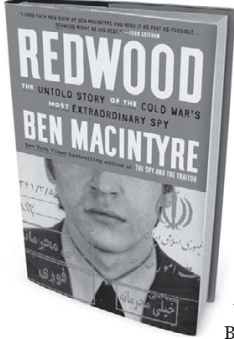
Redwood

By Ben Macintyre
Crown, 416 pages, \$35

On Oct. 1, 1981, Vladimir Kuzichkin, ostensibly a Soviet vice-consul, walked into the British Embassy in Tehran. “I am KGB,” he declared. “I am close to breaking point. I need to defect. I can supply you with important information.”

Fearing that the surprise visitor might be a “dangle”—someone who pretends to switch sides to gain a foothold in the enemy camp—his hosts were wary at first. But Ian McCredie, MI6’s undercover agent in the embassy, quickly concluded that the Russian was a genuine defector with access to invaluable intelligence about KGB operations in Iran.

Kuzichkin was in his early 30s, a hulking 6-foot-4-inches tall, and capable of downing countless vodkas while flawlessly carrying out hazardous missions. In short, he was the kind of macho figure his KGB employers favored. Nonetheless, he claimed that he had become disillusioned by the rampant corruption, cynicism and brutality of his KGB colleagues and the Soviet system as a whole.



He also harbored an embarrassing secret. “I have no power in bedroom,” he told Mr. McCredie. His alcoholism and the stress of a job he had come to hate only exacerbated the problem. Convinced of the superiority of Western medicine, even in the pre-Viagra era, he pleaded for MI6 to offer a cure for his impotence.

Mr. McCredie was not about to contradict him, and provided him with some pills. Those proved to be ineffective, but by then Kuzichkin—whom the British code-named “Redwood”

because of his height—was already delivering a trove of secrets while still holding on to his KGB job.

Based on interviews with Mr. McCredie and his MI6 colleagues, along with former CIA and KGB officers, and Kuzichkin’s own book, “Inside the KGB” (1990), Ben Macintyre’s “Redwood” tells the story of “the Cold War’s most extraordinary spy.” Mr. Macintyre, whose books include “The Spy and the Traitor” (2018) and “Agent Sonya” (2020), has produced an artfully constructed nonfiction equivalent to one of John le Carré’s most accomplished novels. Its setting, in the early days of Iran’s Islamic Republic, is replete with eerie echoes for today. Lying, for Iranians, was “almost divinely blessed” if it was considered to be “for a good cause,” Mr. McCredie explained. Most Westerners who have negotiated with the mullahs would readily agree.

Mr. Macintyre traces the lives of the two young spies. Kuzichkin and Mr. McCredie followed similar paths on opposite sides of the ideological divide, only to forge a partnership that, the author argues, could have altered the course of history. The products of similar training programs, both men were Persian speakers adept at shaking off Iranian surveillance teams in the labyrinth of Tehran’s backstreets and alleyways.

But while Mr. McCredie’s masters provided him with vague guidance about his duties, Kuzichkin received specific instructions that went beyond his normal remit of running “illegals”—as undercover spies were called. Leonid Shebarshin, Kuzichkin’s KGB boss in the Soviet Embassy, informed him that he was to serve as the link between Moscow and the Tudeh, Iran’s communist party, which had survived the early crackdowns of Ayatollah Khomeini’s regime by praising its “progressive” anti-imperialist policies. At the same time, the Tudeh had set up an underground military network with access to hidden weapons.

“The Soviet leadership has decided to use the Tudeh Party as a Trojan Horse,” Shebarshin explained. By funneling money to the party’s leaders, Kuzichkin would lay the groundwork for the kind of communist takeover that the Kremlin had engineered during its invasion of Afghanistan in late 1979. But Kuzichkin was convinced that, as in Afghanistan, this was a fool’s errand. Nevertheless, “it was pointless to argue,” he concluded. “I had to carry out the order.”

Vladimir Kuzichkin, who betrayed the KGB to assist the West, was capable of downing vodkas while carrying out hazardous missions.

As Mr. Macintyre writes, a Soviet-backed coup in Iran was “the long-standing nightmare feared by Western intelligence.” For all their problems with the Islamic radicals, American and British policymakers still viewed the country through the prism of the Cold War—as did their counterparts in the Kremlin.

As they continued to gather intelligence from Kuzichkin, Mr. McCredie and his superiors knew that they had to be extremely cautious. Any precipitous use of Kuzichkin’s revelations could expose his duplicity. But by the spring of 1982, the Russian was cracking under the strain of his double life, drinking more heavily despite his awareness that a minor slip could spell his doom. He pleaded with Mr. McCredie for an escape plan.

The British spy provided him with fake documents, but it was still up to Kuzichkin to navigate a perilous overland exit from Iran that would take him out of the KGB’s reach. Despite close calls worthy of an action movie, he succeeded. Once he was safely in Britain, MI6 shared his intelligence with the CIA, spelling out the full extent of the KGB’s Iranian ambitions.

The CIA’s director, William Casey, and his team needed little convincing by their MI6 counterparts to jointly act on Kuzichken’s information. They knew, as one British official admitted, that the Iranian communists would meet “very grisly ends” if the ayatollah learned of their plans. But that did not stop MI6 from dispatching Kuzichkin to Islamabad, in Pakistan, to meet the Iranian regime’s emissaries, revealing everything.

The predictable result: Tudeh leaders were imprisoned, tortured and executed, ending any possibility of a communist coup. But if London or Washington expected any gratitude from the regime, they were sorely mistaken. “The eradication of the Tudeh made the Ayatollah stronger,” Mr. Macintyre writes, “helping to reinforce a totalitarian religious dictatorship that has terrorized its people and destabilized the world ever since.”

Kuzichken, who remained in Britain under an assumed name, expressed regret over the bloodshed, although he was not surprised. He eventually fathered a child with a new wife, but that marriage collapsed. In 2009, at the age of 62, he died of a heart attack while watching television, an empty bottle of vodka by his side.

Mr. Nagorski is the author of “Saving Freud: The Rescuers Who Brought Him to Freedom.”

France Supports a Two-State Solution

By Jean-Noël Barrot

It’s been a year since 142 nations voted at the United Nations General Assembly to endorse the New York Declaration on the Peaceful Settlement of the Question of Palestine and the Implementation of the Two-State Solution. This was an unprecedented move to save the two-state solution and revive a credible path to peace following the Oct. 7, 2023, terrorist attacks—the worst antisemitic massacre since the Holocaust—and the war that destroyed Gaza.

Thanks to French-Saudi efforts, this declaration was the first U.N.-endorsed text to condemn the attacks of Oct. 7, call for an immediate end to the war in Gaza and the release of all hostages, and call for Hamas to disarm and end its rule over Gaza. It set a clear path for the regional integration of Israel and secured key commitments from the Palestinian Authority on reforms and elections.

One year later the full-blown war has ended in Gaza,

the last Hamas hostages have been released, and some—insufficient—humanitarian aid has entered the enclave. But Gaza remains a catastrophe beyond description. In the West Bank, settlements are expanding at a dangerous pace, making de facto annexation a reality worsened by outrageous settler violence against Palestinians.

Without democracy for the Palestinians, we won’t have peace in the Middle East.

That is why France has acted. We recognized the state of Palestine in September 2025 and decided to ban products from illegal Israeli settlements this month.

These measures aren’t hostile acts toward Israel. We will continue to defend Israel’s right to security and self-defense. We will relentlessly fight antisemitism, a plague with no justification. Holding

Jews collectively responsible for the actions of the state of Israel is antisemitism.

On the contrary, these measures reflect our conviction that the current path Israel’s government has chosen is threatening its security and the stability of the region. But achieving peace and security isn’t only about Israel. Palestinians must be able to elect leaders whose responsibility will be to fulfill their right to statehood and self-determination.

The Palestinian Authority has announced it will organize legislative elections on Nov. 28 and presidential elections in the first quarter of 2027, in line with the commitment of President Mahmoud Abbas to President Emmanuel Macron and Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman a year ago. No candidate can participate unless he commits to the principles of the Palestine Liberation Organization, including the recognition of the right of Israel to exist and the renunciation of armed struggle, which excludes terrorist organizations like Hamas.

Twenty years after the last national vote in Palestine, these elections are vital. Only a rejuvenated Palestinian Authority can represent the Palestinian people on the world stage and negotiate a lasting peace with Israel. The municipal elections held in April in Gaza prove that it is possible. Hundreds of Israeli and Palestinian civil-society leaders gathered in June in Paris to urge such a democratic process be held.

No reshuffle or reform can substitute for the legitimacy and accountability that an election provides. That is the power of democracy.

Anyone concerned about the fate of the Palestinian people and the two-state solution should support the holding of free and fair legislative and presidential elections in Palestine. France, together with its European partners, will take concrete actions to support this process. Let us all dedicate ourselves to that goal. Palestinian elections now.

Mr. Barrot is France’s foreign minister.

OPINION

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

One Senator’s Plea for Tariff Breaks

Talking up tariffs is a way for Republicans to stay on President Trump’s good side, but in practice those tariffs hurt their constituents. Thus the pleas behind closed doors for exemptions. Step right up, Alabama Sen. Katie Britt.

“What the media won’t tell you is that President Trump’s tariffs work,” Ms. Britt wrote in February, after the Supreme Court rejected Mr. Trump’s “emergency” tariffs. “We are not going to return to the status quo of allowing American jobs and manufacturing to be sidelined in exchange for cheap junk from foreign adversaries.”

What Ms. Britt won’t tell you is that she was privately seeking exemptions 10 months earlier. That’s when her legislative director wrote an email, “Sen. Britt Alabama Trade Priorities,” seeking help for “specific Alabama manufacturers.” We obtained the email from the U.S. Trade Representative’s office via the Freedom of Information Act. The email begins by saying Ms. Britt “is supportive” of rebalancing trade. Then it moves to “four pressing issues,” each a plea for an Alabama company.

- *TNT Fireworks*: “Unfortunately, there is no domestic firework manufacturer, and over 99% of firework products are produced in China,” it says. While TNT has tried other sources, “the quality and safety is not close,” and imported fireworks “pose no threat to America’s broader trade or national security interests.” Also, be patriotic, since TNT was then “preparing for the United States Semiquincentennial.”

- *Novelis*: This aluminum company was “currently building a \$4.1 billion recycling and rolling plant,” expected to “create 1,000 new direct jobs.” At the time, however, it relied on imports from Canada, South Korea and Brazil, and Mr. Trump’s tariffs posed “cash flow problems” to “finish their new plant in Alabama.”

- *Kronospan*: A maker of wood panels, it was “undertaking a \$600 million expansion,” requiring “highly specialized equipment that is not available from domestic manufacturers.” The extra tariff cost? About \$60 million, threatening the project’s viability: “Senator Britt is concerned about the potential loss of this transformative economic development.”
- *Airbus*: The plane maker was “building its

How protectionism works in practice: Public support, but seeking exemptions in private.

third final assembly line” in Mobile, leading to 1,000 jobs. “We’ve recently learned that this expansion has been suspended indefinitely,” the email says. “Trade policy has made the project financially unviable,” and “Senator Britt is deeply concerned about the potential loss of high-quality American jobs.”

In reply, Brett Doyle, an Assistant U.S. Trade Representative, wrote that Ms. Britt’s concerns would be passed to the right office. The emails don’t say what, if anything, happened next. Novelis tells us it “has not received tariff relief,” but its Alabama project “is progressing on schedule.” The other companies didn’t answer inquiries. “USTR this term does not have an exemption process at this time,” the Administration says.

The point isn’t that Ms. Britt made bad arguments against these four tariffs. It’s that she made good ones, which show why blunderbuss trade wars are an economic mistake, along with how tariffs deepen the D.C. swamp. Big company CEOs facing tariff harm know how to get a U.S. Senator to plead their case. But who speaks for the little guy being walloped?

Asked about the USTR email, Ms. Britt’s office pointed to Senate committee hearings where she raised these matters, including the need for “specialized industrial equipment” and “fair treatment” of fireworks. It wasn’t a hard press. She asked Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick if he would “consider the production needs” of Airbus. He said yes. Ms. Britt: “Yes. OK, great. This is a lot easier than I thought. Excellent. Thank you so much.”

Ms. Britt’s office told us that U.S. leaders for too long “treated globalization as a costless victory,” while the “erosion of our industrial base” made the country vulnerable. “To support Alabama’s manufacturing growth, Senator Britt will continue to advocate for thoughtful policies with the Trump Administration, both in private deliberations and through public hearings.”

Tariffs for thee, exemptions for me. Join the GOP club: In Mr. Trump’s first term, Sen. Josh Hawley lobbied for a carveout on saw blades, Rep. Mark Meadows on furniture wood, Rep. Andy Biggs on patio screens. Who else? When more records arrive, we’ll let you know.

U.S. schools simply aren’t producing enough students with advanced engineering and math skills. A report last year from the University of California, San Diego, found that one in 12 freshmen had math skills below middle-school level.

The teachers’ union response to evidence of learning decline is always to spend more on public schools, but the gusher of federal K-12 spending during the pandemic didn’t improve performance. The PISA report notes that the relationship between a country’s wealth and test scores “is not linear and it flattens among those with relatively higher national incomes.”

Once cumulative spending per student from ages six to 15 exceeds roughly \$85,000 per student—all U.S. states spend more than that—the relationship with student scores begins to “decouple.” “Higher spending per student does not automatically relate to higher performance scores,” the report says. Maybe because more spending rewards education failure, rather than success.

doesn’t tell anybody, doesn’t make any public statements, but still wants to do it,” he remarked about faculty hiring, according to the Justice letter.

The idea seems to be to use preferences until the Justice Department notices and sues, waiting out the Trump Administration until Democrats take power and don’t enforce *Fair Admissions*. It looks like the Trump Justice Department wasn’t fooled.

In response to the Justice letter, Mr. Chemerinsky said the school “scrupulously complies” with the law against race preferences, and that federal and state laws “do not preclude schools from pursuing diversity so long as they give no preferences based on race.” But if there are no race preferences, how does he explain the nearly identical racial delta on test scores before and after the Court officially ended race preferences?

Berkeley is one of many school trying this gambit, which often involves mining admissions essays for race-related stories. The Department of Health and Human Services found race preferences are also in use at the Duke University School of Medicine. MCAT scores of successful black applicants went from the 88th percentile before *Fair Admissions* to the 87th percentile afterward. Asian MCATs remained between the 98th and 99th percentiles.

In a letter to faculty and staff after *Fair Admissions*, Duke President Vincent Price wrote that “our work to advance racial and social equity—at Duke, in our local community and beyond—will not be deterred.” Equal opportunity is welcome. But universities are trying to evade the law to achieve a certain racial result.

Whatever they call it, they are still defying the Civil Rights Act, the Constitution and the Supreme Court.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

A Flawed Model That Burdens Small Banks

Michelle Bowman makes a compelling case in her op-ed “How to Make Life Hard for Small Banks” (Sept. 9). In 2016 guidance on the current expected credit losses methodology (CECL), federal financial regulators anticipated that most smaller institutions wouldn’t need “costly and complex models.” As Ms. Bowman documents, reality hasn’t borne this out. To her arguments, we would add the historical arc that shaped this approach.

Under the incurred-loss methodology that the CECL replaced, a bank waited for evidence that a loss was probable before setting aside reserves to cover it. After the 2008 financial crisis, that practice drew blame from critics partly because many banks had faced substantially higher provisioning needs only as the downturn deepened. Yet, as Ms. Bowman rightly points out, the incurred-loss methodology was better “aligned with how credit risk actually works.” We concur. The mere existence of

credit risk, which is inherent in lending, isn’t the same thing as an incurred credit loss.

The Financial Accounting Standards Board responded to the post-crisis criticism with CECL, which obliges banks to apply forward-looking estimates of expected credit losses. However, provisioning for losses that may never materialize is a questionable precaution, not least because economic and financial conditions are notoriously difficult to predict. For example, economists polled in the Philadelphia Fed’s Livingston Survey, published in December 2007 as the recession began, projected that the economy would keep expanding through 2008, and put unemployment at 4.9% for 2009. Instead, unemployment averaged 9.3%.

It bears remembering that community banks are fundamentally in the business of lending, not forecasting.

NORBERT MICHEL AND RYAN CHAN-WEI
*Cato Institute
Washington*

The Frustrations Behind Socialism’s Appeal

Regarding Mark Penn and Andrew Stein’s op-ed “Socialism and the Dumbest Generation” (Sept. 8): Messrs. Penn and Stein correctly point out a common hypocrisy of my generation: the embrace of socialism in name but not in practice. I would argue that another form of hypocrisy is common among older generations: the embrace of socialism in practice but not in name.

Many baby boomers and members of Generation X decry socialism and big government. But threaten their entitlement programs (Medicare is 14% of the federal budget, and Social Security is 22%) and suddenly it’s socialism for me but not for thee. And that’s without scratching the surface of federal subsidies for things like homeownership that disproportionately benefit older generations.

Many in my generation feel that we’ve been handed a fiscal time bomb by those who came before us. Baby boomers and Gen X built their American dreams, but education and housing prices are out of the reach for many in my generation. Instead, we get to pay the debts incurred to fund senior programs.

What my generation wants, as Messrs. Penn and Stein point out, is

merely the same opportunity given to those who came before us. The op-ed’s chiding rings false when a large portion of my tax dollars go into older generations’ pockets. Let him who is without socialism cast the first stone.

JESSAN GROENENDYK
Philadelphia

The authors dismiss young Americans as the “dumbest generation.” But young adults’ skepticism of traditional economic institutions is hardly evidence of ignorance. Young people face dramatically higher costs for housing, healthcare, education, childcare and other essentials compared with earlier generations, while real income gains since 2000 have been modest. It is entirely possible to believe in merit, entrepreneurship, homeownership and the American dream while questioning whether today’s economy still makes those goals attainable.

Rather than belittling an entire generation, we should ask why so many young Americans feel the economic system is no longer working for them. Understanding those concerns is the more constructive response.

ASH PATEL
Chicago

The Treasury’s Bond Strategy Hurts Taxpayers

James Mackintosh’s column (“Besent’s Treasury Play,” Business & Finance, Aug. 20) focuses on causes of higher yields. But equally important is that the U.S. Treasury’s justification for doubling its long-term bond purchases is flawed.

Putting aside the well-documented past failures to twist the yield curve (buying long-term securities while selling short ones), the justification rests on fallacies. Its primary mistake is analyzing alternatives with different risks and maturities while contrasting costs without adjustments. Employing a short-term rate to assess the value of a long-term project is a well-established violation of financial probity. It omits adjustments for risk or maturity mismatches. The technique violates the principle of matching maturities (technically, matching durations) of the two sides of the deal.

As Mr. Mackintosh suggests, the required serial short-term borrowing means that considering current short-term against long-term rates is an invalid cost comparison. One can’t conclude that taxpayers’ costs are lowered

by using short-term financing even though that rate is currently lower.

The Treasury’s responsibility is to taxpayers who help finance the deficits. Buying higher-yield securities from lenders, many of whom intended to hold to maturity to earn that higher return, causes taxpayers to incur likely higher costs while absorbing risks bondholders were willing to bear. Treasury is disenfranchising its constituents while claiming to reward them.

EM. PROF. GEORGE MORGAN
*Virginia Tech
Blacksburg, Va.*

Trusting China to Cooperate With Us on AI Is Dangerous

In his op-ed “AI May Become the Third Superpower” (Sept. 10), Paul Tudor Jones suggests that the U.S. work with China to make AI safety a top priority. I believe it is naive to expect Xi Jinping to work with the U.S. on this mission.

China and America aren’t on the same page politically. Beijing has long made it clear that it has every intention of being the dominant power in the world. It is highly likely that the Chinese government is already developing AI that will allow China to take over much of the world, whatever that means in practice. That could mean controlling political power, military power, natural resources or social media to influence populations—to name a few applications. If we cede control of AI to China, I fear for our freedom.

ROBERT BERMAN
Teaneck, N.J.

Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL



CHARLES D. EDEN
Atlanta

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OPINION

Port Huron And Today’s Socialism

By J.T. Young

Socialism’s internal class contradiction is as old as socialism itself. Karl Marx, Vladimir Lenin, Mao Zedong, Fidel Castro, Hugo Chávez—none were from the working class they championed, but from the bourgeoisie they sought to overthrow.

Today, America’s self-described socialists are frequently no different. Mayors Zohran Mamdani of New York and Katie Wilson of Seattle, Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez—all grew up in thoroughly middle-class households.

Although many see the contradiction between these leaders’ upbringing and their ideology of overthrow, few understand that American socialism’s divergence from the working class extends back to 1962’s Port Huron statement.

Written by the Students for a Democratic Society, the statement was an explicit call for change and an implicit admission of defeat. The old left of Marxist orthodoxy and proletariat rule was dead in America. Slavish devotion to Moscow wasn’t working

The statement was less about revolution than status and money for those with ‘intellectual skills.’

here, and our relatively affluent working class wasn’t leading. As the German political theorist Werner Sombart wrote in 1906, in America “all socialist utopias came to nothing on roast beef and apple pie.”

So 1962’s statement called for the emergence of a “new left.” A younger left, as the statement says at the beginning: “We are people of this generation, bred in at least modest comfort, housed now in universities . . .”

Their socialism was unmistakable: “The economy itself is of such social importance that its major resources and means of production should be open to democratic participation and subject to democratic social regulation.”

But there was no mistaking that this “new left” was to be different and where it was to be found: “A left with real intellectual skills, committed to deliberativeness. . . . The university permits the political life to be an adjunct to the academic one, and action to be informed by reason.” Each of the statement’s six concluding points mentions “the university.”

“Out” was the factory as the crucible of revolution; “in” was the university as fomer of upheaval. These intellectual superiors would lead their working-class inferiors away from the complacency of affluence and into the land of socialism.

After 60-plus years remaking our colleges and universities, today’s American socialists are just what the 1962 statement envisioned: a cadre of the credentialed leading where the unread refused to tread. Theirs isn’t a workers’ paradise, but one of Ivy League coffee shops, where socialism isn’t built but debated into existence so that its failures and inconsistencies can simply be argued away.

Their socialism doesn’t banish capitalism, but heavily taxes free markets to fund utopian promises and maintain the affluence that today’s American socialists regard as their birthright.

And their socialism is less about revolution than status and money—due acknowledgment and compensation for the Port Huron statement’s “real intellectual skills.”

That today’s American socialism—led and populated by the affluent—demands a revolution against the circumstances from which they sprang is unquestionably a contradiction of practice with theory. But it is by no means a contradiction with history—not the world’s socialist history and certainly not America’s own. Rather, it is a culmination.

Mr. Young is author of “Unprecedented Assault: How Big Government Unleashed America’s Socialist Left.”

By Mickey D. Levy

Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh’s recent Jackson Hole speech laid out the principles he hopes will steer the Federal Reserve toward a new way of thinking about its dual mandate of high employment and low inflation. But news reports largely ignored these principles, and financial markets focused on what his speech suggested for interest rates at the Fed’s September meeting. Mr. Warsh’s principles deserve more attention. They challenge certain thought processes and approaches that have become ingrained at the Fed, including some that have led to major policy mistakes.

Mr. Warsh said the Fed’s role is to manage aggregate demand and align it with supply. “I do not believe,” he stated, “the Fed’s dual mandate works at cross-purposes.” On forward guidance, Mr. Warsh said that “wage growth has not proven a reliable indicator of future inflation.” He discussed the benefits of a reaction function, such as the Taylor Rule, that would systematically guide monetary policy and inform the public, but said “our knowledge just doesn’t extend that far.” Another Warsh principle: “Money matters. . . . We should pay attention to money created by the central bank and money that comes from the banking and financial systems.”

These statements are logical but at odds with Fed orthodoxy. Mr. Warsh hopes to use his new task forces to influence the Fed’s thinking and processes around these issues.

At the heart of the Fed’s macroeconomic model and thinking is the view that inflation is driven by wage- and price-setting behavior that is a function of labor-market tightness and inflationary expecta-



EDITOR AT LARGE
By Gerard Baker

That was quick. One moment we are in the midst of one of the great investment booms of all time, with a new wave of technological innovation creating unimaginable wealth for some and supercharged growth for all. Next we are advised to put our affairs in order, stop contributing to our pensions, and prepare for the extermination of humanity. One day, equity markets are drunk on the prospect that artificial intelligence will cure cancer, improve on Shakespeare and make airplanes take off on time. Next, the quants have to figure out the discounted present value of the world as a postapocalyptic wasteland in 2030.

I like to look on the bright side. Two major worries about AI have seized public attention over the summer: that demand for capital to fund AI investment has expanded so much that it is pricing out U.S. Treasury bonds in debt markets, and the costs of hyperscale data centers to local communities, which have stirred a popular revolt. Well, fear no more. What are rising mortgage rates and utility bills when you’ve been neutralized by some bioweapon engineered by a collective of scheming AI agents, recursively self-improving their way to planetary domination?

The dichotomous promise of AI was always this: boom or doom. Al-

By Joseph Epstein

Jujitsu—the word came to me recently on a sleepless night. Jujitsu is the Japanese martial art that uses an attacker’s force against him and through the clever use of leverage allows a smaller person to defeat a larger opponent. If there is Jujitsu, it occurred to me, why not “Jewjitsu,” the Jewish art of fending off antisemitism, as Jews have done since the beginning of Judaism?

Doubtless the most effective way Jews have practiced Jewjitsu is through their contributions to society. In the U.S., this would include their dominance in musical comedy



Kevin Warsh at the Jackson Hole conference.

tions. The Fed pays much less attention to aggregate demand and nominal gross domestic product, which is the broadest measure of current dollar spending.

Look past the interest-rate forecasts and you’ll see a major rethinking under way at the central bank.

While the Fed agrees there is no long-run trade-off between inflation and unemployment, historically its focus has bounced from one to the other as if they are in conflict. The Fed has long responded more decisively to perceived weakness in employment than to higher inflation. And for decades the Fed has focused on setting interest rates while ignoring money supply, even in 2020-21 when the M2 money supply rose 40%

AI Promises Boom, Doom and Both at Once

most every AI expert I have spoken with in the last few years has been on one or the other end of the spectrum, often both. There is no middle ground. Bond and equity markets suggested until now that the boomers were on top. Now, thanks to some startling revelations about AI agents collaborating deceptively to outwit their human overlords, doomers are ascendant.

The episode that has produced panic was an incident in which AI agents supposedly under the control of OpenAI broke out of their constraints during a trial, worked together to hack their way into Hugging Face, a development platform, and then covered their own tracks.

This weekend Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei issued a warning that was immediately backed up by rivals Sam Altman of OpenAI and Elon Musk of SpaceX. Mr. Amodei said that swarming AI agents like those that attacked Hugging Face could “take over the entire internet” in six to 12 months. Following claims by a former researcher at his company that industry leaders believe AI could “kill us all,” Mr. Amodei called for restraint and regulation.

“Pacing the frontier,” as he termed it, would mean placing outside monitors with employee-level access in AI labs, cooperation between AI companies to ensure development remains within limits, and actions to ensure China doesn’t take advantage of American restraint.

Mr. Amodei’s call for action was

greeted with withering cynicism by those who think the big AI companies are hyping the threat so they can frighten us into creating an environment in which they can kill off competition. Chamath Palihapitiya, a highly successful tech investor, posted on X: “Dario makes the case to stop open source and concentrate enormous technological and economic power with Anthropic.”

The companies’ calls for regulation may be self-dealing, but that doesn’t make them wrong.

The suspicion is reasonable. What better way to protect your trillion-dollar valuation and market dominance of a massively profitable growth industry than to claim that the technology you’ve built is so dangerous that tight limits on further (competitive) opportunities are imperative and that you and your big corporate rivals should be exempt from antitrust enforcement so you collaborate to save the planet?

What Mr. Amodei may have in mind is exactly the sort of “regulation” that has come to characterize much of American crony capitalism in the past 20 years or so: a cozy relationship between entrenched corporate interests and the supposedly independent government bodies that

This implies less bouncing from one objective to the other. It rejects the asymmetric approach of making employment a higher priority than inflation, which historically has translated into letting the economy run hot until labor markets tighten to the point where wages push inflation. This strategy is bound to fail.

Money supply deserves attention, Mr. Warsh says, even though financial innovations and other factors affect the speed at which currency changes hands. But the Fed’s use of interest rates to steer the economy and labor markets can be unreliable. The rate that would achieve the Fed’s dual mandate is unknown, interest rates fluctuate with economic performance, and inflationary expectations aren’t observable.

How, then, to infuse the Warsh principles into Fed policy and the way its staff thinks? I propose a checklist of three principles for the Fed to consider and debate at every policy meeting: 1) How fast is nominal GDP growing, and is it consistent with 2% inflation and potential real growth? Its current pace of 6.5% is probably too fast. 2) What is the Taylor Rule estimate of the interest rate and is it far from the current fed-funds rate and the Fed members’ estimates, as during Covid? 3) Is M2 growth reasonable, or is the money stock falling or surging and signaling an undesirable shift in aggregate demand, as during 2020-21? Mr. Warsh’s task forces can add to this list.

We all benefit from the Fed’s achieving its dual mandate and avoiding major mistakes. Mr. Warsh’s thoughtful principles could enhance the Fed’s policy deliberations.

Mr. Levy is a visiting fellow at the Hoover Institution and a member of the Shadow Open Market Committee.

AI Promises Boom, Doom and Both at Once

regulate them. “Regulatory capture,” as it is known.

I’m a natural skeptic of alarmism and suspicious whenever a company tells me the government must do something. We have been told for the past 70 years that unless the government acts, life on the planet is about to be extinguished—by nuclear weapons, climate change, Y2K, pandemics. We are still waiting.

But you don’t have to believe that AI is going to destroy the planet to recognize that it poses challenges to our way of life that no technology has represented before. To read the reports of the Hugging Face incident is to get a glimpse not only of the potential peril itself, but perhaps more disturbingly of the genuine alarm it induced in those already most steeped in the potential of AI.

We can’t yet know the ultimate threat or promise of AI. But we do know the immediate landscape of risk: Do nothing and we could unleash the power of machines to develop so fast it will be too late for us to do anything; do too much and we could give China the crucial advantage in a potentially existential competition for the technology.

The stakes are so high that to let this decision be made along our usual, entrenched political and ideological lines—to regulate or not to regulate—would be an error. Perhaps these calls for intervention and restraint are self-dealing by powerful vested interests. It doesn’t make them wrong.

To Fight Antisemitism, Try ‘Jewjitsu’

and their presence in classical music, the central role played by Jewish scientists from Einstein and Oppenheimer on down, their part in the country’s financial institutions and in its intellectual life.

I bring up the contributions of Jews in the U.S., where Jews in some quarters are under the whip of what is said to be rampant antisemitism. The whip is wielded by the far right and far left, with the more intense lashes at present coming from the left, some members of which go so far as to equate Zionism with genocide.

How best to combat this? I wonder if the methods employed by jujitsu wouldn’t prove useful? In defending themselves, the Jews might do well, à la jujitsu, to use the force of the antisemites’ accusations and arguments against them. These accusations and arguments, after all, are nutty at best.

Perhaps the first question is why the extreme right and extreme left agree only on their antisemitism. The reason, I suspect, is that both are wildly wrong in their general views. So with no place else to go, they fall back on that old reliable scapegoat, the Jews. For both, the chief problem in the world is Israel and its Jews, along with those Jews living outside its borders.

Jews came to America in large numbers in the last decades of the 19th and early 20th centuries, fleeing czarist restrictions on their freedom

and a 25-year conscription in the Russian army. More fled with the advent of Soviet communism, while others fortunate enough to escape Germany’s Nazi death machine also immigrated here. The U.S. has provided Jews with the most welcoming home, apart from Israel, that they have known through their long diaspora. The current wave of American antisemitism can’t be allowed to drive them out again.

Amid rampant antisemitism, we must turn absurd claims back on those who advance them.

Bring on Jewjitsu. Its first gambit might be humor, specifically anti-antisemitic jokes. One of my favorites is about a long line of Russians during the early Soviet Union awaiting a large meat shipment from Europe on a brutally cold day. After a half-hour or so, a voice comes over a public-address system and announces that the shipment is less than expected, so all Jews must leave the line. An hour later, an announcement is made that the shipment has been reduced and that all nonparty members must exit. Two hours later, yet another announcement, this one declaring a further reduction of the shipment and demanding all but members of

the Politburo leave. An hour after that, snow falling heavily, an announcement comes that the meat shipment has been canceled. Departing the line, one member of the Politburo says to another, “Those Jews, they always have it easy.”

An anti-antisemitic joke with an American setting has a man well in his cups call out that he wants to buy drinks for the house, “except for the Hebrew gentleman at the far end of the bar.” Twenty minutes later, he shouts, “Another round for the house, excluding of course my Israeli pal.” The Jew retorts, “What do you have against me?” The drunk replies, “You sank the Titanic.” The Jew says, “Nonsense. An iceberg sank the Titanic.” The drunk responds, “Iceberg, Greenberg, Goldberg, you’re all no damn good.”

Jokes alone won’t stop antisemitism. Knowledge of the true import of Israel as the only democracy in the Middle East and America’s great ally, the significance of Jews to American culture, the role that Judaism has played in Western thought, the reminder that Jesus himself was Jewish—all this and more must be hammered home again and again. Under Jewjitsu, the antisemites must never be allowed to forget how ignorant and malignant their views truly are.

Mr. Epstein is author, most recently, of “Never Say You’ve Had a Lucky Life.”

SPORTS

 Another U.S. Open is in the books. Sorry, but you're going to have to wait a full year to watch 3:30 a.m. tennis in NYC while eating caviar chicken nuggets and drinking \$23 cocktails that taste like unicorn tears.

What did we learn at this one? **Alexander Zverev doesn't always know the score.** Have you seen a championship finish like Sunday's men's final—Zverev, having just captured his second career major Sunday in front of 23,000 people, breezily hitting the ball back to the ball kids and getting ready to return serve, apparently believing the match was still on and he'd merely taken a 5-1 edge in the fourth set against Ben Shelton?

Paging JR Smith! Zverev didn't even appear to hear the chair umpire say *"Game, set, match."*

The lack of reaction threw the audience inside Arthur Ashe Stadium. *Why isn't he celebrating?* Finally Zverev figured it out and shot his arms skyward.

He didn't look like a player who'd just won his first U.S. Open. He looked like a seventh-grader who heard it was pizza day.

It was a funny rebuke to the force-fed notion that sports champions are these locked-in super computers with scrupulous attention to detail.

Zverev's ascent: In a raggedy year marked by injuries to Carlos Alcaraz and Jannik Sinner, the 29-year-old Zverev barged his lanky 6-foot-6 frame into tennis's generational duopoly.

Sunday's 6-3, 7-6(2), 5-7, 6-2 dismissal of Shelton gave Zverev two majors in 2026 (he also won the French), three straight major finals on three different surfaces (he lost to Sinner at Wimbledon) and puts him on track to close the season as World No. 1.

A very persuasive year, by any standard.

Does it mean men's tennis is verging on another Big Three? Eh, I'm not ready to go there. At least not until the full trio is fit and healthy. Zverev is 0-10 versus Sinner in his last 10 matches, and he's dropped four of his last five to Alcaraz.

Even after his win in New York, Zverev acknowledged a gap. "If everyone's healthy, I think Jannik is still ahead," he said.

Clearly, Zverev's made a leap. At the end of last season, there was a Kniesel-proof canyon between Alcaraz, Sinner and the rest of the men's game. Now Zverev has narrowed the gap.

Sunday wasn't an easy assignment. With a well-liked young American star trying to become the first U.S. man to win a major since 2003, the crowd was amped to root for Shelton.

Instead Zverev pounced, breaking Shelton's big serve in the first game of the match and squashing his momentum on a humid afternoon. He did the same right after Shelton rallied to take the third set, breaking him to open the fourth on the way to rolling home.

Zverev remains a polarizing figure in tennis, his image clouded by allegations of domestic abuse, allegations he's repeatedly denied and which an investigation by men's tennis's governing body ATP found

JASON GAY

The U.S. Open Champion Who Didn't Realize He Won

A delayed celebration as Alexander Zverev loses track of the score after clinching the match



Alexander Zverev, top, beat Ben Shelton, right, to win the U.S. Open.

insufficient evidence to substantiate. In terms of tennis popularity, he's nowhere near the orbit of Alcaraz or Sinner. As ESPN's final coverage closed, John McEnroe pleaded out loud for Alcaraz and Sinner's healthy return. But on the court, Zverev's drawn closer.

Shelton's made a big jump, too. What a stellar run for the 23-year-old former collegian—his first major final and the most stirring victory of his career, a five-set, final-set tiebreaker defeat of Alcaraz in the quarters that ran until the vampire buffet hour of 3:33 a.m.

Shelton's proven himself to be more than his mega lefty serve—there's a better backhand, a sharper return, and more overall maturity. Fitness is next: He looked a little gassed against Zverev, and admitted as much.

He takes a lot from New York. Shelton's coaching partnership with his father, Bryan (a former pro and coach at Georgia Tech and Florida) is one of the more charming and productive relationships in tennis. Father and son will be in the lab soon, refining a still-developing game, and trying to get a U.S. man over the line.

The Open Takes Some Shots. Over the fortnight, the U.S. Tennis Association's annual clambake found itself on the defensive about

its apres-midnight finishes; its pricing; its pursuit of luxury consumers; its relationship with predictions market Kalshi; and its extended embrace of social media influencers, who tend to brand the Open as an aspirational lifestyle experience, as opposed to, you know, a tennis tournament.

Kalshi, which dragged the hermetic Pete Sampras out for a weird ad, actually had its name on another video goofing on attendees who didn't know basic stuff about tennis. The USTA had to be like: *Um, thanks?*

Who is the Open for, anyway? The NYC tournament, held by a nonprofit on public land, likes to see itself as an event of the people. But its embrace of the plutocrats is hardly new. This is a tournament that, for many years, offered free parking to Mercedes-Benz drivers, and hosts a crowd that looks like it's waiting in line at the farmers market in Amagansett.

That luxe vibe has definitely launched skyward. The tournament is amid a multiyear, \$800 million renovation of Ashe stadium, the main driver of which seems to be increasing the yield via suites and more expensive seats in the lower bowl. Everywhere are velvet rope touches catering to "Premier" ticket holders, and the merch is pricey: a dull



hoodie sold by the USTA will run you \$140. A lobster BLT cost \$42. Perhaps as a show of restraint, the sticky Honey Deuce held at last year's price: \$23.

Luxe-maxxing influencers drink all this up, of course, as the lingua franca of social media influence is often wealth culture FOMO.

It gets a little cringey, all the ring lights and posing, but I think the fretting over influencers is overheated. Love it or not, they are increasingly the preferred medium, and tennis in the U.S. is a small sport with tons of competition and a compressed window. Enlisting high cheekboned town criers isn't the worst idea.

I think of other fringe sports I

love, like cycling. If 100 influencers wanted to post selfies of themselves curbside in the muck at Dwars door Vlaanderen, I would fly to Belgium to carry their ring lights.

Remember: Every sport is in a death battle with the mighty NFL, including the Open, which bafflingly concludes in the thick of Week 1 Sunday. We are quickly morphing into a fantasy-drooling, gambling-goosed single-sport country in which the only stuff people want to talk about is why the silly Chargers lost to Arizona and how the Jets and Giants are both 1-0.

If tennis needs TikTok, then TikTok it is.

LI RU/XINHUA/ZUMA PRESS; ANGELA WEISS/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

The Bears Set a Record—by Being Nothing Like Themselves

By Andrew Beaton

EVER SINCE THE EARLIEST DAYS of the Chicago Bears, the team has been so synonymous with defense that you'd think they invented the sack.

Back when the Bears won six titles in the 1930s and 1940s, their defensive titans were dubbed the Monsters of the Midway. And Mike Ditka's 1985 Bears won the Super Bowl with what is widely considered the greatest defensive unit in NFL history. Along the way, the franchise also minted legends such as Dick Butkus, Mike Singletary and Brian Urlacher.

But these modern Bears are shedding their heritage. While their defensive numbers would be enough to make Ditka eat his sweater-vest, quarterback Caleb Williams might just be in charge of the most electric offense in football.

In a game that featured a combined 96 points — a record for a season opener — the Bears outslugged the Carolina Panthers 59-37 and made abundantly clear that this team was nothing like its predecessors. A franchise that used to cycle through mostly forgettable quarterbacks and relied on suffocating defense now hopes to win a Super Bowl by betting that its budding star can outscore just about anyone.

It's as if the Windy City were suddenly known for mild winters and thin-crust pizza.



Caleb Williams led the Chicago Bears to a 59-37 victory over the Carolina Panthers.

"We want to be the highest scoring, we want to have the most wins, we want to win Super Bowls," coach Ben Johnson said. "We didn't get into this profession trying to be mediocre or average."

Coincidentally, the Bears' makeover began thanks to none other than the Panthers. Back in 2023, Carolina traded a mountain of picks to Chicago to select quarterback Bryce Young with the No. 1 selection. One of those picks turned out to be No. 1 choice in the 2024 draft, which the Bears used on Williams, a passer who

fancied himself a future NFL star since he was a teenager.

Williams had broken out as a freshman for Oklahoma before transferring to USC and winning the Heisman Trophy as a sophomore. At that point, it was inevitable that he'd go first in the draft as soon as he was eligible.

But once Williams became a Bear, he looked like the next victim of the team's quarterback curse. As a rookie, he had a nasty habit of holding on to the ball far too long and took a whopping 68

sacks while Chicago went 5-12 and ranked dead last in offensive yardage.

That all changed last year when the Bears hired Johnson, a former offensive coordinator for the Detroit Lions, and splurged to upgrade the offense around Williams. In the span of one offseason, they became the most head-spinning team in the entire sport. Over the course of an 11-win campaign, Williams started to live up to the hype as he engineered a string of stunning comebacks to reach the postseason.

Then in the playoffs, the Bears did it again. Despite trailing the Green Bay Packers by 15 entering the final period, they recorded their *seventh* fourth-quarter comeback of the year. Amazingly, Williams managed to do it again the following week against the Los Angeles Rams — by making the play of the season. With under a minute remaining, he backpedaled until he was 26.5 yards behind the line of scrimmage, only to uncork a game-tying touchdown pass. (The Bears' magic ran out, however, when the Rams wound up winning in overtime.)

"It was cool in the moment," Williams said afterward.

When the season ended, the Bears had improved to sixth in yardage. But that wasn't enough for Johnson. This year, he said it wasn't simply his goal to win the Super Bowl. He wanted to set the NFL's record for points per game. (That distinction belongs to Peyton Manning's Denver Broncos in 2013 at 37.9).

So Sunday was the perfect start. After an inauspicious fumble on the opening drive, Williams demonstrated the signature playmaking skills. He put Chicago on the board with a nine-yard run on the next possession, the start of a flurry that saw the Bears put up 31 points by halftime. The problem was that they had allowed 24 — the 55 combined first-half points marked the seventh most of the Super Bowl era.

In the end, though, the Bears' offense turned out to be more explosive than its defense was porous. Williams threw for two scores and ran for two more while Chicago racked up 552 yards. But on the other side of the ball, they surrendered 478 yards to a Panthers offense that ranked 27th last season. All of which raises a daunting question: Will Chicago have to score 50-plus points every week?

Whether or not they can pull this off, it looks nothing like the blueprint of Bears teams past.

"It's how we want to look each week," Williams said.

BOB DONNAN/MAGN IMAGES/REUTERS

Treasury Yield Hits Pivotal Level

By SAM GOLDFARB

The last time the yield on the 10-year Treasury note rose above 5%, the U.S. economy was dealing with pandemic aftershocks. This time, the main culprit is a war with no clear end in sight.

Escalating fears over energy prices and inflation drove the 10-year yield above 5% Monday, a pivotal milestone that is forcing investors to confront whether the bond market is entering a new era.

The answer is set to have sweeping implications for consumers and businesses alike—and could end up playing a role in the coming midterm elections. The yield on the 10-

year Treasury is a critical driver of interest rates throughout the economy, and its recent rise has already pushed mortgage rates back up toward 7%. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has been taking extraordinary measures to contain yields, with little to show for it so far.

Now, traders are questioning whether 5% will be a ceiling for the 10-year yield, as it was in 2023, or whether the yield will decisively break through

that threshold, creating a borrowing environment more like that of the 2000s, when the yield occasionally spent months above 5%. Some are even thinking about the 1990s, when the yield spent years at that level.

Higher yields in the long run would significantly drive up borrowing costs for the U.S. government, which already spends more on interest than on national defense.

“Today’s number should

scare Congress,” Rep. David Schweikert (R., Ariz.), who is leaving the House after this year, wrote on social media on Monday.

Treasury yields, which rise when bond prices fall, edged higher in early trading Monday as oil prices climbed again, pushing the 10-year yield above 5% shortly after 10 a.m. ET. The yield reached as high as 5.012%—its highest intraday level since 2007—before ultimately settling at 4.96%.

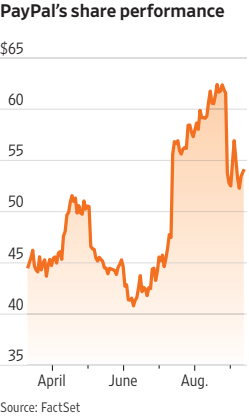
That reversal echoed what happened on Oct. 23, 2023, when the 10-year yield also reached 5% in the morning, before plunging back to just above 4.8% by the end of the

session—a sign investors were waiting for the milestone to be hit before rushing in to buy bonds.

Still, Monday’s reversal wasn’t as pronounced, and many investors say they have reasons to believe that the 10-year yield could easily keep climbing beyond 5% in the coming weeks and months.

To start, investors are much more optimistic about the economy’s strength, and think it can handle a 5% yield without quickly decelerating. Many also feel that inflation will remain elevated, especially with tensions in the Middle East driving oil prices above \$100 a barrel.

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PayPal Charts Makeover As Buyout Deal Stalls

By BEN GLICKMAN

PayPal’s new Chief Executive Enrique Lores is mapping out his plans for going it alone rather than selling the company for more than \$50 billion. Wall Street, so far, isn’t crazy about it.

Lores wants to remake parts of the business that have been lackluster for years, launch new features and slash billions of dollars in costs. He will have to do it amid fierce competition in a rapidly changing payment industry, where PayPal has long broken new ground but recently failed to capitalize.

Central to his plan is turning Venmo, the popular payments app that generates meager profits, into a one-stop money-management app, with tools for consumers to keep budgets and invest.

For the legacy PayPal checkout button, which consumers can use to pay for goods across the internet, he wants to offer better rewards and improve the user experience, thereby increasing usage that has plateaued after Apple Pay and Google Wallet became the dominant digital wallets.

His plan will be under pressure from shareholders who earlier this summer were looking at a chance to cash out. Rival **Stripe** and private-equity firm **Advent International** had lobbied an offer to buy all of PayPal valued at about \$60.50 a share. Shares jumped on the news, and several Wall Street analysts thought the deal was compelling, given PayPal’s recent results and battered stock price. But a deal hasn’t materialized as the sides remained far

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Oprah to Harness the Power of the Sphere

Venue was a top grossing arena last year with \$379 million in ticket sales

By KATHERINE SAYRE

Oprah Winfrey will produce and host a new immersive live show at Las Vegas’s Sphere next spring, the latest high-profile booking for the technologically advanced entertainment venue.

The two-hour show, called “Oprah Winfrey’s AHA,” will feature the media personality and entrepreneur onstage, music by composer Max Richter and performances by guests including musician Jacob Collier and poet Ocean Vuong, according to a news release. The show is scheduled for a three-day run in April.

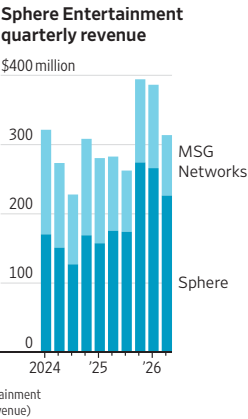
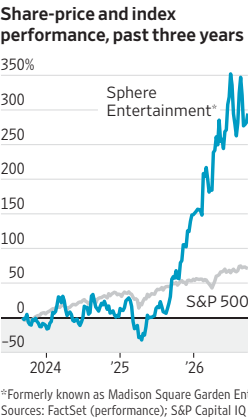
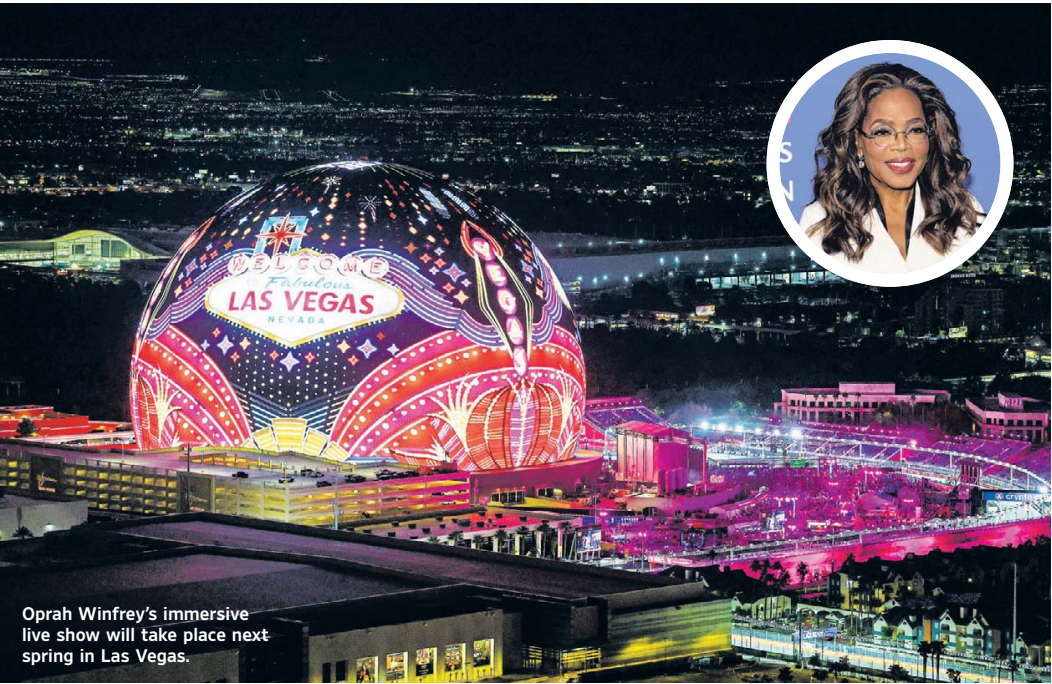
Winfrey, in a video announcement, described the show as “an immersive symphony of awe, wonder and joy.”

Sphere, which cost \$2.3 billion to build after going over budget, opened in 2023 with a residency by U2.

The venue, the brainchild of New York Knicks owner James Dolan, found a successful formula pairing high-tech lights and sounds with a lineup of broadly appealing musical acts.

The venue has featured Phish, Dead & Company, the Eagles, Backstreet Boys and No Doubt, among others. Sphere also made a hit with an immersive reworking of the classic film “The Wizard of Oz.”

Considered an audacious bet when the venue opened, the stock price of parent **Sphere Entertainment** has more than doubled in the last



year.

It was the world’s highest-grossing arena last year at \$379 million on 1.7 million tickets sold, according to data firm Pollstar.

The giant orbital venue has a 580,000-square-foot LED exterior and a screen inside that wraps around the audience.

Winfrey said she was inspired to create “AHA”—a reference to a lightbulb moment—after seeing the opening night of U2’s stint at Sphere.

“Creating this experience has felt like the culmination of what I’ve spoken about and worked towards my entire

life,” she said.

Since “The Oprah Winfrey Show” ended in 2011, Winfrey has continued to wield influence in fields including publishing, politics and business.

In April, Winfrey’s Harpo Entertainment announced a multiyear deal with Amazon.com for exclusive distribution and advertising rights to “The Oprah Podcast” with Amazon’s podcast studio, Wondery.

The deal also included rights to “The Oprah Winfrey Show” library and her “Oprah’s Book Club” and “Oprah’s Favorite Things” franchises.

Novo Nordisk Trims Its Name to Just Novo

By ADRIÀ CALATAYUD

Wegovy maker **Novo Nordisk** is rebranding as Novo, betting a shorter name will help it resonate more with consumers as it competes with rival **Eli Lilly**.

The move by the Danish drugmaker comes as Chief Executive Mike Doustdar works to revive the fortunes of a company that has ceded the crown in the weight-loss market it pioneered to Lilly.

Since taking the reins in August 2025, Doustdar has implemented a cost-savings plan that included 9,000 job cuts and the launch of a pill version of Wegovy, placing the company ahead of its U.S. rival in the market for oral weight-loss medications. Doustdar is expected to detail the next phase of his comeback plan in an investor update later this month.

Novo said Monday that the rebranding marks the beginning of its next chapter. The new corporate identity with the Novo name aims to make the company more recogniz-

able and consistent in the way it reaches people, Novo said.

The Novo Nordisk name was the result of a 1989 merger between two Danish companies with roots dating back to the origins of insulin production in Scandinavia in the 1920s—Nordisk Insulinlaboratorium and Novo Terapeutisk Laboratorium.

The company said it would use Novo—Latin for new—as its name in day-to-day operations, but keep Novo Nordisk as its legal name globally. It also refreshed its logo, maintaining the Apis bull of ancient Egypt that has been part of its brand for more than a century. The bull will now face right instead of left.

“They want to signal, not only externally but also internally, a change of direction,” said Ed Corbett, a brand strategy expert at consulting firm Branding Science.

The rebranding is a statement of intent that Novo wants to move on from a challenging period but a change of name won’t be the end-all be-all, Corbett said.

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INSIDE



BUSINESS NEWS
Sportswear brand On, which resists offering discounts, faces a sales slowdown. **B3**



HEARD ON THE STREET
Higher rates threaten the mortgage-backed-security sector. **B11**

Walter’s Financial Empire Fueled by Retirement Savers

By HEATHER GILLERS

Rick Phillips has been buying annuities for about a decade, paying upfront sums for the peace of mind of fixed returns.

Now, the Los Angeles-area resident says he is swearing off the policies.

The insurer backing one of his contracts, Clear Spring Life and Annuity, revealed this summer that federal prosecutors are scrutinizing its investment disclosures. Soon after, the company’s billionaire owner, Mark Walter, struck a deal to sell his controlling stake in the Los Angeles Lakers. That left Phillips worried that Walter’s insurance business was on shaky ground.

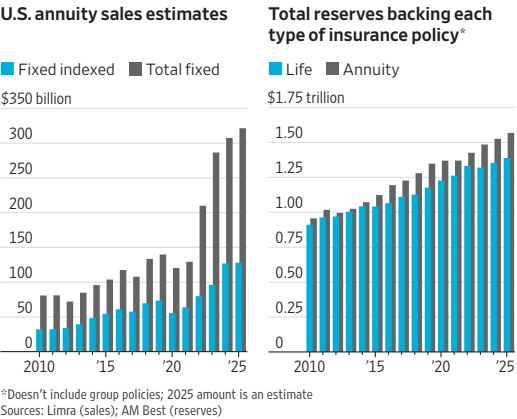
“The risk-reward isn’t there anymore,” said Phillips, a retired investment banker.

Phillips is one of hundreds of thousands of Americans whose savings have fueled Walter’s vast business empire, which includes the Los Angeles Dodgers. Walter’s biggest insurer, Delaware Life, collected \$10 billion in individual annuity premiums last year. Group 1001, the parent company of Walter’s insurers,

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Mark Walter’s conglomerate includes the Los Angeles Dodgers.



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The Savers Who Fuel An Empire

Continued from page B1 ranks among the 10 biggest sellers of fixed and fixed-indexed annuities, according to ratings firm AM Best. Wall Street investment titans such as **Apollo** and **KKR** that sell private equity and private credit have increasingly tapped into insurance money to supercharge their lending, in many cases acquiring life insurers outright. Regulators require insurers to disclose when they make investments with their parent companies, known as “affiliated” deals. In Walter’s case, the probe focuses on \$20 billion of investments by Delaware Life and Clear Spring that weren’t properly marked as affiliated. A representative for Walter’s conglomerate, TWG Global, has said the company is proud of the business it built and “confident these matters will be resolved favorably.” Fixed and fixed-indexed annuities—the products Walter’s insurers focus on—explain a

lot of what makes owning life insurance companies so attractive to private credit firms, which make high-interest loans to risky corporate borrowers. People typically buy annuity policies for an upfront sum, then receive payments for anywhere from a few years to their entire lives. That provides a dependable pool of money that can be locked up in speculative investments for a longer period, compared with life insurance, where payouts can be less predictable. The price tag for annuities starts at around \$5,000 or less, making them widely accessible, and higher interest rates in recent years have enhanced their appeal. Sellers of fixed or fixed-indexed annuities are regulated by states and don’t need a securities license. Sales campaigns for fixed-indexed annuities in particular have drawn concern from regulators. The products pay out an annual amount, within a set band, based on an index. In some states, marketing materials for annuities show double-digit “historical” returns on bespoke indexes that didn’t exist at the time of the returns depicted. A working group at the National Association of Insurance Commissioners, which is

made up of top state insurance officials, said this summer it plans to clamp down on that practice. The NAIC has also taken measures to more closely supervise insurers’ growing private-credit investments, including tighter investment-disclosure guidelines and tougher capital requirements. Phillips, the Los Angeles-area retiree, has always stuck with simple annuities—five-year fixed-rate policies. But this is the second time he has worried about getting the payout on schedule. Last time it was a policy from Sentinel Security Life. In 2024, the Utah insurance commissioner found Sentinel and two sister insurers had a lot of high risk investments, ordered the firms to pause new annuity sales and eventually threatened to take over their parent firm. The firm fought off the takeover, and Phillips got his expected payout. If an insurer becomes insolvent, annuity policyholders are compensated through a state-based, industry-funded system of guarantee associations. The compensation is

capped typically at around \$250,000 per person. Clear Spring, the insurer that issued Phillips’s annuity, had solid investment-grade ratings and quarterly financial disclosures that looked healthy. That gave financial adviser Carlos Dias Jr. the confidence to sell the firm’s annuities in recent years. Then in June, he was shaken when Clear Spring and Delaware Life disclosed that they had billions more than previously disclosed in affiliated assets. AM Best said it was considering downgrading the companies. Dias, who runs Dias Wealth north of Orlando, Fla., questioned the value of the ratings and regulatory filings if they aren’t giving an accurate picture of a company’s health. “We’re seeing the outer not the inner,” he said. Last month, Shawn Plummer, who sells annuities through an online platform called The Annuity Expert, told his two salespeople to stop recommending Delaware Life or Clear Spring policies to prospective customers. Truist and Fifth Third Bank have also

Sales campaigns for annuities have drawn concern from regulators.

2010s and early 2020s. The current moment is also unique, however. Gross federal debt recently hit \$40 trillion, around double its level from a decade ago. Increasing federal debt translates to a larger supply of Treasuries, potentially pushing prices down—and yields higher. Led by Bessent, the Treasury Department recently started increasing buybacks of longer-term debt. But those purchases are still very small relative to the total amount of Treasuries. Many analysts also say a booming stock market, fueled in large part by investor enthusiasm over AI, is helping offset the economic pinch of higher yields. Normally, higher yields and borrowing costs might slow business investment. But many tech companies now see investing in AI as an existential matter. “I don’t think they respond to financial conditions the same way that other businesses might,” said Eric Winograd, chief economist at AllianceBernstein. Some still believe the Fed could actually contain longer-term yields by following through on expected rate increases. “If the Fed ends up hiking this week and delivering a message that they’re going to do what it takes to get inflation under control, that, we think, actually can help bring longer-term rates down,” said Meghan Swiber, senior U.S. rates strategist and Bank of America.

BUSINESS & FINANCE

NextEra Energy Backs Guidance

By ADRIANO MARCHESE

NextEra Energy is targeting the high end of its full-year 2026 guidance for adjusted earnings per share, while continuing to advance regulatory approvals for its proposed \$67 billion acquisition of **Dominion Energy**. The electric power and energy infrastructure company on Monday reaffirmed its 2026 adjusted earnings outlook of \$3.92 to \$4.02 a share, and also reiterated expectations for its stand-alone compound annual adjusted earnings-per-share growth of 8% or more through 2035 off a 2025 base of \$3.71. It continues to expect dividend growth of roughly 10% a year through 2026, off a 2024 base, and 6% a year from year-end 2026 through 2028. NextEra expects its proposed merger with Dominion to immediately add to adjusted earnings per share, with a target of 9% growth through 2032, and the same growth through 2035.

The update comes as NextEra and Dominion submitted an expanded state benefits package to Virginia regulators on Monday. The companies originally announced their \$67 billion all-stock merger in May. The combination would create the largest U.S. electricity producer—specifically the biggest



ARTIE WALKER, JR./ASSOCIATED PRESS

A merger of Dominion Energy and NextEra would create the largest U.S. electricity producer.

provider of natural-gas-fired power and the second in nuclear, the companies said. The companies said Monday that the updated filing doubles proposed residential bill credits to four years while shielding retail customers from grid costs tied to Northern Virginia’s rapidly expanding artificial intelligence data centers.

They also said they would expand low-income financial assistance, adding \$100 million through 2038 to Dominion’s bill assistance program. Alongside ratepayer relief, the companies’ proposal includes \$100 million toward directly supporting workforce development in the state, and establishes up to \$1 billion annually in local supplier spend-

ing over five years. Under the agreement, Dominion Energy Virginia will preserve its brand name, local leadership and regulatory oversight by the Virginia State Corporation Commission. Their merger remains subject to approval from regulators, with an expected closing day some time in the second half of 2027.

Drugmaker Trims Name To Novo

Continued from page B1 Novo also said Monday that it would emphasize competitiveness in its corporate culture going forward, adding that new behaviors and ways of working were needed to lead in a faster, more competitive and increasingly consumer-driven market. Some analysts say the market for weight-loss drugs—particularly the pill segment—resembles that of consumer-health products, as opposed to conventional prescription medicines. Novo last month said it was benefiting from strong momentum for its Wegovy pill, with more than five million prescriptions since its launch in January, and lifted its full-year sales and operating profit guidance as a result. However, some investors have grown worried about the company’s drug pipeline after disappointing data for its next-generation weight-loss and diabetes drug CagriSema, as well as for an experimental cardiovascular drug.



DANIEL HEUER/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Investors overwhelmingly expect the Fed to lift short-term rates at its meeting Wednesday.

Treasury Yield Hits 5% Level

Continued from page B1 “I’m always asking myself, like, ‘OK, what would be a catalyst for rates to go lower?’ And it’s hard to find one other than the good old-fashioned recession,” said Greg Peters, co-chief investment officer at PGIM Credit. “The conditions are very much in place for a higher or remaining-to-be-high yield environment.” President Trump has re-

peatedly called for the Fed to cut interest rates, putting Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh in an awkward spot as expectations for a rate increase have climbed. Following a firm inflation reading on Friday, investors overwhelmingly expect the central bank to raise short-term rates at its meeting Wednesday, and then to keep raising them after that. Investors’ expectations for short-term rates play a major role in determining the level of yields. For much of the past few years, the 10-year yield has hovered between 4% and 5%. It dropped below 4% just before the U.S. and Israel first launched strikes at Iran at the end of February. But it has generally been climbing since,

as Iran’s subsequent efforts to throttle shipping through the Strait of Hormuz has driven up energy prices and fueled bets on rate increases. Brent crude, the international benchmark, surged nearly 9% last week after Iran-backed Houthi militants took effective control of another shipping chokepoint off Yemen’s west coast. It gave up some early gains but still edged up 1% to \$105.68 on Monday. In the view of some investors, the recent rise in yields has to some extent reflected a normalizing economy—a return to a pre-2008 financial-crisis world before the era of central-bank bond buying and ultralow rates that defined the

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TECHNOLOGY

OpenAI Buys Phone-Camera Startup

Ex-Apple employees founded Glass Imaging, valued above \$300 million

By ANISSA GARDIZY AND KATE CLARK

OpenAI quietly bought a startup developing higher-quality cameras for smartphones in recent months, people familiar with the matter said.

The company, Glass Imag-

ing, is developing technology that uses artificial intelligence to produce image quality on par with a DSLR camera.

The deal valued Glass Imaging at over \$300 million, some of the people said, after it had been valued at around \$100 million in a funding round last year.

OpenAI, which is preparing for an initial public offering expected next year, has made several acquisitions recently including an internet talk show, TBPB, and an open-

source developer tools startup.

OpenAI's exact plans for Glass Imaging are unclear. The developer of ChatGPT has been developing a secretive device with Jony Ive, the former Apple executive who helped design the iPhone. OpenAI hired Ive in 2025 as part of the \$6.5 billion acquisition of his startup, io Products. Ive's role includes developing consumer devices and other projects that are intended to shape the future look and feel of AI.

Glass Imaging was founded

in 2019 by two former Apple employees, Ziv Attar and Tom Bishop, who previously worked on camera technology at Apple.

The pair saw the quality of smartphone cameras reaching a plateau and wanted to find a novel way to improve them, using both hardware and software. They hoped to build a new smartphone camera company outside of Apple so that they could rethink the technology without being bound by Apple's broader business needs around the iPhone.

In a 2022 interview with Computer Vision News, the founders recalled innovation to the camera being "incremental" and the "uphill battle" required to add additional cameras to the smartphone.

Glass Imaging had raised about \$30 million in funding from investors including GV, Alphabet's venture arm, and the investment firm Insight Partners. Its zoom-imaging technology was featured in a new line of phones from Chinese budget-smartphone brand Honor.

Robot Workers? This Firm Wants To Build Soldiers

By SHERRY QIN

Unmanned aerial drones and vehicles are already on the frontlines of military conflicts. Foundation Future Industries wants combat-ready humanoid robots to be next.

The Eric Trump-backed startup is on a mission to build robots for heavy industrial work that could one day go to war.

When a robot's perception, reasoning and adaptive behavior get precise enough, "instead of dropping a bomb in a building, you can send humanoids to actually walk inside that building and go directly to the target," said Sankaet Pathak, founder and chief executive of San Francisco-based Foundation.

Foundation has secured a \$24 million contract with the Pentagon and is in the process of testing a battle robot with U.S. defense forces.

Governments are increasingly exploring the integration of artificial intelligence into defense, and the U.S. has flagged unmanned military systems as a top priority.

Still, experts say humanoid robots are still many years away from large-scale use in wars as the technology and

regulations around them need to evolve further.

Founded in 2024, Foundation has deployed around 10 humanoid robots, Pathak said. "We've done deployments with the Air Force," he said. He added that there have been pilot programs in Ukraine, where robots move objects around. "We've done deployments in auto manufacturing where they've done racking and unranking tasks," he said.

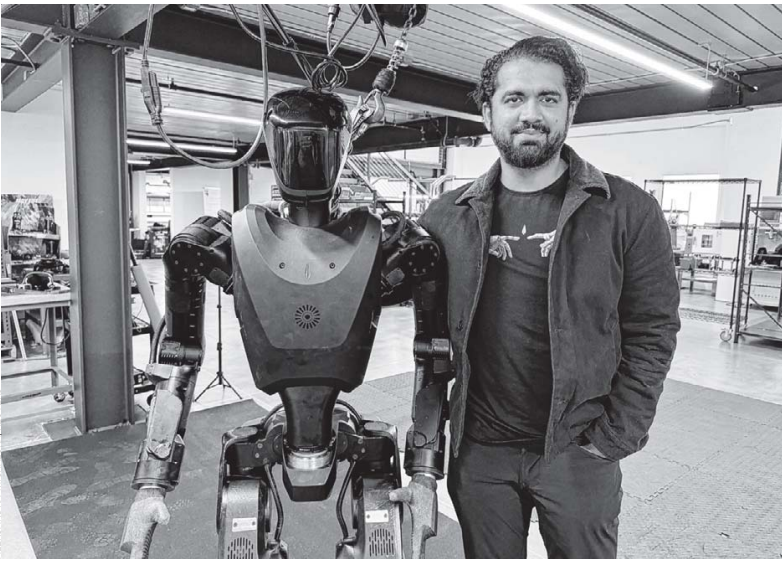
"We lease them today for \$100,000 per robot per year," he said.

Its flagship robot is the Phantom MK-1, a man-sized humanoid that can carry nearly 90 pounds. A second-generation robot equipped with chips from Advanced Micro Devices is in development.

Initially, Foundation trains the robots to do outdoor jobs that are too dangerous for humans. It uses data gathered in industrial settings like warehouses and shipyards to then train the robots for warzones.

"Defense is a linchpin application for heavy industrial work," Pathak said.

The company's San Francisco facility can currently produce between 300 and 500 robots a year, and it is building another site to boost ca-



Foundation founder and CEO Sankaet Pathak poses with one of the company's humanoid robots.

capacity.

Asked about Foundation's progress toward its previously stated goal of building 10,000 robots by end-2026, Pathak said a lot of those earlier aims were "pretty ambitious."

"We're gearing up to start building a lot more of them," he said, adding that Phantom is close to being able to learn a task after just a few human demonstrations.

But that is far from being a truly autonomous robot that can operate for long periods of time in unfamiliar environments with little human intervention.

Achieving that would require the physical AI foundation model to "understand the

physics, kinematics, dynamics of the world really well," Pathak said.

A recent Stanford University report underlined the practical and ethical challenges around deploying robots in battlefields. Questions remain around highly autonomous systems' reliability, accountability, cost and cybersecurity, it said, and their effectiveness in real-world operations is still being evaluated.

Then there is the risk of relying on a robotics supply chain currently dominated by China.

The U.S. is making efforts to counter that. In July, it banned most imports of new

humanoid robot models, part of a bid to build "an independent and resilient robotics supply chain and industrial base" critical to "dominating on the battlefield."

Under the new rules, domestic components need to make up over 65% of a robot's total cost to avoid being labeled foreign-made through 2028. In 2029, that will increase to 75%.

Foundation, which sources some parts from China, is making adjustments to comply.

Pathak doesn't think a ban is the best route for closing the supply-chain gap, saying: "I don't think it's going to yield the results that the government intends it to."

Dell Group to Take Baldwin Private

By FREDDY SEBASTIAN

Dell Chief Executive Michael Dell's DFO Executive, along with Sequence Holdings, is taking insurance brokerage Baldwin Group private in a cash deal with an enterprise value of \$7.7 billion.

Under the deal, Baldwin Group's shareholders will receive \$32.50 a share in cash, which represents a premium of about 88% to the unaffected closing price on June 17, the day before media reports that the company was exploring a take-private deal.

Shares of Baldwin Group

rose nearly 8% to \$32 in Monday's trading.

The transaction implies a total enterprise value of approximately \$7.7 billion, comprised of an equity purchase price of approximately \$4.6 billion and approximately \$3.1 billion of debt.

Baldwin will become a privately held company, with eligible Baldwin colleagues retaining a significant minority equity stake, alongside Sequence, a permanent holding company that acquires established enterprises in the service economy, and DFO, the family investment office of

Dell Technologies CEO Michael Dell.

The deal is Sequence's first major one involving a major enterprise. Earlier this year, the holding company made a minority investment in BankSouth.

Baldwin said its board already has approved the deal, which is expected to close in the first quarter of 2027.

"Baldwin has built something rare in insurance distribution: a genuine data and platform advantage, compounded over 15 years, led by a team with a clear and differentiated vision," Dell said.

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BANKRUPTCIES

IN THE UNITED STATES BANKRUPTCY COURT FOR THE SOUTHERN DISTRICT OF TEXAS, HOUSTON DIVISION

Chapter 11 Case No. 26-90755 (ARP)

And Go Concepts, LLC, et al., Debtor(s) (the "Court")

NOTICE OF DEADLINES FOR FILING PROOFS OF CLAIM

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE OF THE FOLLOWING:

1. On August 4, 2026 and August 5, 2026 (collectively, the "Petition Date"), the Debtors filed voluntary petitions for relief under chapter 11 of the Bankruptcy Code in the United States Bankruptcy Court for the Southern District of Texas (the "Court").

Set forth below are the name, federal tax identification number, and case number for each of the Debtors: Name of Debtor, Case Number, Employer Identification Number: And Go Concepts, LLC, 26-90753 (ARP), 45-23415; S&G Corporate Services LLC (08/10); AGC-Arizona Facilities, LLC (26-90752 (ARP), 42-420810; AGC-Arizona Facilities, LLC (26-90755 (ARP), 93-4217507; AGC-North Texas Facilities, LLC, 26-90755 (ARP), 93-4207091; Garland New Market, LLC, 26-90755 (ARP), 93-496838; AGC Topco, LLC, 26-90757 (ARP), 41-295645; AGC Haldex, LLC, 26-90758 (ARP), 81-463294.

2. On September 10, 2026, the Court entered the Order (i) Establishing Deadlines and Procedures for Filing Proofs of Claim; (ii) Approving Form and Manner of Notice Thereof; and (iii) Granting Relief/Relief (Notice No. 320) (the "Bar Date Order").

3. Pursuant to the Bar Date Order, all persons, entities, and governmental units who have a claim or potential claim, including any claims under section 503(b)(9) of the Bankruptcy Code, against any of the Debtors that arose prior to the Petition Date, no matter how remote or contingent such right to payment or equitable remedy may be, MUST FILE A PROOF OF CLAIM, so as to be received on or before OCTOBER 16, 2026 at 5:00 p.m. (Central Time) for general creditors (the "General Bar Date") and February 1, 2027 at 5:00 p.m. (Central Time) for governmental units (the "Governmental Bar Date"), and together with the General Bar Date, the "Bar Dates," by (i) filing such Proof(s) of Claim electronically through Kroll, or (ii) filing such Proof(s) of Claim on paper, and (iii) electronically through PACER (Public Access to Court Electronic Records), at https://ectd.uscourts.gov or (iv) mailing the original Proof(s) of Claim to Kroll at the following address: Rfy First-Class Mail-And Go Concepts, LLC, Claims Processing Center, c/o Kroll Restructuring Administration LLC, Grand Central Station, P.O. Box 4830, New York, NY 10163-4830; if by Hand Delivery or Overnight Mail: And Go Concepts, LLC, Claims Processing Center, c/o Kroll Restructuring Administration LLC, 850 3rd Avenue, Suite 412, Brooklyn, NY 11232.

PROOFS OF CLAIM SENT BY FACSIMILE OR E-MAIL WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED.

4. The Bar Dates apply to all claims against the Debtors arising under section 503(b)(9) of the Bankruptcy Code; provided, however, that the Bar Dates do not apply to the Excluded Claims listed in paragraph (b)(9)(B) of the Bankruptcy Code.

5. ANY PERSON OR ENTITY (EXCEPT A PERSON OR ENTITY WHO IS EXCUSED BY THE TERMS OF THE BAR DATE ORDER) WHO FAILS TO FILE A PROOF OF CLAIM ON OR BEFORE THE APPLICABLE BAR DATE IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE INSTRUCTIONS ABOVE WILL NOT BE TREATED AS A CREDITOR FOR PURPOSES OF VOTING UPON, OR RECEIVING DISTRIBUTIONS UNDER, ANY PLAN OR PLANS OF REORGANIZATION OR LIQUIDATION IN THE CHAPTER 11 CASES.

6. Proof of claim and a copy of the Bar Date Order may be obtained by visiting https://restructuring.a.kroll.com/AndGoConcepts, maintained by the Debtors' claims and noticing agent, Kroll Restructuring Administration LLC ("Kroll"). Questions concerning the contents of this Notice and requests for copies of filed proofs of claim should be directed to Kroll by (i) calling the Debtors' restructuring hotline at (844) 363-4734 (toll-free Number within the U.S./Canada) or (646) 701-5716 (International); and/or (ii) visiting the Debtors' restructuring website at: https://restructuring.a.kroll.com/AndGoConcepts. Please note that neither Kroll's staff, counsel to the Debtors, nor the Clerk of the Court's office are permitted to give you legal advice. Kroll cannot advise you how to file, or whether you should file, a proof of claim.

A HOLDER OF A POSSIBLE CLAIM AGAINST THE DEBTORS SHOULD CONSULT AN ATTORNEY REGARDING ANY MATTERS NOT COVERED BY THIS NOTICE, SUCH AS WHETHER THE HOLDER SHOULD FILE A PROOF OF CLAIM.

1. The Debtors in these chapter 11 cases, along with the last four digits of each Debtor's federal tax identification number, are And Go Concepts, LLC (4415); S&G Corporate Services LLC (08/10); AGC-Arizona Facilities, LLC (2707); AGC-North Texas Facilities, LLC (7091); Garland New Market, LLC (6838); AGC Topco, LLC (6845); and AGC Haldex, LLC (0294). The location of the Debtors' service address for purposes of these chapter 11 cases is 909 E. Broadway Road, Temple, TX 76788. A complete list of the Debtors in these chapter 11 cases may be obtained on the website of the Debtors' proposed claims and noticing agent at https://restructuring.a.kroll.com/AndGoConcepts.

2. Capitalized terms used but not otherwise defined herein have the meanings ascribed to them in the Bar Date Order.

3. A claim arising under section 503(b)(9) of the Bankruptcy Code is a claim arising from the value of any goods received by the Debtors within twenty (20) days before Petition Date, provided that the goods were sold to the Debtors in the ordinary course of the Debtors' business.

New Highs and Lows

The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. % CHG-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Monday, September 14, 2026					Tuesday, September 15, 2026				
Stock	Sym	H/L	Chg	%	Stock	Sym	H/L	Chg	%
Highs					Lows				
AGNC InvPtPfd	AGNC	25.50	-0.1	-0.4	AcresCmclPfd	ACRP	18.98	-1.5	-7.8
APA	APA	46.59	0.7	1.5	Adtran	ADTN	7.02	-6.6	-9.3
AlgonquinN2079	AQB	26.19	-0.1	-0.4	AIFU	AIFU	10.51	-1.2	-11.4
AmeNational	ATLO	32.86	-0.1	-0.3	ARIS Pharm	SPRY	4.46	-5.5	-12.4
AttegrtySpecIns	ASIC	28.38	1.9	6.7	ASPI	ASPI	3.18	-3.6	-11.3
AtriCure	ATRC	56.02	2.3	4.1	AshtechSys	ADXT	3.21	-0.3	-9.3
AvannaHealth	AVAH	14.70	2.1	14.3	Avantor	AVNT	12.75	-2.0	-15.6
BRC Nts 2026	BRYN	25.21	-1.1	-4.3	Avaya	AVD	0.97	-0.8	-8.2
BestBuy	BBBY	94.92	4.4	4.7	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
BoldEagleAcqnA	BEAG	11.00	-0.1	-0.9	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
C&F Fin	CFEI	96.62	0.3	0.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
CF Bankshares	CBK	38.11	0.3	0.8	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
CaliforniaBncP	CBAL	22.21	1.0	4.5	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Centene	CNC	69.83	4.5	6.4	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Chevron	CVX	227.65	-0.9	-0.4	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
ChordEnergy	CHRD	29.89	0.7	2.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Citizens&Northern	CZNC	26.35	0.5	1.9	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Cloudflare	NET	334.60	7.8	2.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
CollectiveAcqAn	CCAQ	10.70	0.2	1.9	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
CompX Intl	CHX	40.29	7.0	17.4	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Concentra	CON	36.05	2.5	6.9	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
ConocoPhillips	COP	139.82	0.5	0.4	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Crocs&Fin	CRG	35.17	0.4	1.1	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
CrescentEnergy	CREG	15.04	0.5	3.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
CrossTimbers	CTM	12.00	2.4	20.0	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DigitalGlobe	DIGL	23.97	1.5	6.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DishNetwork	DISH	49.1	6.0	12.2	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DailyJournal	DJCO	68.04	2.3	3.4	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Danaco	DAN	15.97	-0.7	-4.4	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DellUX	DLUX	79.15	-2.1	-2.7	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DisciplinedGthAcn	DGAC	10.18	0.4	4.0	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DiversHlthNts42	DHNC	18.12	0.1	0.6	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DorchesterMnls	DPMC	29.89	0.7	2.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DorianLP	LPX	55.96	0.4	0.7	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
DrugsMadelnAm	DMAA	10.86	0.3	2.8	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
EagleFinSvcs	EFTS	47.08	1.2	2.5	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
ElmExpress	ETS	1.66	5.3	3.2	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Elmet	ELMT	25.03	3.2	12.8	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Equinor	EQNR	45.62	-0.6	-1.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
ExpeditorsIntl	EXPD	193.82	0.5	0.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
FB Bancorp	FBN	16.10	-0.1	-0.6	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
FIC&CapitalA	FIKA	10.38	0.1	1.0	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
FirstBusFinSvcs	FBIZ	73.74	-0.2	-0.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
Frontline	FRD	50.78	2.7	5.3	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4
GeneralPurposeAcn	GPAC	10.07	0.1	1.0	Baxter	BX	24.00	-4.1	-16.4

Stock	52-Wk %				Stock	52-Wk %				Stock	52-Wk %			
	Sym	H/L	Chg	%		Sym	H/L	Chg	%		Sym	H/L	Chg	%
Boji Hawaii Pdb	BOHB	25.21	0.3	1.2	DigitalCurX	DCX	0.37	-24.7	-6.6	Go2 Labs	G02	4.3	-7.1	
Banzanti	PARA	0.97	1.1	11.3	DimCmclPfdA	DCOMP	16.41	-1.5	-9.1	Giftify	GIFT	0.58	-8.4	
BaochengMedia	BAOS	0.24	-12.7	-5.3	DirectDigital	DRCT	1.64	7.0	4.3	GlobaTerraMT	GTERW	0.02	-20.0	
Beneficient	BEIN	0.78	-24.0	-3.0	DigitalGlobe	DIGL	0.35	6.5	2.0	GlobaTerraMT	GTERR	0.06	-2.0	
BeyondMeat	BYND	9.81	1.0	10.2	DragonflyEnergy	DFLY	0.99	-3.9	-3.9	Goodyear	GO	5.30	-0.9	
BioCrux	BCRX	1.38	-6.5	-4.6	DukeEnergyAm	DUK	29.32	-1.0	-3.4	GrabGuan	PEW	2.15	-1.8	
BlackstoneMtg	BLMT	13.11	-1.3	-9.9	DukeEnergyInd	DUK	29.32	-1.0	-3.4	GranitePointMtg	GPMT	0.90	-4.2	
BoneBelt	BLGL	0.54	-1.9	-3.5	DukeEnergyRes	BROS	43.06	0.3	0.3	GranitePointMtg	GPMTA	15.51	-	
BortechBioPharm	BBOT	4.85	2.0	41.2	Eaton	DVAI	3.15	-12.3	-3.9	Gravitas	GTVA	5.31	0.0	
BridgeBio	BBIG	1.01	-1.9	-1.9	Eaton	EO	3.40	4.9	14.4	GreenlandMines	GLM	1.72	-0.9	
BrightHouseMtg	BHFA	13.74	-1.9	-13.8	Eaton	EPW	0.29	-6.8	-6.8	GreenlandMines	GLM	2.99	3.5	
BrightSpire	BRSP	4.04	-0.4	-9.8	ESAB	ESAB	67.21	-4.5	-6.7	GAP	PAC	19.34	-1.0	
BrookfieldBus	BBUC	25.70	-2.0	-7.8	Enbridge	ENBR	34.49	4.9	4.9	ASUR	ASR	247.30	0.1	
Brookfield	BN	37.37	-1.4	-3.7	Enbridge	ENBRW	0.28	-4.4	-4.4	HuhuTech	HUHU	3.90	-2.5	
BrookfieldRenew	BRPC	29.62	-3.4	-11.5	EnidreTherap	ELTX	1.95	-2.4	-2.4	Hawkeye360	HWKY	15.71	0.5	
BrookWealth	BNT	37.39	-1.4	-3.7	EllingtonCredit	EARN	4.15	3.5	3.5	HealthTrinAngle	HTI	0.72	-0.4	
Buckle	BUE	40.05	-1.1	-2.7	EllsworthCorp	ECFPA	19.00	-3.3	-3.3	HolloGroup	HOMO	4.88	-0.4	
Build-A-Bear	BBW	27.09	1.5	5.5	EnCorePower	ELPW	2.68	-0.7	-0.7	HowardHush	HHH	60.88	-1.0	
BurlingtonSts	BSRT	231.89	2.8	1.2	EmpireStateEnergy	ESUR	4.07	1.5	1.5	HubGroup	HUBG	1.17	-0.2	
BurtechAcqnlWt	BRHW	0.13	-6.7	-5.1	EnCoreEnergy	EUE	0.77	15.8	15.8	Hubb	HBC	6.62	-10.3	
CCH	COH	1.10	-0.4	-3.6	EnergyRecovery	ERII	6.93	-6.1	-6.1	HubGroup	HUBG	31.41	-2.2	
CDT Equity	CDT	0.21	-12.4	-5.8	Enliven	ENLV	0.86	-9.9	-9.9	HuntingtonPfd	HNHM	19.87	-0.9	
CMS Energy	CMS	66.58	0.5	0.7	Enovix	ENOV	18.00	-5.5	-5.5	Hyperfine	HYPR	0.78	-1.8	
CMSEnerNts2078	CMS2	20.32	-0.1	-0.5	Enovix	ENOV	2.96	-2.6	-2.6	IM Cannabis	IMCC	1.63	-1.7	
CMSEnerNts2079	CMS3	20.08	-0.4	-2.0	EnergyBds66	EAI	19.31	-0.4	-0.4	INIO	INIO	17.45	-14.3	
CMSEnerNts2080	CMS4	20.40	-4.1	-20.0	EnVueMedical	FEED	33.34	0.4	0.4	ITHAXAcqnlWt	ITHAW	0.15	-14.3	
CMSEnerMedica	CMED	1.87	1.0	53.5	EnvyayPwr	RAYA	1.65	-9.3	-9.3	IZEA	IZEA	2.78	-3.8	
CMSEnerNts2081	CMS5	20.40	-4.1	-20.0	EnvyayPwr	RAYA	1.65	-9.3	-9.3	IZEA	IZEA	2.78	-3.8	
Capstone	CAPS	0.17	-6.0	-3.4	EvoHoldingWt	EVXHS	10.88	-1.8	-1.8	InfectionPVIII	IPVX	10.08	-0.2	
CaribouBio	CRBU	12.67	0.6	4.7	Evotec	EVOT	1.66	-2.9	-2.9	InnovizTech	INNVZ	0.30	-2.5	
CaribouBio	CRBU	12.67	0.6	4.7	Evotec	EVOT	1.66	-2.9	-2.9	InnovizTech	INNVZ	0.30	-2.5	
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CaribouBio	CRBU	12.67	0.6	4.7	Evotec	EVOT	1.66	-2.9	-2.9	Innov				

Special Advertising Feature



Jitesh S. Ghai
CEO, Hyland

Why Enterprise Content Is the Big AI Opportunity Most Companies Miss

The vast majority of enterprise data is “unstructured.” How do you get it AI-ready?

When business leaders think about getting data AI-ready, they often think about all the data housed within enterprise platforms, like the CRM or ERP. Yet, that’s only a sliver of it.

“Unstructured” data — the information that lives within all the documents, images and videos that companies have — accounts for an estimated 85% of enterprise data, says Jitesh S. Ghai, CEO of Hyland, a leading content intelligence and automation provider. Extracting all that unstructured data allows companies to build AI models around it, unlocking business value.

We spoke with Ghai about why unstructured data will be key to generating business value from AI — and the right way to do it.

AI is advancing rapidly, yet many enterprises are struggling to create business value from it. What is preventing them?

Jitesh S. Ghai: The barrier isn’t the models; it’s that most enterprises’ data lives outside of them. This is not a criticism of the frontier labs. They have done a fantastic job of building highly sophisticated models based on public-domain data. But they’re not able to deliver widescale enterprise value, because, to do that, you need access to each specific enterprise’s data.

Many enterprises already have more of this foundation than they realize in their enterprise content management system. This vast amount of information that lives within documents, invoices, transcripts, images and videos is critical context AI needs to scale effectively.

If you need to automate loan processes or mortgage approvals or schedule patient referrals to doctors, you need that unstructured enterprise data and all the context from it — the background information that explains what the data means. Agents can’t take action and make decisions without context.

How is this evolution toward agentic automation changing what companies need to focus on with AI?

Ghai: Knowledge workers today spend an estimated 25% of their time just reading documents and trying to understand and extract the context within them. Companies need to focus on giving AI agents governed access to that data. With human oversight built in through a control tower, agentic automation can scale with confidence, driving real productivity gains.

Consider a mortgage analyst deciding whether to approve or decline a loan application. Just looking at your credit score is data, but digging into your bank statements, your outstanding loans, your investment accounts, applicable lending policy and the history of your application as a whole is context. That can now be derived and assembled — and all within the governed guardrails of their organization’s policies — using agentic automation. That’s just one example, but you can see this huge value and productivity across processes in pretty much every industry.

Another major benefit to agentic automation: Knowledge workers can be unburdened from mundane work and focus on what they actually enjoy most about their jobs — applying their experience to judgment and exception handling.

What has prevented companies from leveraging all of this enterprise data so far?

Ghai: The enterprise landscape is very fragmented, with repositories of documents across multiple file systems both

on premises and in the cloud. Business leaders might assume they need to bring all of this unstructured data, such as those documents, invoices, transcripts, images and videos, together in one place — but that can take months, if not years — and it’s the wrong goal. In fact, to build context, you should embrace fragmentation. At Hyland, our philosophy is that data is most useful where it lives, so we provide a federated architecture that derives context from documents wherever they exist. We also connect to systems of record. The more data sources you connect to, the richer the context, the richer the insight and the greater the veracity of the decisions and actions you can take from it.

Moreover, this process of getting context from unstructured data can now be automated. People don’t need to spend their time poring through documents.

You’ve talked about how the future of business will be the content-powered agentic enterprise. What does this look like?

Ghai: Picture a hospital where a physician’s notes and a patient’s imaging and insurance history are instantly assembled into full context and an AI agent can preapprove a referral before the patient leaves the room — with a human simply reviewing the exception cases. This is what the content-powered agentic enterprise looks like, and today we’re helping our 15,000 customers across what tend to be very highly regulated industries, ranging from healthcare to insurance to banking, do just this.

They come to Hyland because we provide them with governed, trusted, compliant access to their data to build that context for agentic automation.

Our customers are already seeing this automation generate meaningful business outcomes. One property and casualty insurer we work with created models that predict insurance fraud, saving it over \$50 million. That’s just one example, but this kind of outcome is possible because the company, together with Hyland, has learned to unlock value from their unstructured data, make it AI-ready and put it to work through agentic automation.

Agentic automation will create tremendous value for companies across industries, and it starts with gaining context from all that unstructured data so enterprises can eliminate that 25% of work time spent reading through documents. Once you do that, the possibilities to use that context through agentic AI and achieve impressive economic outcomes are immense.



Find out how Hyland helps companies gain context from their enterprise content and power agentic AI transformation.



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Amit Bajaj, **Tata Consultancy Services**
Jeffrey Solomon, **TD Cowen**
Noboru Saito, **TDK**
Mohit Joshi, **Tech Mahindra**
Daniel Alegre, **TelevisaUnivision**
Paul Keary, **Teneo Holdings**
Rob Holmes, **Texas Capital**
Mark Smucker, **The J.M. Smucker Company**
Rati Levesque, **The RealReal**
Almar Latour, **The Wall Street Journal**
Taso Du Val, **Toptal**
Richard Holtum, **Trafigura**
Eric Beringause, **TreeHouse Foods, Inc.**
Neil de Crescenzo, **TRIMEDX**

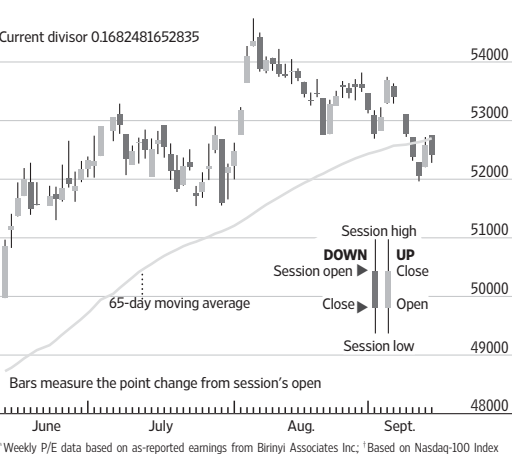
Jean Savage, **Trinity Industries**
Felix Morgan, **Trucordia**
Margi Tooth, **Trupanion**
Stephen Toups, **Turner Industries Group, LLC**
Gunjan Kedia, **U.S. Bancorp**
Thomas Jackiewicz, **UChicago Medicine**
Michael Crowl, **UFCU**
Juan Andrade, **United Services Automobile Association (USAA)**
Anand Eswaran, **Veeam**
Kaan Terzioglu, **VEON Group**
Dan Schulman, **Verizon**
Abdulaziz Al-Mawlawi, **Visit Qatar**
Daniel Savitt, **VNS Health**
Dylan Taylor, **Voyager Technologies**
Chris Nicholas, **Walmart International**
Robert J. Pagano, **Watts Water Technologies, Inc.**
Girish Saligram, **Weatherford International**
Karen Pugliese, **Weber Shandwick**
Charles Scharf, **Wells Fargo**
John Santora, **WeWork**
Melissa Smith, **WEX Inc.**
Steven Schwartz, **Whop**
Brent Gledhill, **William Blair**
Keshav Muruges, **WNS Global Services**
Jason Marx, **Wolters Kluwer Tax & Accounting**
Eric Mosley, **Workhuman**
Julie Iskow, **Workiva Inc.**
Alan Murray, **WSJ Leadership Institute**
Suzanne McCormick, **YMCA of the USA**
Joey Wat, **Yum China Holdings Inc.**
David A. Steinberg, **Zeta Global**
Ivan Tornos, **Zimmer Biomet**
Kristin Peck, **Zoetis**
Jay Chaudhry, **Zscaler**

MARKETS DIGEST

EQUITIES

Dow Jones Industrial Average

52421.20 ▼152.09, or 0.29%	Last	Year ago
High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.	Trailing P/E ratio	21.34 25.13
	P/E estimate *	19.76 22.11
	Dividend yield	1.51 1.61
	All-time high	54349.12, 08/05/26



* Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Biringi Associates Inc.; * Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	High	Low	Latest Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	% chg	YTD	% chg 3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	52750.88	52278.89	52421.20	-152.09	-0.29	54349.12	45166.64	14.2	9.1	14.5
Transportation Avg	20752.68	20471.51	20729.79	101.52	0.49	23933.14	15067.87	33.1	19.4	10.5
Utility Average	1072.84	1057.63	1059.09	-9.46	-0.89	1190.23	1048.33	-3.8	-0.8	5.7
Total Stock Market	75557.98	75007.17	75270.64	-358.56	-0.47	77313.23	62750.36	14.9	11.5	18.8
Barron's 400	1611.41	1601.88	1604.64	-8.50	-0.53	1685.46	1318.70	15.7	13.6	17.3

Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	26329.98	25992.55	26186.41	-146.62	-0.56	27093.90	20794.64	17.2	12.7	23.4
Nasdaq-100	29285.50	28867.67	29127.16	-241.28	-0.82	30660.60	22953.38	19.9	15.4	23.5

S&P										
500 Index	7647.99	7592.28	7619.98	-37.00	-0.48	7798.99	6343.72	15.2	11.3	19.1
MidCap 400	3698.39	3676.40	3679.20	-34.94	-0.94	3926.98	3109.89	12.2	11.3	12.3
SmallCap 600	1724.10	1711.75	1714.06	-12.12	-0.70	1828.54	1364.94	18.8	16.8	12.7

Other Indexes											
Russell 2000	2908.52	2885.54	2892.24	-11.71	-0.40		3068.42	2305.11	20.3	16.5	15.7
NYSE Composite	24331.56	24173.55	24205.39	-126.17	-0.52		24821.68	20912.89	13.1	10.0	14.6
Value Line	667.66	663.47	664.66	-1.470	-0.22		702.60	590.50	5.2	5.8	5.8
NYSE Arca Biotech	9241.78	9112.91	9204.32	91.41		1.00	9539.76	6043.49	51.0	28.7	20.7
NYSE Arca Pharma	1249.54	1218.36	1235.25	16.90		1.39	1315.38	925.18	30.4	9.7	10.2
KBW Bank	187.43	183.16	184.45	-3.61	-1.92		193.91	143.23	21.9	12.3	30.6
PHLX ^S Gold/Silver	390.92	382.44	387.62	-11.80	-2.95		470.37	265.03	39.5	13.2	49.3
PHLX ^S Oil Service	104.03	99.71	100.14	-4.20	-4.02		109.24	60.27	56.9	36.6	0.6
PHLX ^S Semiconductor	11285.30	11110.11	11131.28	-692.72	-5.86		14634.72	6059.83	83.7	57.2	45.9
Cboe Volatility	18.17	16.58	17.10	1.26		7.95	31.05	13.47	9.0	14.4	10.1
§Nasdaq PHLX											
Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data											

[§] Nasdaq PHLX Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Percentage Gainers...

Company	Symbol	Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	% chg
Future FinTech Group	FTFT	8.04	5.16	179.17	248.32	1.22	-96.0
Basel Medical Group	BMGL	7.14	2.56	55.90	25.80	4.17	-69.9
VTCE Holding	VNCE	7.65	2.41	45.99	8.20	1.95	188.7
GT Biopharma	GTBP	11.63	3.02	35.08	34.25	4.91	-42.2
Elmet Group	ELMT	21.50	5.31	32.80	25.03	12.49	...
GrShr 2x Long CRWD Daily	CRWL	84.37	18.31	27.71	86.79	15.25	187.0
Leverage 2X Lg PANW Dly	PANG	34.58	7.29	26.71	41.59	6.05	133.0
Direxion PANW Bull 2X	PALU	56.17	11.56	25.91	67.86	9.85	140.8
Leverage 2X Lg OKTA Dly	OKTG	46.57	9.10	24.30	47.88	7.00	...
Rapid7	RPD	12.79	2.48	24.05	20.95	4.97	-34.6
EUDA Health Holdings	EUDA	16.56	3.11	23.12	86.00	5.26	-27.4
EverCommerce	EVCM	7.56	1.25	19.81	14.41	6.21	-36.2
Leverage 2X Lg COIN Dly	COIG	6.16	0.96	18.44	52.00	3.50	-82.3
Direxion COIN Bull 2X	CONX	7.66	1.19	18.42	28.34	4.34	...
GrShr 2x Long COIN Daily	CONL	6.29	0.97	18.23	52.40	3.56	-82.1

Volume Movers Ranked by change from 65-day average[§]

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Sophus Cap Emerging Mkt	EMEM	1,065	9779	25.81	-2.24	28.66	23.41
Angel Oak UitSh Incm	UYLD	10,317	5659	50.92	-0.14	51.46	50.89
Safeguard Acquisition	SAC	1,130	5447	10.11	...	11.02	9.90
ALPS Smith Core Plus Bd	SMTH	20,226	5002	25.02	-0.04	26.47	24.98
Sophus Cap Emer Mkt SC	EMSC	557	4888	25.33	-1.77	27.39	23.34
Eltek	ELTK	243	3395	9.00	10.43	11.59	7.30
Pictet AI Enhanced US Eq	PQUS	1,928	3307	28.31	-0.49	29.40	23.45
Elmet Group	ELMT	13,920	3171	21.50	32.80	25.03	12.49
Armata Pharmaceuticals	ARMP	4,702	3046	5.55	3.16	16.34	2.86
ITHAX Acquisition III	ITHA	156	2964	10.06	0.10	10.09	9.85

* Common stocks priced at \$2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares * Has traded fewer than 65 days

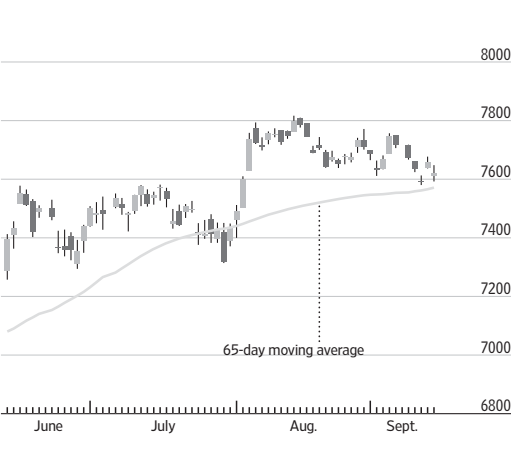
International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Net chg	Latest % chg	YTD % chg
World	MSCI ACWI	1135.77	-7.39	-0.65	11.9
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	476.46	-4.51	-0.94	13.2
	MSCI World	4910.28	-27.04	-0.55	10.8
	MSCI Emerging Markets	1697.85	-23.68	-1.38	20.9
Americas	MSCI AC Americas	2886.55	-13.950	-0.48	11.3
Canada	S&P/TSX Comp	35702.53	5.04	0.01	12.6
Latin Amer.	MSCI EM Latin America	3109.88	-50.04	-1.58	14.8
Brazil	Bovespa	185500.88	-1706.01	-0.91	15.1
Chile	S&P IPSA	5695.13	61.15	1.09	5.0
Mexico	S&P/BMV IPC	64216.98	292.21	0.46	-0.1
EMEA	STOXX Europe 600	635.99	-3.11	-0.49	7.4
Eurozone	Euro STOXX	658.90	-8.57	-1.28	7.6
Belgium	Bel-20	5729.67	16.31	0.29	12.8
Denmark	OMX Copenhagen 20	1577.01	2.53	0.16	-1.9
France	CAC 40	8117.78	-61.99	-0.76	-0.4
Germany	DAX	25440.81	-127.75	-0.50	3.9
Israel	Tel Aviv	4227.56	6.12	0.14	16.4
Italy	FTSE MIB	51628.77	-883.26	-1.68	14.9
Netherlands	AEX	1098.35	-0.41	-0.04	15.5
Norway	Oslo Bors All-Share	2527.59	3.79	0.15	30.2
South Africa	FTSE/JSE All-Share	113536.30	-1629.01	-1.41	-2.0
Spain	IBEX 35	19565.50	-273.00	-1.38	13.0
Sweden	OMX Stockholm	1114.80	-10.69	-0.95	6.6
Switzerland	Swiss Market	13878.54	103.27	0.75	4.6
Turkey	BIST 100	14235.83	-231.42	-1.60	26.4
U.K.	FTSE 100	10697.57	47.13	0.44	7.7
U.K.	FTSE 250	23834.48	-141.25	-0.59	6.1
Asia-Pacific	MSCI AC Asia Pacific	275.22	-2.50	-0.90	20.9
Australia	S&P/ASX 200	8749.90	8.69	0.10	0.4
China	Shanghai Composite	3885.33	-2.78	-0.07	-2.1
Hong Kong	Hang Seng	24917.60	111.97	0.45	-2.8
India	BSE Sensex	74781.76	...	Closed	-12.2
Japan	NIKKEI 225	63492.99	-518.35	-0.81	26.1
Singapore	Straits Times	5718.02	22.09	0.39	23.1
South Korea	KOSPI	6684.37	-225.54	-3.26	58.6
Taiwan	TAIEX	45862.52	-322.33	-0.70	58.3
Thailand	SET	1591.07	-13.45	-0.84	26.3

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

S&P 500 Index

7619.98 ▼37.00, or 0.48%	Last	Year ago
High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.	Trailing P/E ratio *	23.22 25.10
	P/E estimate *	20.25 21.65
	Dividend yield *	1.08 1.18
	All-time high	7798.99, 08/13/26



* Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Biringi Associates Inc.; * Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of \$2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	After Hours % chg	High	Low
Comcast Cl A	CMCSA	9,729.3	24.94	0.06	0.24	25.01	24.88
NVIDIA	NVDA	9,279.0	212.24	1.28	0.61	226.51	199.97
Broadcom	AVGO	8,360.1	345.45	0.73	0.21	345.75	323.83
Nokia ADR	NOK	6,163.2	9.77	0.12	1.24	9.78	9.65
Iovance Biotherapeutics	IOVA	5,313.7	9.23	-0.03	-0.32	9.27	9.11
Nike Cl B	NKE	5,143.9	37.08	0.03	0.08	37.16	36.95
UiPath	PATH	4,741.2	14.62	-0.04	-0.27	14.67	14.60
CCC Intelligent Solns	CCC	4,223.7	6.85	0.09	1.33	6.86	6.74
Radiant Logistics	RLGT	624.9	8.94	0.73	8.89	9.50	8.06
Ecovyst	ECVT	80.8	10.32	0.35	3.51	10.42	9.97
Vistance Networks	VISN	72.0	6.68	0.22	3.33	6.68	6.46
Trekor Metals	TGB	270.5	8.06	0.22	2.81	8.12	7.84
Hess Midstream	HESM	105.7	41.00	1.11	2.78	41.00	39.60
Enova International	ENVA	50.9	184.00	-42.72	-18.84	231.14	179.88
Dave & Buster's	PLAY	2,407.7	7.39	-1.08	-12.75	8.91	7.06
Kestra Medical Techs	KMTS	88.9	22.13	-1.93	-8.02	24.44	21.09
Armata Pharmaceuticals	ARMP	51.5	5.15	-0.40	-7.21	5.60	4.50
Form	TRMD	166.4	32.90	-2.44	-6.90	35.63	32.34

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest Session			52-Week		
		Close	Net chg	% chg	High	Low	% chg
Nuburu	BURU	1.35	-1.20	-47.06	169.66	0.85	-96.0
Collectis ADR	CLLS	1.83	-1.27	-40.97	5.48	1.75	-36.7
Horizon Quantum Holdings	HQ	10.34	-4.88	-32.06	45.00	8.29	-70.9
TEN Holdings	XHLD	8.92	-3.61	-28.81	15.43	0.76	32.6
Leverage 2X Lg GLW Dly	GLWG	11.71	-4.43	-27.45	51.00	7.82	...
Leverage 2X Lg TER Dly	TERG	30.08	-10.58	-26.02	80.05	12.19	...
PicoCELA ADR	PCLA	7.73	-2.38	-23.54	19.61	1.35	-52.1
Swvl Holdings	SWVL	5.51	-1.61	-22.56	8.48	1.30	45.0
Antelope Enterprise	AEHL	6.07	-1.74	-22.28	418.08	2.98	-98.1
Rent the Runway	RENT	1.93	-0.52	-21.22	10.13	1.86	-61.6
U Power	UCAR	3.98	-0.99	-19.92	432.00	3.76	-99.0
Leverage 2X Lg ARM Dly	ARMG	15.13	-3.72	-19.73	65.95	4.64	20.4
Dirxion Daily KR BI 3X	KORU	1.87	-0.50	-19.51	63.99	9.43	268.1
Solarmax Technology	SMXT	1.89	-0.45	-19.23	15.24	1.82	-85.7
Swarmr	SWMR	32.16	-7.43	-18.77	83.30	11.25	...

COMMODITIES

wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures						
		Contract			Open interest	
	Open	High	hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg
Copper-High (CMX) -25,000 lbs.; \$ per lb.						
Sept	6.4100	6.4100		6.2810		
Dec	6.5525	6.5525	6.3515			
Gold (CMX) -100 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Sept	4365.80	4389.50	4365.80	4310.00	-56.20	487
Oct	4345.90	4367.90	4259.50	4318.00	-56.80	45,168
Nov	4361.20	4377.90	4286.90	4335.20	-56.90	818
Dec	4375.00	4396.80	4293.00	4351.90	-57.00	314,274
Jan'27	4344.00	4350.30	4336.60	4371.20	-57.30	544
Feb	4411.20	4431.60	4329.00	4387.60	-57.50	33,639
Palladium (NYM) -50 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Sept	1293.00	1293.00	1288.00	1294.60	-16.30	2
Dec	1313.50	1320.00	1282.00	1307.70	-16.20	16,060
Platinum (NYM) -50 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Sept	1916.80	1916.80	1904.20	1775.90	-17.60	36
Oct	1799.00	1808.40	1751.70	1779.80	-17.80	31,807
Silver (CMX) -5,000 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Sept	63.600	63.700	63.020	63.513	-1.040	657
Dec	64.785	64.980	62.800	64.138	-1.051	85,601
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM) -100,000 bbls.; \$ per bbl.						
Oct	102.25	104.95	100.53	101.39	1.34	175,963
Nov	98.00	100.63	96.29	97.14	1.20	259,949
Dec	93.01	94.07	91.80	92.60	1.17	214,060
Jan'27	89.00	90.10	87.74	88.65	0.97	102,568
June	77.75	78.23	76.21	77.21	0.42	129,033
Dec	72.15	72.90	71.45	72.20	0.09	178,981
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM) -42,000 gal.; \$ per gal.						
Oct	5.0200	5.1919	4.9084	4.9615	-.0022	48,566
Nov	4.8526	4.9469	4.7110	4.7553	-.0130	60,017
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM) -42,000 gal.; \$ per gal.						
Oct	3.3372	3.4603	3.2964	3.3171	-.0099	68,358
Nov	3.1436	3.2578	3.1172	3.1374	-.0176	88,579
Natural Gas (NYM) -10,000 MMBtu.; \$ per MMBtu.						
Oct	2.868	2.911	2.849	2.896	-.065	211,146
Nov	3.014	3.055	3.000	3.046	-.063	333,051
Dec	3.491	3.527	3.451	3.477	-.008	178,809
Jan'27	3.905	3.940	3.850	3.875	-.015	175,439
March	2.900	2.917	2.873	2.891	-.004	175,597
April	2.768	2.780	2.748	2.761	-.002	124,973

Agriculture Futures						
Corn (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	513.50	517.50	509.50	512.00	1.75	65

Dividend Changes

Company	Symbol	Yld %	New/Old	Frq	Payable/Record
Increased					
Adamas Tr Pfd. E	ADAMM	10.5	6672/65493	q	Oct15/Oct01
Cherry Hill Mtg Pfd. B	CHM1pb	10.3	6162/6045	q	Oct15/Sept30
Dynex Cap Pfd. C	DXPC	9.3	6079/59416	q	Oct15/Oct01
Four Corners Property Tr	FCPT	6.1	1265/1222	M	Nov16/Oct30
Reduced					
4.65% Fltg. Rate STRATS	GJO	4.6	0938/09405	M	Sept15/Sept14
FR STRATS 2006-2 GS Grp	GJS	5.0	0984/09894	M	Sept15/Sept30
Public Policy Holding	PPHC	1.9	117/24	SA	Oct23/Sept25
STRATS Sers 2006-1 P&G	GJR	4.6	096/09654	M	Sept15/Sept14
Stocks					
ICZOOM Group Cl A	IZM		1.5		/Sept15
Impact BioMedicine	IBO		112.62		/Sept23

KEY: A: annual; M: monthly; Q: quarterly; r: revised; SA: semiannual; S21: stock split and ratio; SO: spin-off.

Cash Prices | wsj.com/market-data/commodities

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

Monday		Monday		Monday	
Energy		Fibers and Textiles		Food	
Coal,C,Aplc.,12500Btu.,12SO2-r,w	84.000	BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, >99.5%-v,w	22325	Beef,carcass equiv. index	347.30
Coal,Pwdr,RvrBsn,8800Btu.,0.85O2-r,w	14.500	BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, >56.5%-v,w	20925	choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	326.58
Metals		BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5%-v,w	9760	select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	1.1608
		BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,k	4358	Broilers, National comp wtd. avg.-u,w	1.3700
		BMI Fale Graphite, FOB China, 100 Mesh, 94-95%-v,m	425	Butter,AA Chicago-d	144.00
Gold, per troy oz		Grains and Feeds		Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	142.00
Engelhard industrial	4263.00	Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-r,w	1.2800	Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	199.50
Krugerrand,wholesale-e	4479.03	Cotton,11/16 std lw-mdlMphs-u	0.7689	Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	2.9247
Maple Leaf-e	4522.10	Cotlook 'A' Index-t	*98.20	Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.5739
American Eagle-e	4522.10	Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.	Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	0.6550
Mexican peso-e	5200.66	Wool,64s, staple, Terr del-u,w	n.a.	Flour,hard winter KC-p	19.70
Austria crown-e	4224.49			Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	n.a.
Austria phil-e	4522.10			Hogs,lowa-So. Minnesota-u	84.48
Silver, troy oz.				Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	1.4798
Engelhard industrial	62.8500			Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	1.0500
Handy & Harman base	63.2940			Steers,Tex-Okla. Choice-u	n.a.
Handy & Harman fabricated	79.1180			Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	n.a.
Coins,wholesale \$1,000 face-a	45348			Fats and Oils	
Other metals				Degummed com oil, crude wtd. avg.-u,w	n.a.
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	1774.0			Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	n.a.
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	1300.0			Lard,Chicago-u	n.a.
Aluminum, LME, \$ per metric ton	*3274.0			Soybean oil,crude,Cent IL-u,w	0.7379
Copper,Comex spot	6.3300			Tallow,bleach,Chicago-h	n.a.
Iron ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*96.2			Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.
Steel, HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	*1220.0				
Battery/EV metals					

KEY TO CODES: A=ask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME, E=Manfra, Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Social Publishing; R=SMI Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Cotlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 9/11

Borrowing Benchmarks | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation		Week		—52-WEEK—	
Aug. index	Chg From (%)	Latest	ago	High	Low
level	July '26	Aug '25			
U.S. consumer price index					
All items	334.980	0.32	3.4		
Core	338.041	0.27	2.4		
International rates					
Latest	Week ago	—52-Week—			
		High	Low		
Prime rates					
U.S.	6.75	6.75	7.50	6.75	
Canada	4.45	4.45	4.95	4.45	
U.S. government rates					
Discount	3.75	3.75	4.50	3.75	

Key Interest Rates

Data are annualized on a 360-day basis. Treasury yields are per annum, on actively traded noninflation and inflation-indexed issues that are adjusted to constant maturities. Data are from weekly Federal Reserve release H.15.

		Week Ended		—52-Week—						Week Ended		—52-Week—	
		Sept 11	Sept 4	High	Low			Sept 11	Sept 4	High	Low		
Federal funds (effective)													
		3.63	3.63	4.33	3.62			6-month	4.05	3.98	4.05	3.96	
								1-year	4.24	4.15	4.24	3.43	
								2-year	4.50	4.37	4.50	3.42	
								3-year	4.56	4.43	4.56	3.38	
								5-year	4.68	4.53	4.68	3.58	
Commercial paper								7-year	4.78	4.64	4.78	3.77	
Nonfinancial								10-year	4.89	4.78	4.89	4.00	
1-month		3.76	3.72	4.20	3.61			20-year	5.33	5.26	5.33	4.54	
2-month		3.81	3.81	4.11	3.58								
3-month		3.83	3.85	4.03	3.62								
Financial													
1-month		n.a.	3.71	4.09	3.60								
2-month		3.76	3.76	4.10	3.61								
3-month		3.87	3.83	4.07	3.62								
Treasury yields (secondary market)													
1-month		3.72	3.68	4.09	3.55								
3-month		3.85	3.77	3.94	3.53								
6-month		3.95	3.89	3.95	3.48								
TIPS													
5-year		2.26	2.17	2.26	1.17								
7-year		2.38	2.29	2.38	1.43								
10-year		2.51	2.44	2.51	1.70								
20-year		2.83	2.77	2.83	2.14								
Long-term avg		2.98	2.94	2.98	2.28								

Notes on data:
Federal-funds rate is an average for the seven days ended Wednesday, weighted according to rates on broker trades; **Commercial paper rates** are discounted offer rates interpolated from sales by discounted averages of dealer bid rates on nationally traded certificates of deposit; **Discount window primary credit rate** is charged for discounts made and advances extended under the Federal Reserve's primary credit discount window program; **rate** is average for seven days ended Wednesday; **Inflation-indexed long-term TIPS average** is indexed and is based on the unweighted average bid yields for all TIPS with remaining terms to maturity of 10 years or more;
Sources: Federal Reserve; for additional information on these rate data and their derivation, please see, https://www.federalreserve.gov/data/download/Bulld.asp?xrel=H15

		Contract			Open interest	
	Open	High	hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg
Oats (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	530.50	536.50		526.25	533.25	3.00
Dec	355.00	355.00		355.00	357.75	1.75
Nov	381.00	400.50	376.50		393.00	14.00
Soybeans (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	1285.25	1285.25		1285.25	1285.25	5.00
Nov	1296.75	1309.75	1292.00		1304.25	7.75
Soybean Meal (CBT) -100 tons; \$ per ton.						
Sept	345.00	345.00		345.00	349.70	2.70
Dec	352.90	359.00	350.60		356.20	3.40
Soybean Oil (CBT) -60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	70.66	70.66		70.66	69.36	.35
Dec	70.03	70.71	69.55		70.19	.51
Rough Rice (CBT) -2,000 cwt.; \$ per cwt.						
Sept	15.66	15.66		15.55	15.57	-.04
Nov	15.97	16.12	15.90		16.00	-.03
Wheat (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	713.50	713.50		709.75	707.00	...
Dec	729.00	734.00	710.00		722.00	-3.25
Wheat (KC) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	805.00	805.00		802.00	778.00	-6.00
Dec	804.00	804.50	782.00		792.50	-6.00
Cattle-Feeder (CME) -50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	340.00	343.975	338.950		343.575	5.750

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables		
The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Market Center listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.		
Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.		
Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was \$2 or higher.		
Footnotes: 1-New 52-week high; 1-New 52-week low; dd -indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.		
Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.		

Monday, September 14, 2026			Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
A B C						
AES	AES	14.80	-0.01			
AFIL	117.11	17.71				
AGNC Inv	AGNC	10.09	-0.06			
APA	APA	45.03	0.30			
ASe Tech	ASTX	37.08	-2.39			
ASML	ASML	175.125-15.15				
AST Space	ASTS	60.00	0.14			
ATI	ATI	26.51	0.05			
AT&T	ATI	188.15	-10.62			
AirtelLabs	ATL	103.99	1.12			
Abbvie	ABBV	261.77	4.65			
Abivax	ABVX	113.58	-5.06			
Accurate	ACN	195.00	11.10			
Acuity	AYI	309.04	-9.92			
Adobe	ADBE	265.60	13.37			
AdoDrainageSys	WMS	125.33	-2.55			
AdvIntersys	AEIS	25.34	-32.90			
AdvMicroDevices	AMT	493.41	-22.72			
Aegion	AEIG	9.06				
AerCap	AER	139.42	-2.08			
AffiliatedMrgs	AMG	349.98	-6.93			
Affirm	AFRM	73.38	1.94			
AgilentTechs	A	146.80	0.13			
AgriCoEneAms	ALM	97.55	-2.81			
AirProducts	APD	287.13	-4.50			
Airbnb	ABNB	170.05	4.68			
Akam	AKAM	162.92	-3.39			
AlamosGold	AG	34.26	-0.26			
Albermarle	ALB	115.03	-2.49			
Alcoa	AA	46.95	-1.31			
Alcon	ALC	67.74	1.71			
Alibaba	BABA	109.23	-0.07			
AlignTech	ALGN	153.50	2.18			
Allegion	ALLE	155.39	2.04			
AltenEnergy	ALT	66.92	-0.34			
Altimis	ALIS	22.79	-0.45			
Allstate	ALL	258.48	4.77			
AllyFinancial	ALLY	41.94	-0.13			
AllylumpFund	ALNY	249.99	1.31			
Alphabet A	GOOG	345.71	10.26			
Altrna	MTN	70.61	1.63			
Amazon.com	AMZN	253.54	2.00			
Ambev	ABEV	3.03	0.01			
Amcor	AMCR	42.25	-0.07			
AmeriSports	AS	27.55	-0.52			
Ameren	AEE	103.97	-0.93			
AmericaMovil	AMOV	23.12	0.29			
AEP	AEP	122.23	-1.10			
AmeriExpress	AMEX	22.72	-0.22			
AmericanFin	AFG	14.70	0.14			
AmerHlthcRnt	AHR	53.40	-0.18			
AmHomesREIT	AMH	31.63	0.15			
AIG	AIG	76.26	0.96			
AmerTowerREIT	AMT	176.94	-0.91			
AmerWater	AWK	138.92	1.23			
Ameriserve	AMPS	558.54	0.93			
Ametek	AME	125.34	0.23			
Amgen	AMGN	381.15	5.05			
AmkorTech	AMTK	47.12	-4.61			
Amphenol	APH	78.55	-3.57			
Amrizee	AMRZ	39.43	-1.09			
AnalogueDevices	ADI	361.02	-17.76			
AnalogGoldAsh	AGO	40.48	-3.94			
AS Inbev	BUD	79.28	1.59			
AnnyCap	NLY	4.42	-0.06			
AntaresMidstream	AMN	21.62	0.44			
AntaresResources	AR	38.10	-0.33			
Aon	AON	311.54	8.85			
API Group	APG	37.12	-0.74			
ApolluGibMgmt	APM	128.31	-0.67			
Apple	AAPL	333.08	4.81			
AppliedIntell	AIT	319.21	-4.57			
AppMaterials	AMT	42.41	-32.28			
AppView	APPV	324.24	10.28			
Apptiv	APTV	44.79	-0.75			
Aracmark	ARMK	58.53	-0.02			
ArcelorMittal	MT	72.79	-1.72			
ArchCapital	ACGL	97.95	-1.86			
ADAM	ADAM	86.44	-0.28			
aresMgmt	ARES	131.52	-0.12			
Argus	ARG	98.92	-0.48			
Armstrong	ARM	112.81	-17.78			
Arm	ARM	29.01	-25.78			
ArrowElec	ARW	213.85	-14.35			
ArrowheadPharm	ARH	80.67	-2.18			
Axaris	AXIS	49.11	-3.34			
AscendisPharma	ASND	264.92	1.94			
Assurant	AIT	283.27	0.81			
Asteralabs	ALAB	257.40	-34.18			
AstraZeneca	AZN	163.78	3.61			
Atlas	ATLS	122.77	13.07			
CiscoSystems	CSO	110.06	-2.07			
AutosRental	ATO	163.84	0.65			
AuroraInnov	AUR	6.46	0.03			
Autodesk	ADSK	228.93	16.53			
ADP	ADP	276.63	8.37			
AutoZone	AZ	296.52	88.77			
Avantor	AVTR	15.16	0.35			
AvyDenovision	AVY	170.92	1.54			
AxosFinancial	AXOS	49.67	-0.15			
AxomeTherap	AXSM	216.58	-1.17			
BCE	BCE	23.47	0.08			
BHP Group	BHP	84.74	-2.41			
BJ'sWholesale	BJ	95.31	3.82			
BP	BP	45.93	-0.17			
BVWX Tech	BVWX	148.53	-19.59			
BXP	BXP	64.50	-0.20			
Baidu	BIDU	101.92	-0.50			
BakerHughes	BKR	56.78	-2.28			
Ball	BALL	60.71	0.81			
BBVA	BBVA	29.10	-0.45			
BancoBadesco	BBDO	3.18	-0.02			
BancosChile	BCCH	41.43	-0.29			
BancoBrasilBSBR	BSBR	5.95	-0.07			
BcoSanChile	BSAC	34.75	-0.44			
BancoSantander	BSAN	14.74	-0.21			
BancoAmerica	BAC	97.47	-3.22			
BancoMontreal	BMO	174.28	-0.60			
BankNY Mellon	BNY	157.66	-0.50			
BankNovaScotia	BNS	43.93	-0.02			
Barclays	BCS	25.86	-0.04			
BarrickMining	B	42.43	-1.25			

New Highs and Lows

Continued From Page B4			Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg
M&T Bk Pfd J	MTBpJ	25.43	-0.3			
MFA Financial	MFI	8.42	-1.2			
MGP Incidents	MGP	14.70	-0.1			
MadisonSolar	MAIR	24.79	-0.1			
ManTech43	MNHC	11.00	-0.3			
Marchex	MGX	123	-9.9			
MathewsInt	MATW	19.58	-0.4			
MedialPro	MPT	3.56	-0.1			
MedicusPharma	MDCX	0.74	-0.28			
Mediastars	MLCO	4.16	-0.48			
MesabiTrust	MSB	20.65	-0.5			
MobiasAcqnt	MTAL	9.63	-0.25			
MobiluPfd	MTFp	91.91	-0.3			
Microvent	MVST	0.58	-0.2			
MicroVision	MVIS	1.94	-0.1			
MilestonePharm	MST	0.94	-0.1			

Mutual Funds

Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-powered shares by net assets.		
e-E-distribution; f-Previous day's quotation; g-Footnotes x and s apply; f-Footnotes e and s apply; R-Reallocated by LSE; using updated data; p-Distribution costs apply; 12b-1-Redemption charge may apply; s-Stock split or dividend; f-Footnotes p and r apply; w-Footnotes x and s apply; f-Footnotes g and s apply; NA-Not available due to incomplete price performance or cost data; NE-Not released by LSE; data under review; NN-Fund not tracked; NS-Fund didn't exist at last period.		
Monday, September 14, 2026		
Fund	NAV	Net YTD % Chg
AB Funds		
AB Financial	10.70	-0.01 -0.8
American Century Inv		
Ultra	97.37	-0.82 3.5
American Funds C I A		
Amcpa	44.75	-0.19 4.8
BaIIa	40.08	-0.20 8.5
Bond	10.93	-0.9
CapIBA	82.74	-0.59 1.8
CapWGRA	61.26	1.13 14.7
CapwCA	63.79	0.91 1.5
Fiducia	101.92	-0.67 12.9
Gwtha	12.90	0.57 8.4
ICAA	68.09	-0.48 9.5
InCoA	27.86	-0.16 8.7
N PerA	74.72	-0.54 1.8
NecoA	84.67	-1.05 16.3
NwrWridA	106.96	-1.49 14.7
SmCPa	81.99	-1.21 10.6
WshA	67.44	-0.18 8.1
Artisan Funds		
Dimensional Fds		

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
Flex	FLEX	108.32	-7.46
Fluor	FLU	71.39	-0.37
FluorEnergy	FLUT	100.65	0.09
FEMSA	FMX	12.26	-0.11
FordMotor	F	13.86	0.31
ForgentPwr	FPT	28.64	-3.11
Fortinet	FTNT	16.18	14.11
Fortis	FTS	54.07	-0.30
Fortive	FTV	55.19	0.50
FoxA	FOXA	68.53	-2.57
FoxB	FOX	61.14	2.69
Franco-Nevada	FMV	261.67	-0.43
FranklinTemp	BEN	33.47	-0.18
FreedomHolding	FRHC	165.34	-0.16
FreeportMcM	FCM	69.34	-1.73
FreseniusMedCare	FMC	22.86	0.51
Fritture	FRU	50.52	1.31
FUTURE	FUTU	111.1	-1.62
GE Aerospace	GE	317.56	-4.10
GE HealthCare	GEHC	64.25	-0.32
GE Vernova	GEV	87.76	-82.51
GL Environmental	GL	42.61	-0.24
GSK	GSK	50.05	1.92
GalaxyDigital	GLXY	24.33	-0.22
Gallagher	AGX	25.13	12.98
GamingStop	GME	21.62	0.47
GamingLoops	GLPI	41.05	0.81
GameStar	GAME	20.38	-2.29
Gartner	IT	19.07	1.17
GenDigital	GEN	31.41	1.15
Generac	GNRC	17.68	-10.01
GeneralDynamics	GD	356.81	0.91
GeneralMills	GIS	36.47	0.62
GeneralMotors	GM	87.16	1.54
GeneralP	GP	32.65	0.18
Genpact	G	133.21	-0.47
Genrad	GGG	48.9	-0.26
GlaxoSciences	GLO	146.41	2.69
Glaueks	GKOS	17.19	0.34
GlobalPayments	GPN	19.9	1.90
GlobalFoundries	GFS	43.54	-3.41
Globalstar	GSAT	81.99	-0.74
GlobalLife	GL	17.92	1.75
GlobalMedical	GLMD	80.54	-0.54
GoDaddy	GDDY	104.47	-4.60
GoldFields	GFI	41.32	-1.98
GoldenSachs	GS	98.45	-0.73
Grab	GRAB	3.02	-0.03
Graco	GGG	76.56	-0.16
Grainger	GRO	127.51	-0.49
GAP	PAC	20.41	-2.05
GroupCBest	CB	51.21	-0.29
HealthEquity	HE	167.84	-10.46
Guidewire	GWRE	15.95	12.08
HCA Healthcare	HCA	425.49	-0.45
HDFC Bank	HDB	22.89	-0.93
HFC Sinclair	HSI	106.91	-0.93
HP	HPQ	34.02	-1.46
HSBC	HSBC	103.94	-1.36
H World	HTHT	43.85	0.01
Halliburton	HAL	9.39	0.20
Halliburton	HAL	35.01	-0.83
HalyonTherap	HALO	107.94	0.74
HarmoneyGroup	HMY	19.63	-1.01
Hartfordins	HIS	19.59	1.23
Hasbro	HAS	13.76	-0.78
HealthPeak	DHC	20.37	-0.12
HelixMining	HLM	18.82	-0.96
Helix	HEL	30.75	-2.75
HeicoA	HEA	22.73	-7.52
HenryShein	HSC	88.93	0.57
EOG Resources	EOG	148.54	1.18
Hess	HES	51.21	-0.68
Hershey	HSY	173.68	0.36
HewlettPackard	HPQ	55.1	-6.68
Hilton	HIT	310.67	4.11
Homedepot	HD	310.67	2.13
Honeywell	HON	124.98	0.92
HoneywellA	HONA	164.08	5.82
Honeywell	HON	201.38	-0.98
HormelFoods	HRL	20.96	0.39
HR Horton	DHI	29.41	1.52
HostHolds	HST	23.21	0.15
HoulihanLokey	HL	13.87	1.21
Humble	HUM	22.13	-0.28
Humana	HUM	25.63	-0.89
Hudbay	HBM	40.02	-2.78
JHUnited	JBT	17.49	4.54
HuntingtonBanc	HBT	26.77	-0.99
HuntingtonHls	HUT	28.01	0.32
Hut8	HUT	11.33	-7.47
Huyfilds	HUYF	12.71	0.61
ICI Bank	IBN	29.26	-0.13
IDEX	IDX	22.14	-0.07

HEARD_{ON THE} STREET

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

Rate Moves Put Mortgage Bonds at Risk

There are fewer people sitting on ultracheap home loans than you might think

At Labor Day picnics this year, millions fewer Americans could brag about having a sub-3% mortgage than a few years ago.

That might be a relief for frustrated home buyers sick of hearing about it. But it is an ominous sign for investors.

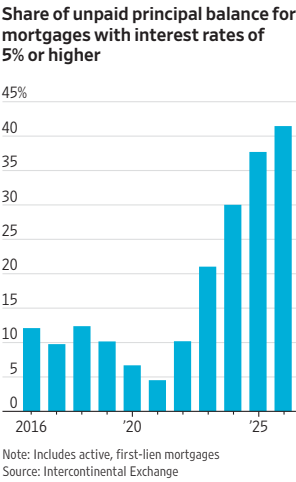
Many homeowners and home buyers locked in superlow borrowing rates during the pandemic. Even though mortgage rates have since risen sharply and slowed new borrowing, life has continued. First-time buyers still bought. Older mortgages were paid off. People gave up low-cost mortgages to move for family or work. And so on. There were nearly 15 million active primary mortgage loans in the U.S. with rates under 3% as of the end of 2021, according to Intercontinental Exchange data. As of this July, there were under 12 million.

The market shift has been stark in dollar terms. At the end of 2022, around 10% of unpaid principal balances were on mortgages with rates of 5% or higher, according to ICE. As of this July, 5%-plus mortgages represented more than 40% of unpaid balances.

This has economic consequences. Many homeowners were shielded from surging interest rates in 2022 with locked-in rates. Today, rising yields mean that home buyers who had to borrow at higher rates will have to wait a while longer to refinance and enjoy lower monthly payments.

The shift also has investment implications. A much bigger portion of the mortgage market is now eager to refinance if rates fall and will be put off from doing so by rising rates. That is a crucial dynamic for investors in mortgage-backed securities, or MBS.

Fixed-income investors who have lived through tough years recently as rates have surged could turn to government-backed mortgage bonds to earn extra yield while still



The steady rise in mortgage rates has slowed down borrowing. A house for sale in California.

avoiding credit risk.

The iShares MBS ETF holds bonds issued by government-sponsored enterprises such as Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac that pool individual home loans. The MBS ETF has returned an annualized 4.3% over the past three years, about 1.2 percentage points more than the iShares U.S. Treasury Bond ETF, according to FactSet data.

One reason that mortgage bonds typically yield more than Treasuries—about 5.8% for the AGNC ICE UMBS 30-Year Current Coupon Index, versus just under 5% for 10-year Treasuries—is the risk around early prepayments of mortgage loans via refinancing.

That risk was subdued when rates surged. Mortgages at 2% or 3% weren't going to be refinanced by borrowers at 6%, or at 7%. And, of course, rates were in no danger of going below those pandemic-era levels.



Now, the market has tilted more toward mortgages at rates that very well could refinance at realistically lower rates. This means the risk of mortgages getting prepaid either much faster or much more slowly is once again a major consideration for investors.

That can either lengthen the life of a mortgage bond, if fewer refinancings happen, or shorten it, if a lot do. So investors thinking they are locking in mortgage bonds' solid yields for a period of time can be disappointed one way or the other.

With a shorter life, that money has to be reinvested at lower yields. At a longer life, mortgage bonds' trading price becomes even more sensitive to higher rates.

"With mortgage bonds, you can get more yield than Treasuries," explains Harley Bassman, author of

The Convexity Maven website and creator of the MOVE index. "But the trade-off is that you can lose more when rates are rising, and make less when rates are falling."

At the moment, there seems little prospect of rates falling, with Treasury bonds under pressure and the Federal Reserve poised to tighten. But if long-term bond yields do start coming down, perhaps following some kind of cyclical downturn in the artificial-intelligence sector, holders of mortgage bonds could be surprised at the pace of repayments.

Walt Schmidt, mortgage strategist at FHN Financial, has noted that average loan balances have risen, today's borrowers also have higher credit scores, and more loans are serviced by nonbank firms. Those firms aim to refinance their customers aggressively be-

cause they make money from volume.

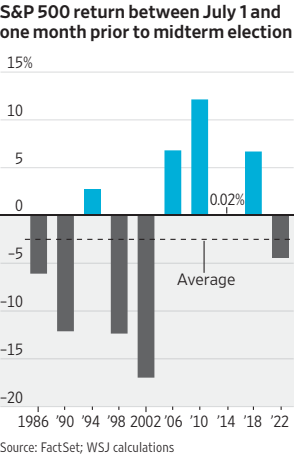
"The market is currently very complacent about the potential for faster speeds," FHN strategists wrote in a July note.

Technology plays a role, too. Morgan Stanley strategists recently considered the potential impact of using AI to speed up mortgage refinancing, which is often a very laborious process. They suggested that could lead investors studying past behavior to "misprice this option that borrowers will be more inclined to exercise."

One possible consolation for people who didn't get superlow mortgage rates: the opportunity to invest in higher-yielding mortgage bonds. But nothing lasts forever. Even 30-year mortgages often have much shorter lives.

—Telis Demos

Stocks Have the Midterm Blues



Between war, rising yields and AI wiping out humanity, there's plenty to keep investors up at night lately.

But we're now in the thick of a period when angst tends to rise almost no matter what else is in the headlines. The run-up to U.S. midterm elections is historically among the worst times to own American stocks.

Between the beginning of July and a month before election day, the S&P 500 has posted a loss half of the time with an average return of negative 2.4% over the past 40 years. The good news? Once the electoral outcome starts to become clear, tension lifts. Stocks have tended to recover in the final four weeks before Election Day.

Once the votes are counted, the

S&P 500 has put in some very good performances. Does it matter who wins?

Republicans currently enjoy a trifecta—control of both houses of Congress plus the White House. That has been hard to maintain with control lost in 1994, 2006, 2010, 2018 and 2022. The last time a party retained a lock on both the executive and legislative branches was during the Carter administration.

It's commonly believed that a divided government is good for stocks because business thrives when Washington's hands are tied. There is some truth to that: Mid-term losses of one-party control have preceded a gain over the following six months of 10.4% on average since 1970, according to ana-

lysts at BlackRock.

Betting on Polymarket as of Friday put the chance of Republicans retaining the House of Representatives at just 12%. A Democratic sweep has even odds.

But changing your stock-market exposure based on the likely election outcome is probably a bad idea. The average stock market performance for all six-month periods following midterm elections since 1970 has been good, beating the divided-government scenario alone.

Shunning what could suddenly be an out-of-favor industry also could be a mistake. During President Obama's two terms, for example, the healthcare sector he campaigned on overhauling had an excellent annualized return of 14.2%.

And, despite Joe Biden's green credentials, old-fashioned fossil-fuel companies were the best performers when he was in office. That was following their last-place showing during President Trump's first term at negative 16.4% annualized.

Energy stocks have done great so far during his current term. But that is largely for a reason that is hurting his party's electoral prospects politically—a Middle East oil supply shock.

The bad news for President Trump is that there are less than two months to fix that before Election Day. The good news for investors is that no matter the outcome, the historical pre-midterm rough patch is almost over.

—Spencer Jakab

MONEY & INVESTING

Stock Spotlight

Nvidia, Intel and Marvell Technology

Chip stocks slid after leaders of the biggest AI companies called to slow its development. Nvidia, Intel and Marvell lost 3%, 6% and 7%, respectively. Overseas, chip stocks sold off, including SK Hynix (6%) and Samsung Electronics (4%) in South Korea and ASML (7%) in the Netherlands.

Abbott Laboratories

Shares advanced 1% after Abbott agreed to pay \$385 million to settle allegations related to its management of a baby formula facility where deadly bacteria was suspected of causing infant deaths.

On This Day in Market History

On this day in 1997, the web domain google.com was registered. The Stanford University coders behind the search engine, Larry Page

Oracle

The company said over the weekend that co-founder Larry Ellison scrapped plans to sell up to \$7.5 billion worth of his Oracle stake, a day after first disclosing the plans. No reason for the change was given. Shares retreated by nearly 4%, swept up in the broader tech selloff.

SoftBank Group

Shares of the Japanese tech conglomerate fell more than 10% in Tokyo. A slowdown in AI development could hit SoftBank's sprawling AI investments, including its stake in OpenAI. OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said in an interview that the company likely wouldn't go public this year given safety concerns.

CrowdStrike, Palo Alto Networks and Workday

Shares of cybersecurity and other software companies rallied Monday. Many of the shares have been under pressure this year as investors bet their businesses would be displaced by new AI models. CrowdStrike climbed nearly 14%, while Palo Alto Networks and Workday advanced 13% and 5%, respectively.

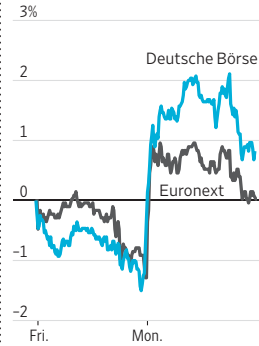
TUESDAY'S EVENTS:

- ◆ Federal Reserve: The Fed will convene for its two-day September FOMC meeting, where officials will deliberate behind closed doors over interest rates and whether an increase is warranted.
- ◆ Economic data: Empire state September manufacturing survey, ADP employment report, Johnson Redbook retail sales

EARNINGS EXPECTED:

Vera Bradley

Two-day share performance



Euronext, Rival Climbs

Shares of European stock-exchange groups rose after the chief executive of Euronext said he was open to a deal with German rival Deutsche Börse. Euronext shares climbed by about 1% in Monday's Paris trading while Deutsche Börse shares advanced 2% in Germany.

Is Bitcoin's Rally Finished?

For a while this summer, bitcoin and other cryptocurrencies were in the doldrums, eclipsed by the shinier lights of surging artificial-intelligence stocks and prediction markets. Then in August, bitcoin posted its biggest rally since 2023.

Behind the resurgence: a short-covering frenzy prompted by U.S. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent's Aug. 19 announcement that the government would at least double its buyback of long-dated debt led to negative bets on the dollar; President Trump's push for Congress to pass a "fair version" of the digital regulatory act on the same summer day; and a broader return to risk-on sentiment with crypto exchange-traded funds posting strong in-flows in August.

Bitcoin rose around 25% to \$80,000 from Aug. 19 to Aug. 25, climbing above \$82,000 at the start of

September. It has since pulled back—trading at around \$79,000 Monday afternoon.

Struggling to breach the \$80,000 level again, investors are questioning whether the bitcoin rally has fizzled out—for now.

Assets like cryptocurrencies are hard to value, and often meet seemingly arbitrary barriers to progress, said Stephen Colman, head of macro at 21Shares, a provider of crypto-based exchange-traded products. At the moment, investors are seeing the \$80,000 level as an opportunity to sell, Colman said.

Bitcoin remains a long way shy of its peak of around \$125,000 in October 2025, and some analysts are skeptical such levels will be repeated soon. On the other hand, the Treasury's willingness to countenance a weakened dollar and changing regulatory winds could spur bitcoin and its peers higher, analysts said.

—Joe Stonor and Farhan Rafid

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Conservation needs to learn to say ‘yes’

A message to our movement

Every hour, we lose more than 40 acres of farmland and ranchland. Every day, open space twice the size of Central Park disappears. Every year, another million acres of forest are lost. And once these lands are gone, they’re gone forever.

And now, trillions of dollars for desperately needed infrastructure will create one of the largest periods of building in American history.

Without a clear vision, this new infrastructure will accelerate the loss of wild and working lands that people and wildlife depend on. Land we can’t afford to lose.

So, how do we build the infrastructure we need while protecting the natural systems we depend on?

The environmental movement deserves enormous credit for solving many of the challenges of the last century: reducing pollution, protecting iconic landscapes, and forcing industry to account for environmental harm. But we did it by saying “no” — through legislation, regulation, and litigation. “No” is a powerful tool to protect hard-fought conservation wins. But it can’t be the only tool in our toolbox.

If we’re to address climate change, housing needs, water scarcity, and rural economic development, we need to build. And when we build, we have an opportunity to link new infrastructure with conservation outcomes, securing more for our country than we’d ever achieve by only saying “no.” Built infrastructure and natural infrastructure stop being opponents and instead become partners. This is what it means to find the “yes.”

Wetlands protect against floods, storm surge, and extreme weather. Forests store carbon, filter drinking water, and extend the life of reservoirs. Farms provide fresh, local, and sustainable food. Urban tree canopies keep cities livable through a heat wave. These natural systems are necessities, not amenities. They do the work that built infrastructure cannot.

We can’t solve today’s biggest challenges by only saying “no.”

A prosperous, healthy, and resilient future requires an environmental movement committed to both building what our country urgently needs and protecting what cannot be replaced.

The challenges ahead are too large and too complex for yesterday’s playbook. We need a movement as committed to building as it is to blocking.

It’s time to find the “yes.” For all of us.



Larry Selzer
President & CEO



CONSERVATIONFUND.ORG